



NATIONAL ENGINEERS' DAY

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●THE WORLD CIRCULAR Economy Forum 2026 begins in Gujarat. The global forum will showcase India's initiatives to strengthen cooperation on sustainable production and consumption.

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AFTER SHAH SAYS UCC IN NDA STATES BY '29

NDA allies TDP and Sena back Uniform Civil Code, JD(U) says not in Bihar



Union Home Minister Amit Shah with Maharashtra CM Devendra Fadnis on Ganesh Chaturthi in Mumbai, Monday. PTI

Not a hidden agenda for us, says Bengal BJP chief

Liz Mathew & Jatin Anand
New Delhi, September 14

A DAY after Union Home Minister Amit Shah announced that a Uniform Civil Code (UCC) would be implemented in all 21 NDA-ruled states before the next Lok Sabha polls in 2029, most alliance partners came out in support of the move. A few other NDA allies, however, adopted a cautious approach while the JD(U) made it clear that it would not allow any such move in Bihar. The TDP, on which the BJP-led NDA depends for a majority in Parliament and which has a significant Muslim vote bank in

Andhra Pradesh, expressed support for the move, as did the Shiv Sena and the Hindustani Awam Morcha (Secular).

"We will be supporting it," Lavu Krishna Devarayalu, leader of TDP in the Lok Sabha, told *The Indian Express*. "As of now, there is no discussion. But whenever we find the need for it, we will be looking into it. We will definitely involve various stakeholders before we adopt it," Krishna said.

The TDP and JD(U), which also has a sizeable Muslim vote bank in Bihar, had earlier opposed any legislation without adequate consultation, but the TDP appears to have since softened its stand on the issue. "It (UCC) is very much needed in a country like India, which has different religions and cultures," said a TDP leader.

Before the TDP joined the

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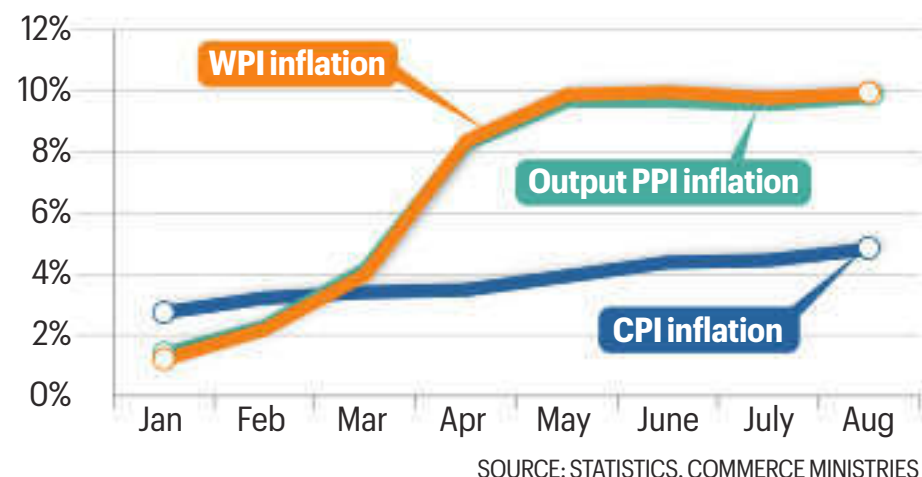
Team MEA, day after BRICS

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar with the Ministry team that was involved in the BRICS Summit, in New Delhi on Monday, a day after the conclusion of the event. Posting the photograph on X, he said, 'Your unwavering commitment and professionalism contributed to the success of #BRICSIndia2026 Summit.' **XI, MODI REACHED 'MOST IMPORTANT CONSENSUS' ON PARTNERSHIP, SAYS WANG YI, PAGE 6**

U.S. FEDERAL RESERVE EXPECTED TO INCREASE INTEREST RATES THIS WEEK

Key inflation numbers rise in August, all eyes on RBI's interest rate decision next month

● Inflation rates ticking up



Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, September 14

ARANGE of indicators measuring prices rose in August, with the main gauge of household inflation rising to 4.82% from 4.45% in July — the highest in at least eight months — government data showed on Monday, bringing the focus on the October 5-7 meeting of the Reserve Bank of India's Monetary Policy Committee (MPC), which could

see the first interest rate hike in three-and-a-half years.

While food inflation as measured by the Consumer Price Index (CPI) rose from 5.52% in July to 5.95% in August, upward pressure in prices was clearly visible for several items such as sugar and onion.

The CPI for sugar surged by 19% in August from July, and 24% as compared to August 2025. Prices have jumped due

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EXPRESS special

Pressure on food prices: El Nino effect, geopolitical tensions

Dip in fertiliser sales warning signal

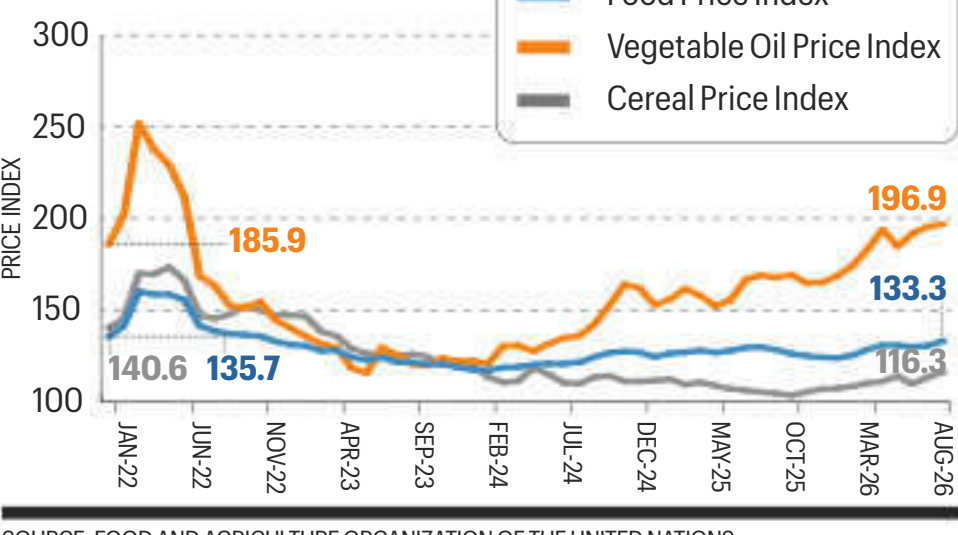
Harish Damodaran
New Delhi, September 14

THIS YEAR'S southwest monsoon has been rather erratic. June, the opening month of the season, usually witnesses an average of three low-pressure systems (LPS) that cover a 24-

hour period of about 11 days. This time, not a single LPS — which brings rain as warm, moist air near the ground rises into the atmosphere, where it cools and condenses into clouds — was formed. Rainfall over India as a whole was, then, 38%

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● FAO food price index



EXEMPTION FOR RUPAY DEBIT CARD TOO

Govt: No bank charge on UPI payment up to Rs 2,000

In 2025-26, only 4% of person-to-merchant UPI payments were for over Rs 2,000

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, September 14

THE MINISTRY of Finance on Monday notified that banks and system providers cannot levy charges on UPI transactions of up to Rs 2,000 and RuPay debit card payments, paving the way for a fee to be levied on higher-value person-to-merchant transactions.

The ministry did not specify the charges for transactions above the specified amount. Whether a Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) fee will be imposed on higher-value person-to-merchant UPI transactions will be decided by the UPI and Services Steering Committee. Headed by the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI), the committee has 22 members including banks, third-party application providers like PhonePe and Google Pay, Payments Council of India and Indian Banks' Association.

Payments industry officials have said earlier that an MDR of around 0.4-0.5% may be set for UPI payments to large merchants. This would help in meeting the industry's annual

cost of about Rs 20,700 crore.

"No bank or system provider shall impose, whether directly or indirectly, any charge upon a person making or receiving a payment by using the electronic modes of payment specified in paragraph above," the government notification said on Monday, referring to a paragraph in which it specified RuPay debit cards and UPI transactions of up to Rs 2,000.

While only 4% of person-to-merchant UPI payments in 2025-26 were for more than Rs 2,000, these transactions accounted for about two-thirds of the total person-to-merchant UPI payments by value. More than 24,000 crore UPI transactions worth Rs 314 lakh crore were made in the year.

The notification comes after the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026 — passed by Parliament last month — amended Section 10A of the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007, to remove exemption from bank charges for electronic payments under Section 269SU of the Income Tax Act, 1961.

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Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



Tarun Tejpal surrenders before court in Goa, taken into police custody

Pavneet Singh Chadha
Panaji, September 14

CONVICTED FOR raping a woman journalist, *Tehelka's* former editor-in-chief Tarun Tejpal surrendered before a local court in Goa's Mapusa on Monday and was subsequently taken into police custody.

A senior police officer said Tejpal has been sent to the Central Jail in Colvale.

Outside the court in Mapusa, Tejpal told media persons, "I just want to say that we are in the Supreme Court and we are sure that justice will come."

The Supreme Court last month rejected Tejpal's plea seeking an exemption from surrendering in the 2013 case, in which he was convicted for aggravated rape and related offences and sentenced to 10 years in jail. The High Court of Bombay at Goa, while sentencing Tejpal on August 6, had given him four weeks to surrender.

The woman had accused Tejpal of sexually assaulting her

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BJP trumps Cong in Rajasthan civic polls, Independents win on CM turf

Hamza Khan
Jaipur, September 14

THE OUTCOME of the Rajasthan urban local body (ULB) elections Monday saw the ruling BJP getting the better of the principal Opposition Congress, even as Independents and smaller parties registered a significant performance.

As per the poll results declared by the State Election Commission, the BJP won a clear majority in four of 10

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Rajasthan Chief Minister Bhajan Lal Sharma offers sweets to state BJP chief Madan Rathore after the poll win, in Jaipur. ROHIT JAIN PARAS

QUANTUM INFORMATION AND COMPUTING LAB AT RAMAN RESEARCH INSTITUTE

Scientists develop new way to tackle key quantum computing challenge

Amitabh Sinha
New Delhi, September 14

SCIENTISTS AT the Quantum Information and Computing (QuIC) laboratory at Raman Research Institute in Bengaluru have demonstrated a novel way to increase the stability of the quantum states that enable computation in a quantum computer that can potentially improve the reliability and integrity of these calculations.

Unlike traditional computers that encode electric states into 0s and 1s to store and process information, quantum computers make use of the very unique, but counter-intuitive, properties of the quantum world to carry out calculations.

One of these happens to be "quantum entanglement," a remarkable property of the quantum world in which two particles, after undergoing an interaction, get "linked" (or en-

tangled) together in such a way that they begin to behave like one single system. Measuring certain properties of one reveals information about corresponding properties of the other, irrespective of the distance between the two.

Scientists have used this, along with some other special properties like superposition — the ability of quantum particles to exist in multiple states at the

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● AFTER ARMY CUSTODIAL KILLINGS, TOPA PIR WAS ADOPTED AS 'MODEL VILLAGE', GOT INFRASTRUCTURE UPGRADE

Adopted by Army after killings, Jammu village sees change as it fights tragedy

Naveed Iqbal & Arun Sharma
Topa Pir (Poonch), Jammu, September 14

AS SHE sweeps her tiny courtyard just outside her new single-storey house in Poonch's remote tribal village of Topa Pir, Zainab Bi pauses for a minute to catch her breath. She stops as a load carrier trundles past the house on the newly laid road made of broken stones.

The house was a dream of the 80-year-old's family, made possible by the new 1.7-km road that has brought the so-far-remote tribal village of Topa Pir,

some 10 km from the Buzliar bridge in Poonch, closer to J&K's strategic Thannamandi-DKG-Buzliar road — and the rest of the Union Territory.

But for Zainab, both the house and the road carry a painful memory — that of her 48-year-old son, Safer Ahmed. Safer was one of three civilians killed during custodial torture by Rashtriya Rifles troops on December 22, 2023. At the time, families of the three

civilians described to *The Indian Express* cuts, bruises and burn marks on the bodies.

Last month, the Chandigarh Bench of the Armed Forces Tribunal (AFT) upheld the In-

dian Army's decision to award "severe displeasure" to Brigadier P Acharya, the officer who commanded the troops accused in the Topa Pir incident. The Bench noted that while the incident came in the wake of an ambush by terrorists on the DKG-Buzliar road that left four soldiers dead and three injured, "emotions cannot override military discipline and the legal obligation to treat the civilians humanely" for troops involved in follow-up operations.

However, for people like Zainab, closure feels distant and the pain acute, especially given that her oldest son is still serving in the Army. Memories of her lost son now haunt her:



they lurk in the corners of the grey house, stand beside her in the mud-and-stone kitchen as she makes tea, and crouch behind the blue plastic drum in

one corner of the courtyard.

Much has changed in the house: Zainab's husband passed away six months after they lost Safer, and her grand-



(Left) A community hall built by the Army in Topa Pir; Zainab Bi's son Safer Ahmed was among the three killed. SHUAIB MASOODI

children are away at school. Her only companion now is Safer's widow, Zareena Begum.

"Building this was possible because of this new road. *Lekin*

jo mujhse lena tha woh le gaye (they've taken from me what they could)," she says. "My son used to work very hard to earn a living for his family. The kids all lived here, and we were happy. It is lonely now. I wake up in the morning and look forward to nothing."

That day

Topa Pir is a village of about 30 households in J&K's Poonch district, sitting high on the forested terrain of the Pir Panjal. Before the new but not-yet-macadamised road came up, reaching Topa Pir was an odious task: it meant an hour's drive uphill on a dilapidated road and then a 30-minute trek

through the forest from an unmarked point just off the DKG-Buzliar road.

On December 22, 2023, the local unit of the 48 Rashtriya Rifles picked up nine men from Topa Pir's Gujjar Bakerwal community. Three of them — Safer, 28-year-old Mohammad Showkat, and 25-year-old Mohammad Shabir — never made it back, while six others had to be treated for severe torture wounds at an Army health facility in Potha.

The incident occurred following the deaths of four Indian Army soldiers in a militant ambush near the village. After the custodial deaths, the Army

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Assam man accused of beheading wife jumps from police van, dies

Jimmy Leivon
Imphal, September 14

A MAN accused of beheading his wife died early Monday morning after jumping off a police vehicle while being taken for a medical examination.

According to the police, the incident occurred around 2 am when teh accused, Ramanuj Goswami, was being taken to the Guwahati Medical College Hospital (GMCH).

He was scheduled to be produced before a court on Monday following the completion of his seven-day police custody on Sunday.

Speaking to the media, Guwahati East DCP T R Pegu said the police vehicle suffered a tyre puncture on the way to the hospital. After the tyre was replaced, the journey resumed.

“When the vehicle reached Nursing College, Goswami suddenly attacked the escorting constable. He kicked the constable, opened the rear door and jumped off,” Pegu said.

Goswami suffered serious injuries after falling onto the road, following which the police team rushed him to GMCH, where doctors declared him

dead on arrival, the DCP said.

GMCH Superintendent Devajit Choudhury said Goswami was brought to the hospital at 3.41 am by the police as a traffic accident victim. “He was brought dead. The cause of death is yet to be ascertained,” he said, adding there were no bullet injury marks on the body.

Details will be known once the post-mortem is completed, Choudhury added.

Police said Goswami’s family members have been informed about his death and that all legal formalities are being carried out. An investigation is underway, police said.

Goswami’s wife, Riya Talukdar Goswami, was found dead at her apartment in Guwahati on September 9. The incident came to light after Riya’s family approached the police, claiming she was not responding to their calls. A police team from Hatigaon Police Station Police recovered Riya’s severed head from inside a refrigerator at the residence and also seized an alleged murder weapon, a *dao*.

Goswami, a cab driver, surrendered to the police two days later.

WITH PTI INPUTS

Rajasthan

Municipal Corporations — Jaipur, Udaipur, Bhilwara and Kota — while the Congress secured a win in the Bikaner Corporation.

In Jodhpur, Alwar, Ajmer and Pali Municipal Corporations, both the rivals fell short of the halfway mark and would need to rely on Independents for control. While the BJP emerged as the largest party in Alwar, the Congress was ahead in the Ajmer and Pali Corporations.

Independents got a majority in the Bharatpur Corporation — Chief Minister Bhajan Lal Sharma’s home turf.

In the elections to 47 Municipal Councils, the BJP secured a clear majority in 12 bodies, while the Congress crossed the halfway mark in 6 and the AAP in one. Of the 252 Municipalities, the BJP clinched 70 as against the Congress’s 39, with Independents or smaller parties leading in the remaining Councils and Municipalities.

Overall, of 10,244 wards in 309 urban local bodies across the state, the BJP won 4,179, Congress 3,613, Independents 2,273, Rashtriya Loktantrik Party 63, AAP 42, CPI(M) 38; BSP 19 and Bharat Adivasi Party 8, with results not declared for 9 wards on account of glitches in the EVMs. Hailing the BJP’s victory, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said in an X post in Hindi: “Heartfelt gratitude to the public for securing a resounding victory for the BJP in the Rajasthan local body elections. This is proof of the victory of truth over the echo of falsehood.”

CM Sharma said the poll results were “a stamp of approval” on the BJP government’s work in the last two-and-a-half years in both urban and rural areas and that the people have adopted the “Viksit Bharat, Viksit Rajasthan” resolution of PM Modi. “The youth of Rajasthan have again reposed their faith in PM Modi. And the country’s youth is taking forward the PM’s vision,” he said.

The BJP, considered formidable in urban areas, has traditionally performed well in the civic polls in Rajasthan. However, Monday’s results are nowhere near the hoped that the BJP might have won for.

While the BJP bagged four Municipal Corporations, even in Jaipur (150 wards), its known

stronghold, it just managed to cross the simple majority mark by winning 78 wards.

In another major Corporation Jodhpur — the home district of Congress stalwart and ex-chief minister Ashok Gehlot and BJP leader Gajendra Singh Shekhawat — both the parties were neck and neck at 44 seats each, while in Bikaner (80 wards), the Congress beat the BJP.

While the BJP may succeed in forming a Board in most of the remaining Corporations, with most Independent councillors expected to align with the ruling party, the results have exposed chinks in the BJP’s urban armour in various regions.

For CM Sharma, the point that Independents have performed better than the BJP in Bharatpur would be a cause of concern: Independents won 36 wards in the 65-member Bharatpur Corporation as against the BJP’s 20 and the Congress’s 7.

In Pali too, the home turf of BJP state president Madan Rathore, of 65 wards, the Congress bagged 29 against the BJP’s 21, while Independents won 15.

The BJP also suffered a loss in the 45-member Jhalawar Municipal Council, where it got just 13 against the Congress’s 29. This region is considered a stronghold of BJP heavyweight and ex-CM Vasundhara Raju, who is an MLA from Jhalrapatan in the district. The BJP, however, won the Jhalrapatan Municipality.

The results dealt a blow to the Congress which was projecting an upper hand in the ULB polls. Citing criticism of the Bhajan Lal Sharma government over the delay in holding these polls, the Congress had sought to create a narrative that it was due to the BJP’s “fear” of losing it.

While the Congress is said to have suffered due to its factionalism and weak organisation, state party president Govind Singh Dotasra blamed alleged misuse of delimitation by the BJP for its setback.

Meanwhile, springing a surprise, the AAP won a majority in the Baran Municipal Council, while the CPI(M) is set to form a Board in Bikaner’s Nokha Municipality, winning 29 of the 45 wards against the BJP’s 13 and 3 Independents. In the absence of the Congress in Nokha, the CPI(M) capitalised on perceived dissatisfaction with the BJP which was seen in other ULBs in Bikaner too.

UPI payments

Section 269SU applies to those having a business turnover of over Rs 50 crore.

Earlier, Section 10A of the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007, said that no bank or system provider could impose any charge on payments made through electronic modes prescribed under Section 269SU. These modes were RuPay debit cards, BHIM-UPI, and UPI-QR code.

But the amendment paved the way for an MDR fee to be imposed on UPI and RuPay debit card payments to large merchants such as Amazon and

Flipkart.

However, the government has repeatedly said that small value transactions and money paid by one individual to another will not face any charges. This is what has been notified on Monday.

Amid speculation that charges would apply on all UPI payments, the Ministry of Finance had said in a statement on August 8: “The recent amendment to the Payment and Settlement Systems Act has generated debate, with some misinterpreting it as a move to impose charges on ordinary users. In

UCC

NDA following the 2024 Lok Sabha election, which brought down the BJP’s tally to 240 from 303 in 2019, TDP chief and Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu had said that when it “comes to a UCC, the TDP will stand with the Muslim community”.

In Andhra Pradesh, of the total population of 8,45,80,777, Hindus accounted for 7,48,24,149, or over 88%, while Muslims numbered 80,82,412, or almost 10%, according to the 2011 Census.

In Patna, JD(U) leader and former state minister Shyam Rajak reiterated on Monday that the party favours the Bill at the national level, but not in Bihar. JD(U) leader and former chief minister Nitish Kumar had previously underlined the need for

broad national consensus on the issue before its implementation.

Rajak told reporters: “When this Bill came to Parliament, our leader (Nitish Kumar) was clear: that we support it but will not let it be implemented in our state (Bihar). We stand by this.”

Asked about the party’s stand, senior leader and Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Jha said the party will take up the issue with the BJP’s national leadership. “We will discuss it with the Home Minister,” Jha, who is also national working president of the party, said.

Another Bihar ally, the Lok Janshakti Party (Ram Vilas), has always maintained that it will evaluate the potential impact and legal framework once a blueprint or draft bill on the issue is presented to it.

Shah’s latest remarks came three months after the BJP swept the elections in West Bengal, where the previous TMC

Quantum computing

same time — to build powerful quantum computers which can perform certain very complex computations in an efficient manner.

But the quantum states that give superpowers to these computers are themselves very fragile and ephemeral. The entangled state, for example, disintegrates quickly on interaction with the external environment, a phenomenon known as decoherence. Sometimes, entanglement vanishes abruptly, too, even before the normal disintegration takes place. Scientists call this condition “entanglement sudden death.”

This weakness creates a problem for quantum comput-

ing. The integrity of the calculation becomes doubtful. Scientists have tried to deal with this challenge by carrying out repeated corrective interventions that delay decoherence. But these repetitive interventions have their own side-effects. They are costly, and can introduce errors of their own.

This is where the research team of Urbasi Sinha, group leader of the lab at RRI, has achieved a breakthrough. Instead of repetitive operations, her team has developed a new technique that deals with decoherence in this context through a “single-shot operation.”

Depending on the instant when the operation is carried

out, this operation can delay decoherence and entirely avoid sudden death.

Applied at some other instant, this operation can even hasten decoherence, though it is not an outcome that is scientifically desirable. This operation, therefore, gives scientists greater control over the different possibilities.

“To me, the heart of the result is that the timing of the operation is not just an experimental detail, it can be a control resource,” said Sinha, a senior professor at RRI. She said her experiments presented a proof of concept, something that has relevance to the problem of decoherence, rather than a complete solution. It would need to be tested out by different quantum computing systems to see how advantageously it can be applied

government had vehemently opposed the UCC. On Monday, BJP Bengal president Samik Bhattacharya said the party’s state government will initiate the process for the passage and implementation of the law as soon as possible.

“We are going to introduce the UCC, it’s not a hidden agenda for us. BJP, since its inception, has been holding it as one of its priorities and now it’s our moral duty to fulfil it. A large section of the population is also keen to see that a uniform civil code is implemented in the state,” Bhattacharya told *The Indian Express*.

However, the BJP’s new Bengal ally, Nationalist Citizens Party of India (NCPI), formed of MPs who have broken away from the Trinamool Congress, said the party, which has 20 MPs in the Lok Sabha, would have to deliberate on the issue.

“We heard that the NDA-ruled states are going to imple-

ments. It’s a serious issue which needs a lot of thinking and deliberation. We will do that once a proposal is made. We will have discussions before taking a stand,” party leader and MP Kakoli Ghosh Dasgupta said.

The 2011 Census puts West Bengal’s total population at 9,12,76,115, of which Hindus constitute 6,43,85,546, or over 70%, and Muslims, at 2,46,54,825, account for a little over 27%.

Shiv Sena leader Shrikant Shinde said: “The UCC is similarly rooted in the principles of equality, justice and national unity... Our leader Eknath Shinde is deeply committed to the implementation of the UCC and to advancing the vision of a strong, united and progressive India.”

HAM-S national president Santosh Kumar Suman “wholeheartedly” welcomed Shah’s statement on the UCC and extended the party’s support to it.

in different environments.

The results of experiments by Sinha’s team has been published in a paper in the American Physical Society’s Physical Review A.

“We are not claiming to have solved decoherence or replaced quantum error correction, rather the work identifies timing itself as another control parameter that future quantum processors could exploit alongside better materials, better gates, and error-correction protocols,” she said.

“Our experiment shows that one does not always have to fight decoherence with long sequences of corrective operations. The timing of a single local gate can redirect the entanglement trajectory and extend the regime over which the state remains useful,” she said.

Inflation

to lower-than-expected sugar production and inventory falling to multi-year lows. In light of the soaring price of sugar — a key ingredient during the festival season — the government last month allowed duty-free imports of up to 10 lakh tonnes of raw sugar until October 31.

The price of onion, on the other hand, was up 22% in August as compared to July, with the late rains delaying planting.

“The inflation outlook remains vulnerable to both external and weather-related risks,” said Rajani Sinha, chief economist at CareEdge Ratings. According to Sinha, while the RBI is likely to remain data-dependent, a sustained uptick in inflation “could strengthen the case for a rate hike in the coming months”. This makes the October meeting of the MPC “crucial to watch, especially as some major central banks have already embarked on a rate-hiking cycle”.

The latest CPI inflation print comes three weeks before the next meeting of the MPC. The minutes of last month’s meeting had shown that RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra and Deputy Governor Poonam Gupta were both hinting towards an increase in interest rates. The MPC last increased the repo rate in February 2023.

The RBI is legally mandated to keep CPI inflation at 4% in a band of 2-6%. However, this is the third month in a row that headline retail inflation is above 4%. The central bank, which last month left the policy repo rate unchanged at 5.25%, expects CPI inflation to average 4.7% in July-September, 5.9% in October-December, 5.5% in January-March 2027, and 5.3% in April-June 2027.

With inflation ticking up and the economy far more robust than anyone had expected — GDP growth was 7.8% in the first quarter of 2026-27 — economists have been warning that the MPC must soon increase interest rates. Although CPI inflation is expected to remain within the 2-6% band of the RBI, there are fears of price pressures spreading from food and fuel to other categories.

In a sign that price pressures may be broadening, as many as 314 of the 358 items in the CPI saw higher prices in August as compared to July. The number was 310 in July and 236 in February, before the war in West Asia began.

Meanwhile, the number of

items whose inflation was more than 4% rose from 101 in July to 110 in August.

Signs of higher prices becoming “structural” were also visible in wholesale inflation numbers, according to Devendra Pant, chief economist at India Ratings & Research. This, Pant said, could be seen in the fact that wholesale inflation of seven sub-categories of the manufacturing sector — tobacco products, textile products, chemical products, rubber and plastic products, base metals, electrical equipment and other manufacturing — has remained above 10%. These seven categories make up more than a quarter of the manufacturing group, which in turn accounts for almost two-thirds of the entire WPI.

US Fed decision

Policy action is also expected from the US Federal Reserve, which will announce its interest rate decision on Wednesday.

Markets are expecting the US central bank to hike the federal funds rate target range by 25 bps to 3.75-4% after inflation data released last week showed American consumer prices rose 0.4% month-on-month in August as against a 0.1% increase in July, with the year-on-year headline inflation rate steady at 3.4%.

“We recently changed our fed funds (rate) view to forecast a mini 75 bps tightening cycle,” ANZ economists led by Brian Martin said on Monday. “We had pencilled in December for the start of that but acknowledged that poor September inflation data could see the cycle start earlier. This is now the case.” Martin now expects the US Fed to raise interest rates by 25 bps this week, followed by further hikes in October and December to take the key rate to 4.25-4.50%.

Hours before the household inflation numbers, the commerce ministry released Wholesale Price Index (WPI) data for August, which showed that wholesale inflation rose to 9.92% from 9.78% in July. This increase was driven by food and fuel prices, with Rahul Agrawal, principal economist at ICRA, noting that wholesale food inflation hitting a 20-month high of 7.05% in August was largely due to higher prices of fruits, vegetables, milk, spices, and sugar.

In addition to the WPI, the commerce ministry also released producer price data for August on Monday, with inflation based on the output Producer Price Index (PPI) edging up to 9.81% from 9.57% in July.

Topa Pir

issued a two-year administrative censure of “severe displeasure” against Brigadier Acharya and removed his unit from the area. Acharya challenged the disciplinary action, but on August 20, 2026, the Armed Forces Tribunal upheld the Army’s decision.

Since the alleged incident, much has changed in the village. After the 2023 incident, the Army adopted Topa Pir as a ‘model village’, facilitating its transformation.

On the new 1.7-km road now winding through the village, water pipelines are still being laid, and solar panels gleam from the porches of homes. A small shed now serves as a bus stop, while the stretch of road from Bufliaz Bridge to the bus stop is metalled, taking vehicles only a few minutes to cover, down from the earlier 60 minutes. Where darkness once fell with sunset, the village now stays bright 24x7, powered by two solar bulbs in every household.

The only primary school, which previously had just a room where students up to Class 5 sat on the floor, has now been upgraded into a middle school, although villagers claim this is yet to be functional. “Two years ago, a health sub-centre was operating out of a one-room structure, but now, in the community hall built by the troops, one room has been furnished as the health centre and another as the computer centre,” Mehboob Bhat, former sarpanch of the neighbouring Mastan Dara Pan-

chayat, says.

As compensation for the deaths of the three men, the district administration has provided jobs to their next of kin. Safer’s widow Zareena Begum and Showkat’s brother Mohammad Razzaq are both attached to the health sub-centre, while Shabir’s brother Kabir now works in the village for the Jal Shakti Department.

Meanwhile, the Army has helped secure admissions and scholarships for the victims’ children: for instance, Safer’s son is studying at an Army school, and his daughter is studying at a private school on an Army scholarship.

But in the village, the road, lights, education schemes and jobs sit uncomfortably alongside the memories of that December day. Back at his house — a three-room structure with a bare courtyard — near the newly built community centre, Wali limps across the room and sits on a folded mattress with some difficulty.

“I can’t forget my son’s face, the bruises on his body. The Army is meant to protect the people of this country. But if the poor are not protected, is there a point?” At the same time, he says, “But the entire Army cannot be termed bad for the wrongs of a few people.”

Barely 100 metres from his house, Showkat’s 62-year-old father Nazir Hussain says the Army’s internal inquiries do not provide them with any relief. “There should be clarity on what they did and the punishment.”

As he looks at the road, Hussain shows some disdain. “Every village gets a road. Did people have to die for us to get here?”

Tejpal

in a hotel elevator in Goa on November 7 and November 8, 2013. In 2021, a sessions court in Goa acquitted Tejpal, saying the complainant “did not demonstrate any kind of normative behaviour” a victim of sexual assault “might plausibly show”.

The Goa government had appealed to the High Court. On August 6 last month, the HC

overturned the trial court’s verdict and sentenced Tejpal to 10 years in jail. The HC said that the trial court “proceeded on a notion that a victim of sexual assault must behave in a stereotypical manner”.

Tejpal subsequently moved the Supreme Court challenging his conviction and 10-year jail term. His appeal is pending. The Goa government also moved the SC last month seeking an enhancement of his punishment and a life term.



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FEUD BETWEEN FAMILIES BEHIND KILLINGS, SAY POLICE

After 69 bullets pumped into man, now nephew shot dead in South Delhi

Alok Singh
New Delhi, September 14

VIJAY KUMAR, 32, was at his gym in Delhi's Fatehpur Beri area on Monday morning when a man asked him to step out. When he did, two men wearing helmets opened fire, pumping more than a dozen bullets into him and killing him on the spot.

His family alleged that his killing was the result of the rivalry between two families -- Arun Lohiya and Ratan Lohiya, who share the same last name.

Last year, both houses saw two murders in the span of a few months, allegedly at each other's hands. Ratan and Arun were intercepted by armed men in broad daylight before they were shot dead.

Ratan was Vijay's uncle. "Vijay was innocent... Last year in November, they had murdered my cousin, Ratan, near his house in a similar manner. And now they have killed our innocent nephew," Vijay's uncle Narender Kumar told *The Indian Express*.

Ratan, a milk dairy businessman, was shot around 69 times in Aya Nagar in November 2025. He was reportedly wearing a bulletproof jacket at the time of the attack.

"Had Vijay been aware that he might be the next target after his uncle, he might have been a little more alert," Narender said.

Vijay's wife, Ritu, said that she spoke with him on the phone around 8:30 am on Monday, when he told her to prepare breakfast. However, she said that after 10 am, Vijay allegedly stopped taking calls. "Ramvir Vidhuri has killed my husband," she claimed.

Ramvir is Arun's father and lives in the same area. She also said that Vijay had celebrated his birthday on September 8. "We were living in fear after Ratan's murder. In fact, I did not let him (Vijay) to go to his gym for 20 days after Ratan's



Gym owner Vijay Kumar (top) and his uncle Ratan Lohiya

murder. I don't know why they killed my husband now. He had nothing to do with Arun's murder," she said.

Police said four men riding two motorcycles arrived at Hansa Chowk in Fatehpur Beri around 10 am, and two of them opened fire at Vijay before fleeing. The accused came on a black Apache bike and fled towards Faridabad, according to police sources.

"An FIR has been registered in the matter and multiple teams have been constituted. Raids are being conducted at various locations to trace and apprehend the accused persons. The motive initially seems to arise from personal enmity," Deputy Commissioner of Police Anant Mittal said.

Long rivalry

As per the police, the rivalry began with a dispute between Arun and Ratan's son, Deepak. They used to be friends.

The friendship, however, soured over a financial dispute. Then, Arun allegedly as-

saulted Deepak. In April 2024, Arun was killed near Chhattarpur Metro Station.

Deepak and Vijay's younger brother Ajay are lodged in Tihar Jail in connection with the case. Narender said Vijay was the only earning member of his family.

"His wife is yet to come to terms with the fact that he is no more. She was already unwell, and after hearing about her husband's death, her condition has deteriorated further," he said.

Gangster angle suspected again

Police suspect the involvement of gangsters in Vijay's murder.

In Ratan's murder, the alleged involvement of gangster Neeraj Faridpuria had surfaced. Police had also suspected the role of Western Uttar Pradesh-based gangster Randeep Bhati, who allegedly provided the gunmen to carry out the killing.

Police now suspect that a new set of shooters from the same group may have been involved in Vijay's killing.

Investigators are probing whether the murder was part of the continuing cycle of revenge.

Late on Monday evening, a social media post surfaced where one claiming to be linked to gangster Himanshu Bhau's gang took responsibility for the killing.

The police, however, said that they were checking the authenticity of the post.

Op Safed Sagar veteran hit with iron rod over parking dispute in Gurgaon; accused arrested

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurgaon, September 14

A RETIRED Indian Air Force (IAF) Group Captain, who served during Operation Safed Sagar in the 1999 Kargil war, was allegedly assaulted with an iron rod following an altercation over vehicle parking in Gurgaon, police said on Monday. Officers said that the accused was arrested within seven hours of the registration of the FIR.

IAF veteran Amit Kumar Gupta sustained a head injury and a fracture to his left arm and is currently undergoing treatment at a private hospital, officers said.

In his complaint filed on Sunday, Gupta said he and his family had gone to a restaurant in M3M Magnum Business Park, Sector 58, for dinner around 8 pm on September 10.

After dropping his family members near the entrance, he proceeded to park the vehicle but was allegedly turned away from multiple parking areas by the staff. The retired officer alleged that when he attempted to reverse his car, a parking attendant began punching and hitting the vehicle's window.



IAF veteran Amit Kumar Gupta; Accused in police custody. EXPRESS

When Gupta stepped out to object, the attendant allegedly produced an iron rod, struck him repeatedly on his head and left arm, and fled the scene.

The accused parking attendant was identified as Deepak Mavi, 24, a resident of Kot village in Faridabad, with the help of CCTV footage, officers said.

Rambir Singh, Station House Officer (SHO) of the Sector 65 police station, said preliminary inquiry confirmed an altercation broke out after Gupta was made to drive across various parking points on the premises.

"Prime facie, CCTV footage shows how he was beaten with an iron rod. He has a fracture on



his arm," Assistant Commissioner of Police (Headquarters) Abhilash Joshi said. Police said an FIR was registered at the Sector 65 police station.

Police spokesperson ASI Sandeep Kumar said, "A case was registered under relevant provisions of law. Gurgaon Police is examining CCTV footage related to the incident... During questioning, the accused said that he had an argument with the complainant over car parking. In a fit of anger, he picked up an iron pipe lying nearby and struck the complainant, hitting him on his arm. The accused is being questioned regarding the sequence of events..."

BRICS delegate reports a bag with Rs 3 lakh missing, cops find it in 35 mins

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 14

THE DELHI Police launched a frantic search after a South African BRICS delegate's bag containing nearly Rs 3 lakh in cash was reported missing on Sunday — barely an hour before he was due to leave India.

Within 35 minutes, police traced the cab he had travelled in to Gurgaon and recovered the bag from beneath a seat. It was handed over to the delegate, Dumisa Morris Sobekwe, at 8.15 pm — around 30 minutes before his scheduled departure — said officers.

How the search unfolded

Police said Sobekwe had returned to The Lalit Hotel after visiting Ambience Mall in Gurgaon when he realised the bag, which contained US dollars and Indian currency, was missing. Hotel staff informed the police and the information was subsequently conveyed to ACP Security and the SHO of Barakhamba Road police station.

Police received the informa-

tion at 7.10 pm and a team was at the hotel in five minutes. Officers obtained details of the delegate's journey and began tracing the cab.

The vehicle was identified and the driver was located at 7.45 pm. The bag was found under the seat, police said. The cash was recovered and, after verification, handed over to the delegate at 8.15 pm.

"The matter was treated with urgency as the delegate had a scheduled departure. Our teams immediately traced the cab, recovered the bag and verified its contents before handing it back to him. The prompt action ensured that he could leave without any inconvenience," said DCP (New Delhi) Sachin Sharma.

Police said the driver initially attempted to evade questions but later cooperated with the team. The recovery operation was carried out under the supervision of ACP Barakhamba Rajeev Kumar. SHO Barakhamba Sube Singh, SI Anupam and Head Constable Akash Rana were part of the team.

Billing, retrospective tariffs: Gurgaon residents to raise concerns with power regulator over operational flaws

This comes after regulator initiated proceedings on compliance

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurgaon, September 14

OPERATIONAL CHALLENGES related to the Unified Billing System (UBS) and mounting retrospective non-domestic or commercial power penalties are among the concerns that the

RWAs — representing group housing societies along the Dwarka Expressway — in Gurgaon are planning to raise before the Haryana Electricity Regulatory Commission (HERC) as the regulator seeks details on compliance.

This comes after the HERC, the state power regulator, initiated suo motu proceedings on August 25 into the "deliberate, continuous, and systemic non-compliance" of the HERC (Single Point Supply) Regulations, 2020, and the delayed roll-out of a new system — Unified Billing Software — mandated by

a 2022 circular. During the hearing, counsel for the Dakshin Haryana Bijli Vitran Nigam (DHBVN) submitted that the compliance rested with developers and RWAs, seeking time to gather field data.

HERC granted time until October 7 for the discom to submit its reply, scheduling the next hearing for October 12.

In response, representatives from over 15 RWAs — across Sectors 99 to 113 in Gurgaon — convened on Saturday evening to deliberate on the regulatory fallout. While the RWAs welcomed the regulatory push, they as-

serted that the billing software suffers from fundamental operational flaws and shifts administrative failures onto residents.

Under the existing Single Point Supply (SPS) framework, DHBVN supplies bulk electricity to a housing society through a single primary meter, billing the society collectively. The RWA, or the developer, remains responsible for maintaining the internal distribution network, reading individual sub-meters, and billing flat owners.

A major friction point with this system, however, involves the split between domestic

supply (DS) tariffs for residential units and non-domestic supply (NDS) or commercial tariffs that are applied to the common amenities like community halls, and retail outlets in the societies.

"DS and NDS category billing is the real problem," said PN Mishra, General Secretary of the RWA at Suncity Avenue, Sector 102. "DHBVN has penalised our society with Rs 97 lakh in arrears for not raising bills accordingly, but it is not our fault. We have requested DHBVN for UBS, and we send commercial consumption readings separately, but the department is not helping..."

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DEVANSH MITTAL

Hearings underway at a voter registration centre in Badarpur.

Notices to 44% electors in Badarpur: BLOs hold SIR hearings at polling stations and homes

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, September 14

BY AROUND 2.30 pm on Monday, at Panchsheel Public School in Southeast Delhi's Badarpur — a polling station where hearings for electors are being held amid the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise — Booth Level Officer (BLO) Sumit Bhati had already conducted 36 hearings. A Hindi teacher by profession, Bhati has been allocated 1,000 electors. People across the city are being served hearing notices, requiring them to verify their details to make sure their names are not deleted from the draft electoral rolls.

According to officials, notices will be issued to around 87,000 or 44% of electors in Badarpur because their details could not be linked to the 2002 SIR electoral roll, or due to anomalies found in their enumeration forms. Badarpur, therefore, is said to become the Assembly seat with the highest percentage of electors who are being served notices.

Bhati and other BLOs are conducting the hearings in Badarpur — in a move, election officials say, is meant to spare electors a trip to the electoral office. “If all 87,000 electors, who get notices, have to come to the electoral office, it will be inconvenient for them. They can submit documents to the BLO, at their own house or at the polling station, and the BLO will upload those in the portal. But the final approval will be granted by the Electoral Registration Officer (ERO),” a source in the ERO office, meanwhile, said.

The Badarpur Assembly seat had 3.44 lakh electors before the SIR exercise began. While 1.98 lakh names made it to the draft rolls published on August 31, enumeration forms of 1.46 lakh electors were marked ‘uncollectible’ and their names were struck off.

According to the Election Commission's communication to Delhi's Chief Electoral Officer, the inquiry to ascertain whether an elector is eligible to stay on the electoral rolls has to

be conducted by the ERO or the Assistant ERO. Officials in the CEO office, however, said that the ERO can use their discretion to decide on the location of the hearing. “But before finalising any venue, it is ensured that there are proper logistics,” an official said.

Of the 1,000 electors BLO Bhati is handling, 701 have made it to the draft roll. Around 240 will be served notices, mostly due to discrepancies such as a mismatch in the spelling of their names. “These issues can be easily solved ... the elector just has to give us an undertaking about the correct name,” Bhati said.

“*Kuchh nahi, bas logo ko pareshan karne ka tarika hai* (This is nothing but a way to trouble people),” said 57-year-old Bachan Singh, who had forgotten to fill in details from the 2002 electoral roll. “When I have been voting for all these years, why do they have to call me to waste my time like this?”

Three kilometres away, at a voter registration centre, Anita (23) said: “*In logo ko ek baar mein batana chahiye, baar baar alag kaagaz ke liye bolte hai* (These people should tell us at once what documents are needed. Every time they would ask for different documents).”

Anita, a housewife, was issued a notice as she was not able to establish a link to the 2002 electoral roll. She had brought her own education certificates as well as that of her father. The BLO scanned and uploaded photos of both, then clicked a selfie with Anita holding the notice, along with an attendance sheet certifying she had attended the hearing.

Meanwhile, officials at the local election office attributed the high number of deletions and notices to the fact that a large number of people live in rented accommodations. “Most of the settlements here are unauthorised colonies where people live on rent. They shift frequently,” an official said, pointing out that many of the settlements did not exist in 2002, when the last SIR exercise was carried out.

SURVEY CONDUCTED AFTER HC RAP OVER SATYA NIKETAN BUILDING COLLAPSE

99% PGs do not have fire NOC, no layout approval for nearly 30%: MCD survey

Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, September 14

A WEEK after the collapse of a five-storey boys hostel in Satya Niketan claimed seven lives, a Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) survey of 2,453 paying guest (PG) accommodations across the Capital has revealed stark compliance gaps.

Only 31 or 1.2% of such buildings have a No Objection Certificate (NOC) from the Delhi Fire Service (DFS), according to the details collected so far. The building plans for only 726 PG buildings — which is less than 30% of those surveyed — have been sanctioned. Just eight buildings have a structural stability certificate.

The survey, which covers properties across all 12 MCD zones, was carried out following the Delhi High Court's rap on September 7, a day after the Satya Niketan building gave way.

The civic body initiated a crackdown against illegal constructions across the city, and flagged off the survey.

Documents for structural stability, occupancy certificate (OCC); and compliance with the Master Plan for Delhi (MPD); these and other regulatory checks were part of the MCD survey.

Zone-wise analysis

The Civil Lines Zone — where the Delhi University's North Campus is located — recorded the most number of properties across 12 MCD zones with 608 PG accommodations, as per the survey.

Of the total buildings, only 364 have sanctioned building plans, only 28 have fire NOCs, 27 have regularisation approvals and none have structural



•Numbers flagged in survey

Zone	Properties	DFS NOC Obtained	Structural Stability Certificate	Building Plan Sanctioned
Civil Lines	608	28	0	364
Keshav Puram	410	2	2	54
South	390	0	0	0
KBZ	365	0	0	128
Central	191	0	0	134
Shahdara South	130	1	5	7
West Zone	116	0	1	35
NGZ	106	0	0	0
Narela	82	0	0	0
Rohini	36	0	0	5
Shahdara North	11	0	0	2
City SP	8	0	0	0
Total	2,453	31	8	729

stability certificates.

At 410, Keshav Puram Zone has the second highest number of PG properties across the 12 MCD zone. Only 54 have sanctioned building plans, two have fire NOCs, two have structural stability certificates and none have occupancy certificates.

The South Zone houses many of the prominent universities, including DU's South Campus, IIT Delhi and JNU.

Of 390 PG properties recorded in the area, none have DFS clearance, structural stability, building-plan sanction or occupancy certificate. None of the properties were recorded as having PG activity permissible

under the Master Plan.

Lapses under lens

The deadline of the survey set by the HC ended on Sunday. But the MCD, which had set its eye on September 10 as the last date of survey, will continue its survey, for at least one more day, before wrapping up, according to officials.

■ Among the regulatory norms, the buildings need to have a layout plan sanctioned by the civic body.

The proposal for a layout plan, according to the MCD website, should be prepared “strictly in accordance to MPD and building bye-law, rules,

regulations and practice of the department and no misinterpretation or inference of provisions of these MPD and unified building bye-laws has been exercised while preparing the plans”.

■ An NOC is a formal clearance by the Delhi Fire Service that a building meets the safety requirement as per its occupancy. Presently, the DFS generally issues a Fire Safety Certificate (FSC) after verifying the required measures. The DFS certificate, specifically, carries conditions such as keeping escape, entry and exit routes unobstructed, ensuring occupants and employees know how to evict the building in case of an emergency, and maintaining fire fighting equipment in working condition.

At the Satya Niketan building, there was allegedly only one exit for escape.

■ The structural stability certificate is meant to establish that a building can safely withstand the loads and stresses associated with its construction and use.

■ MCD's construction-permit system treats OCC as the next stage after the building has been constructed. For the OCC stage, MCD requires completion plans showing all floors actually constructed, along with plot dimensions, area and setbacks, as well as photographs of the completed building and other prescribed documents.

■ According to MCD, regularisation is a process through which certain existing unauthorised construction or development is brought into compliance with the applicable rules, subject to the specific regularisation policy and payment of prescribed charges.

‘Felt unsafe on road in Gurgaon,’ says woman biker after being chased, hit by ‘drunk’ men in car

Express News Service
Gurgaon, September 14

A WOMAN motorcyclist was injured on Sunday after she was chased by a car that then rammed into her two-wheeler in Gurgaon's Golf Course Road before fleeing the spot.

The woman, Sia, was riding her Aprilia RS 457 sports bike alongside members of a biking group when the incident occurred. A purported video of the incident shared on social media shows a car bearing a Haryana number plate tailing the group before allegedly cutting sharply into Sia's lane and colliding with her bike. The Gurgaon police on Monday said an FIR was filed suo motu at Sector 56 police station under relevant BNS sections for rash driving and endangering human life. Officers, however, said that the accused, who remained on the run, was not named in the FIR. They said three teams have been formed that are raiding locations he has stayed and worked at.

‘They were hostile’

According to the rider, the car, which was being driven by the accused, began pursuing her shortly after their ride commenced. When she asked them to maintain a safe distance, the occupants of the car allegedly turned hostile and demanded that she pull over.

“The men appeared to be drunk,” Sia alleged in a video statement posted online. “I kept riding ahead to prevent them from blocking me, while a friend riding behind tried to shield my bike from the vehicle.” The car continued to pursue her until the driver allegedly attempted to cut directly in front of her and struck the mo-



Screengrab from dashcam footage show the rider being thrown onto the road. EXPRESS

torcycle. Sia was thrown onto the road in the impact. The car dragged her bike a short distance before speeding off.

Another rider in the group chased the car and managed to intercept it at a nearby traffic signal. When confronted over the collision, the driver denied responsibility and sped away as the signal cleared.

Sia sustained injuries in the crash, though fellow riders noted that full protective gear helped avert serious injuries.

Sia had earlier appealed to the authorities for strict action, saying: “I felt unsafe on Gurgaon roads. People like them aren't afraid of hitting people and running away.” In a statement on her Instagram account, which she has since made private, Sia said she does not wish to reveal her face or identity.

The video triggered widespread outrage on social media, with citizens and motoring groups demanding action.

Earlier on Monday, police spokesperson ASI Sandeep Kumar told *The Indian Express*: “We have seen the video, and messaged her on Instagram and asked her to come and file a formal complaint so we can begin our investigation on the specific allegations legally.”

‘Chameleon in hostel food’: Jamia forms panel to probe claim

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 14

JAMIA MILLIA Islamia (JMI) AMK Hostel has constituted a four-member fact-finding committee to examine CCTV footage after students alleged that a chameleon was found in a bowl of pulses served in their hostel canteen on Saturday. The university on Monday also said that it is seeking help from government investigating agencies to examine the footage.

In a statement issued Mon-

day, the university said the CCTV footage “appears to show” one of the boys' hostel residents taking his bowl of pulses under a mess table, following which a group of students allegedly created a commotion claiming that a chameleon had been found in the bowl. The committee will examine the entire footage, including the circumstances leading up to the incident and the actions and roles of those involved, JMI said.

The panel formed over the

latest allegations has also been tasked with determining whether the incident was part of any deliberate attempt to create disruption or bring disrepute to the university's hostel messes. JMI said appropriate action would be taken under applicable rules if deliberate wrongdoing, fabrication, misinformation was established.

Meanwhile, the Jamia unit of the All India Students' Association (AISA) has alleged that six school hostel students, most of them minors, were summoned

to the Proctor's office at around 3.30 pm on Sunday without prior notice or explanation, and that their phones were seized. In a statement, the student group said the students were questioned individually by over five members of the proctorial team about the incident.

AISA alleged that the students were held for more than seven hours and one of them was pressured to “confess to having planted the reptile to defame Jamia”. The university has not responded to the claims.

The student group also alleged that the administration had begun targeting students who spoke to the media and conducting searches of students' rooms. The development comes days after a three-day protest by residents of the university's Jammu and Kashmir Girls' (J&K) Hostel over food-quality issues. The protest was called off on Saturday night after a meeting with the administration and fresh assurances..

On Monday, JMI said in its statement food quality in its

hostel messes were routinely monitored by hostel administrations, including provosts, wardens, caretakers and mess committees comprising hostel residents.

The university has now decided to install additional CCTV cameras in all hostel messes and their kitchens. On the disruptions, the varsity called it “concerted attempts” to disturb the normal functioning of its hostels and the wider academic environment through unsubstantiated allegations.

EXPRESS special

Homes worth crores, worms in water: Noida's Supernova residents battle crisis

Over 350 families said worms have been coming from taps and flushes

Drishti Jain
Noida, September 14

TWO WEEKS ago, Dr Geeta Mishra opened the kitchen tap at her Noida home and was alarmed to find yellowish-black and foul-smelling water, infested with worms. She soon found worms in the bathroom taps and flushes too.

The 42-year-old assistant professor had moved to Noida with her husband and 10-year-old son after spending her entire life in Delhi.

The family first rented a home in Supertech's Supernova, in the Nova East and West block, for nearly two years before buying a 3 BHK flat worth a few crores.

She is among 350 families in the project, located in Sector 94 along the Noida-Greater Noida Expressway, facing a worsening water problem. “When we saw worms coming out of our kitchen tap, it was actually heartbreaking. Then it started coming in our toilet taps and flushes. No matter how many

times we clear the washrooms, it doesn't help,” said Dr Geeta.

A daily struggle

Residents said they have been forced to buy packaged water for drinking.

Naresh Nandwani, Advisor, Super Nova Apartment Owners' Association (SNAOA), said, “We get 40 litres of water that lasts for five days and it costs Rs 240. I have to prioritise my family's health.”

But for the professor, who has bought a 20-litre can, this solves only one part of the problem.

“How can we bathe with packaged water?” Geeta asked. As a temporary fix, the family bought a filter costing Rs 1 lakh two years ago but it needs to be replaced every two to two-and-a-half months.

“When we take out the filter to replace it, we see how it's turned red-black. And it's expensive to keep doing so,” said Geeta.

She added that her 10-year-old son, who already has sensi-



tive skin, has developed drier skin on his hands and legs. “I can even see pimples on his face... My sister-in-law is a dermatologist and when I took my son to her, the first thing she asked me was about the water we're consuming,” she said. Geeta and her partner, both in their early 40s, are also experiencing hair loss. “We get throat infections very often...,” she claimed. The condition of the water has also made her reluctant to have guests over. “It is so embarrassing that I cannot keep my washroom clean. The water is so bad that

once you flush, you have to clean the commode seat again. If you don't, it gets damaged easily,” she said.

Behind the issue

Nandwani said residents used to receive Ganga water, but claimed the supply stopped more than two years ago.

“The builder of the project, which is currently undergoing insolvency, did not clear water dues of around Rs 42 lakh — it is now over Rs 72 lakh, including penalties,” he alleged.

“We are now dependent on borewell water. The processing plant in the society has a li-



The project is located in Sector 94, Noida; residents say water in the taps is yellowish-black, smells foul and has worms. EXPRESS



imited capacity to filter it,” he claimed.

Mudit Kapur, General Secretary of the Apartment Owners' Association, said his WhatsApp chats are filled with videos shared by families in the residents' group, showing worms in the water and buckets filled with black water.

“It is a health hazard for young children and senior citizens, or for anyone, since water is a basic necessity,” said Kapur. “We get a lot of complaints, but resolution will take time.”

Recently, the association raised its concerns before the

three-member committee appointed by the Supreme Court to oversee the Corporate Insolvency Resolution Process (CIRP) of M/s Supertech Realtors Pvt Ltd, which had been caught in a series of litigations by homebuyers.

Nandwani said, “The SNAOA is working closely with the committee to sort out the problems, including restoring Ganga water supply.”

Geeta, however, said she wished she had known about the water problem earlier. “I would have thought multiple times before buying the house,” she said.

•Skywatch



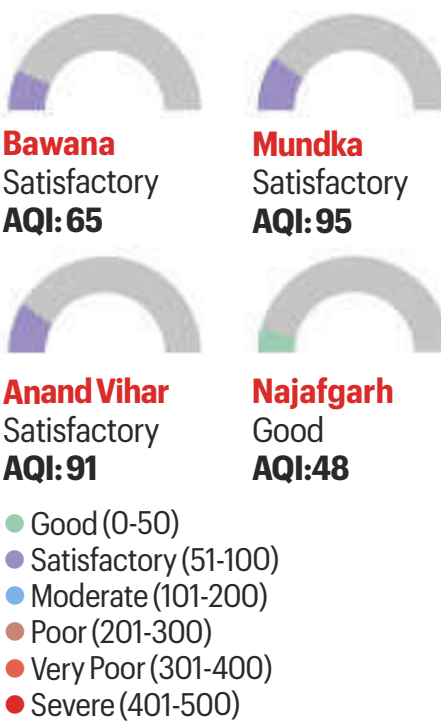
Forecast:
September 15, 2026
Generally cloudy sky. Very light to light rain.
MAX: 32-34
0.2°C above normal

MIN: 23-25

0.1°C below normal

• **Sunrise:** 6:06 AM (September 16)
• **Sunset:** 6:26 PM (September 15)
• **Moonrise:** 10:59 AM (September 16)
• **Moonset:** 8:43 PM (September 15)

•AQITracker



To mark PM's birthday, govt to launch projects worth Rs 13,820 crore

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 14

BLOOD DONATION camps, cleanliness drives, registration and health check-ups for workers, and outreach camps for government schemes are among a series of programmes the Delhi government and the BJP have planned to mark Prime Minister Narendra Modi's birthday on September 17.

The programmes will be held as part of a month-long “Seva Sankalp Abhiyan” campaign from September 17 to October 18, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and Delhi BJP president Harsh Mal-

hotra said on Monday. Gupta said development projects worth around Rs 13,820 crore will be inaugurated or have their foundation stones laid during the campaign, including around Rs 8,000 crore related to river Yamuna.

Officials said that the Delhi government will also organise a mega blood donation camp on September 17 with a target of collecting 2,500 units, while around 25,000 senior citizens will be provided health check-ups.

The Labour department will conduct health check-ups for workers, they added.





Clean Gesture

TO MARK Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 25 years in public service, the *Bharatiya Janata Yuva Morcha's* 'Seva Yatra' will add a new practice — 'Swachhita Se Swagat' — emanating from the PM's recent trip to Vadodara. Party insiders say the concept of cleanliness drives for days will also be rolled out at party events across the country. Scheduled between September 17 and October 7, the yatra will commence simultaneously from Vadnagar to Varanasi and vice versa and will see the participation of over 1,000 youth. It will pass through 20 routes named after sacred rivers and will cover 193 districts, 773 tehsils, and 1,159 villages across 10 states. The yatra has been conceptualised by BJP's Lok Sabha MP from Vadodara, Hemang Joshi, who heads the BJYM.

ED, Hindi

THE ENFORCEMENT Directorate has found an unlikely reason to celebrate. The agency's in-house Hindi magazine, *Pravartan Sandesh*, has won the second prize in Category-A of the Rajbhasha Kirti Puraskar, awarded by the Department of Official Language under the Home Ministry. It was presented in Mumbai on Monday during the 6th All-India Official Language Conference.

17 out of 20 TMC rebels to join BJP, claims MP Basunia; ruling party distances itself

Ravik Bhattacharya
Kolkata, September 14

REBEL TRINAMOL Congress (TMC) MP Jagadish Chandra Barma Basunia on Monday claimed that 17 of the 20 MPs who had broken away from the Opposition party and joined the Nationalist Citizens Party of India (NCPI) were ready to join the BJP before or after Durga Puja festivities.

The NCPI is a little-known outfit that rebel MPs joined in June before declaring their support for the BJP-led National Democratic Alliance.

However, other NCPI MPs said they were unaware of any such plan and Abu Taher Khan (Murshidabad) who is one of



Rebel TMC MP Jagadish Chandra Barma Basunia

the three Muslim MPs in the group along with Yusuf Pathan (Baharampur) and Khalilur Rehman (Jangipur) said they would neither join the BJP nor support the NDA.

"Who asked him (Basunia) to become our spokesperson? We have already spoken about our

stand. We do not need him to speak for us... We (the three MPs from the minority community) have made it clear that we will not support the NDA, and there is no question of joining the BJP," Khan told *The Indian Express*.

Plan ready: Basunia

Basunia told reporters in Cooch Behar, "We are 20 NCPI MPs now, of whom 17 will join the BJP soon. It will be before or after Durga Puja. The two-thirds figure will be around 14, but we are 17 and the anti-defection law will not apply to us."

"Three MPs — Khan, Pathan and Rehman — will remain in the NCPI and support the NDA. They will not join the BJP. They may be given (Cabinet) port-

folios. As they represent minority-dominated areas, they may face problems if they join the BJP," he added.

Basunia said the BJP had helped facilitate the group's move to the NCPI.

"We are not aware of any such issue. Basunia has to take responsibility for his own statement," BJP spokesperson Debjit Sarkar told reporters.

Basunia's remarks have seemingly sparked internal dissent within the BJP as well, with the party's Baranagar MLA, Sajal Ghosh, saying the entry of rebels "would be hard to accept".

Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar, one of the prominent faces of the rebel group, also declined to comment on Basunia's claim.

EXPRESS special

4th man in Modi-Xi-Putin photo: Techie-turned-IFS officer, a Mandarin expert

Shubhrajit Roy
New Delhi, September 14

AT 4.13 PM on Saturday, Prime Minister Narendra Modi shared on X a photograph that shows him holding the hands of Chinese President Xi Jinping and Russian President Vladimir Putin at the BRICS leaders' summit in New Delhi.

The photograph, which sent a message of cooperation among the three world leaders, has a fourth person in it. This Indian diplomat caught the attention of those watching photos and videos of the BRICS leaders' summit over the weekend.

He is 36-year-old Siddharth Babu, a 2017-batch Indian Foreign Service (IFS) officer. Babu ranked 15th in the country in the Union Public Service Commission's (UPSC) Civil Services Examination for entry to India's coveted government services.

Originally from Kaloar in Kerala's Kochi, he studied in Nava Nirman Senior Secondary School from 1995 to 2006, and completed Class 12 at Bhavan's Adarsha Vidyalaya in 2008.

Babu then studied mechanical engineering at Mar Athanasius College of Engineering, a government-aided engineering college in Kothamangalam in Kerala. He completed his BTech in 2012. He then worked for an e-commerce firm for more than two years before taking the plunge and starting preparations for the civil services entrance exam. He chose history and political science as subjects.

He couldn't clear the all-India examination in his first attempt. Then, in 2017, at the age of 26, he cleared the highly competitive exam with an All India Rank of 15 and opted for the Indian Foreign Service. After he entered the foreign



Siddharth Babu (second from left) is a 2017-batch IFS officer.

service, he studied Mandarin as a compulsory foreign language. Every IFS officer needs to learn at least one foreign language.

Babu chose Mandarin while at the Foreign Service Institute in Delhi, and underwent training in international relations, negotiations, conducting foreign policy, protocol and other relevant issues.

He lived in China for four years — 2018 to 2022 — where he learnt the language while working at the Indian embassy in Beijing. These were the years of the COVID-19 pandemic, which saw very tough lockdowns in China. Babu used his time well by studying Mandarin and China's history, politics, and economy.

He went on to complete a Master's course in translation and interpretation at the Middlebury Institute for International Studies in Monterey, California, in the US in 2022. He graduated in 2024.

In 2024, in a video on the Middlebury Institute's website, he gave his reasoning behind learning Mandarin: "Not many people in India understand China well and that's a difficult job. And many people in China

don't understand India," he said. "As diplomats, we act as bridges between cultures. I felt like that was something worthwhile to do in life. It's something that keeps you engaged."

Babu got a posting in Delhi at the Ministry of External Affairs in 2024, first as an Under Secretary. He is now a Deputy Secretary in the East Asia division in the Ministry of External Affairs. This division looks after India's relations with China, Japan, South and North Korea. So, his main diplomatic assignment is relations with these countries.

And whenever needed, he steps in for interpretation and translation for the Prime Minister and other key officials in the government. One thing he abhors, his friends and colleagues say, is the spotlight. A shy and always preferring to work in the shadows, and behind-the-scenes, he can't escape the new spotlight in this day and age of social media — as he has been seen behind PM Modi while he is chatting with some of the world leaders — from EU chief Ursula von der Leyen during Republic Day parade to President Xi during the BRICS summit.

Xi, Modi agreed both nations should be partners: Wang Yi

Divya A
New Delhi, September 14

A DAY after Chinese President Xi Jinping wound up his first visit to India in seven years, the Chinese foreign ministry said that Beijing will work with New Delhi to implement the "important common understandings reached between the two leaders".

"Prime Minister (Narendra) Modi has said India has an independent foreign policy...and that India will not allow any force to engage in anti-China activities on its territory. China values PM Modi's statements," China's Foreign Ministry spokesperson told reporters on Monday after the Modi-Xi meeting in New Delhi on Saturday evening on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit.

Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi said President Xi and PM Modi have reached the "most important consensus" during their meeting that China and India should be partners, said news agency *PTI*.

Summing up Xi's two-day visit to New Delhi to attend the 18th BRICS Summit and his meeting with PM Modi, Wang Yi said the two leaders held a

candid and in-depth exchange of views on strategic, long-term and directional issues concerning China-India relations, as per the *PTI* report.

President Xi said China and India can draw on each other's strengths, support one another, help each other succeed and pursue common development, according to Wang, who is also a member of the Political Bureau of the Communist Party of China Central Committee.

The two leaders agreed to jointly maintain peace and tranquility in border areas, while the two countries will support each other as rotating chair of the BRICS, Wang said, adding that the Modi-Xi meeting drew widespread international attention.

Following their meeting, PM Modi said that the talks marked the beginning of a new chapter in bilateral relations. New Delhi emphasised that future ties must be guided by mutual respect, mutual sensitivity and mutual interest, while reaffirming that differences should not become disputes.

As President Xi Jinping landed in New Delhi for the BRICS Summit on Saturday morning, China Southern Air-



'Most important consensus reached between the two leaders,' says Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi

lines announced the resumption of passenger services on the key Guangzhou-New Delhi route from September 21, after a six-year hiatus.

The developments come in the wake of a broader understanding between New Delhi and Beijing after the border agreement in October 2024. Direct air service between the two countries was suspended following the Covid-19 pandemic and tensions after the Doklam and Galwan standoffs; the Kailash Mansarovar Yatra had also resumed in 2024, post the border understanding.

The two sides had agreed on a number of steps towards eas-

ing tensions after the meeting between PM Modi and President Xi in September 2025. Earlier, they had met in Russia's Kazan in 2024. On Saturday, they held their third meeting since the breakthrough in ties.

The improvement in China-India relations has been welcomed by over 2.8 billion people of both nations, Wang said, adding that it represents an essential pillar of strengthening cooperation across the Global South.

He also said the border issue should be viewed in proper perspective within the broader context of the bilateral relationship. Wang said PM Modi offered a positive response, affirming that India has always approached India-China relations from a strategic standpoint.

They also agreed to support each other's BRICS chairmanship, strengthen coordination within multilateral frameworks, including the United Nations, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation, and the G20, advance cooperation across the Global South, promote a more multipolar world order, and serve as stabilising, progressive force in an era of global uncertainty, Wang said. China takes over as the BRICS chair for 2027.

Rahul-led review may trigger major rejig of Cong secretaries

Asad Rehman
New Delhi, September 14

THE CONGRESS is set to inject fresh blood into its organisation, with the party preparing for a major reshuffle of AICC secretaries and likely to replace around half of its existing secretaries. Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi and Congress general secretary Priyanka Gandhi Vadra have, along with AICC general secretary (organisation) K C Venugopal, interviewed around 130 probable candidates for the posts over the past week.

Sources in the Congress said the Gandhi siblings will meet the existing AICC secretaries on Tuesday to review their performance. The meeting is also likely to precede the reshuffle, with around 50% of the secretaries expected to be relieved of their duties.

The group interviews, which began on September 7 were conducted with dossiers on each candidate. The dossier, sources said, contained details of their work and performance in the party organisation.

The Congress currently has 64 AICC secretaries, most of whom are assigned to different states, where they work under the respective AICC general secretaries or in-charges to oversee and assist the functioning of the state units. Some are also posted in key party offices in Delhi, including those of



Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi and Congress MPs Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and K C Venugopal interviewed around 130 probable candidates for the posts over the past week. *PTI*

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge and Venugopal.

What the candidates were asked

A leader who appeared for the interview said candidates were interviewed in batches of 12-14, with the Gandhi siblings and Venugopal asking detailed questions about their work in the organisation.

"We were first asked to introduce ourselves in a minute or so. After that, Rahul ji, Priyanka ji and Venugopal ji asked us questions about our performance in the party. They asked us what we did in our roles, why we did things the way we did, how we contributed to the party, and where we fell short," the leader said.

Another leader who appeared for the interview said candidates were also asked to respond to hypothetical situ-

ations, including how they would revive the party in a state where it had performed poorly or where elections were due.

"They asked direct questions about how we would perform our duties if appointed as secretary of a particular state, and how we would deal with issues specific to that state. They also asked us about our past and told us to list the most remarkable performances in our political career," the leaders said.

Candidates were also questioned about the Sangathan Srijan Abhiyan, the organisational overhaul being undertaken by the Congress across the country.

"There are a handful of leaders, six or seven, who have been given new responsibilities in the last few weeks. They will obviously be relieved of their work as secretaries," an AICC source said.

• PARTIES HAVE EARLIER TOO PROMISED TO END THE CRISIS BUT THE ONLY REAL CHANGE HAS OCCURRED IN THE NATURE OF THE NARCOTICS TRADE ITSELF

Ahead of election, Punjab talks drugs again; its children are still paying the price



NORTHERN LIGHTS

BY MANRAJ GREWAL SHARMA

A WEEKLY DISPATCH ON POLITICS AND POWER SHIFTS IN PUNJAB, HARYANA AND HIMACHAL PRADESH

HOME ALONE, three children, hands interlaced, came down the stairs, fear etched on their faces. And as the youngest, barely seven, managed a scared smile, all my journalistic questions dissolved. That image remains my most enduring memory from a reporting assignment on drugs in Punjab in late 2024.

The house in Badshahpur village in Kapurthala belonged to a man recently out on bail in a case registered under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic

Substances (NDPS) Act, 1985. His wife was in prison; his teenage daughter had just been detained after a video of her allegedly selling drugs went viral. As dusk settled and the evening prayers wafted from a nearby gurdwara, the enormity of the crisis struck home. Children like these were the collateral damage. Drugs were devouring Punjab's future.

Last week, that future claimed another victim.

Gulzar Singh, a labourer from Sangrur, consumed Cephos tablets after allegedly being threatened by the local sarpanch and others for questioning a sitting minister about rampant drug abuse in the area. At home, his son, mostly skin and bones, told *The Indian Express* that he spent every paisa he earned as a daily-wage labourer on "chitta" (heroin). It was as easily available as "namak" (salt), he said.

When *Uda Punjab* was released in 2016, many in the state bristled at what they called an attempt to tarnish Punjab's image. That outrage has gradually given way to grim

acceptance. Today, words such as "chitta", "goliyan" (pills), and "sooiyan" (injectables) have become part of everyday language.

Veteran police officers trace the origins of the crisis to Punjab's geography and its proximity to the Golden Crescent, the major opium producing region spanning Afghanistan, Iran, and Pakistan. What began largely as a transit route for drugs gradually evolved into a far more entrenched narcotics economy, with narcotics and, increasingly, cheaper pharma drugs flooding local markets.

Chemists speak openly about the misuse of medicines meant for pain relief and neurological disorders. A Dehradun-based pharma company discontinued the production of a pill, locally known as the "ghodeyan wala capsule", after widespread allegations of its abuse.

Failed attempts

Successive governments have promised to rid Punjab of drugs, but to no avail. In 2014, the Shiromani Akali Dal-BJP government launched the first



Gulzar Singh's widow, Pal Kaur, and sons Sehbaz and Lakhwinder said they are yet to receive promised compensation and job

anti-drug campaign during its tenure. In 2017, Captain Amarinder Singh famously swore on a holy book to eradicate drugs within four weeks. The Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) government came to power in 2022 with Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann promising decisive results within a year, but to no avail.

In March 2025, Punjab Police launched Yuthi Nasheyan Virudh. The numbers are impressive on paper. Between March 1, 2025, and September

2, 2026, the police registered 59,293 FIRs under the NDPS Act, arrested 696 major traffickers, seized 3,757 kg of heroin and 62 lakh tablets, and recovered Rs 22 crore in drug money.

Taking a cue from Uttar Pradesh, Punjab also began attaching and demolishing properties allegedly built from drug proceeds. Yet voices on the ground insist the supply has not dried up: *chitta* is as easily available as *namak*.

Punjab Governor Gulab

Chand Kataria, who has walked with Mothers Against Drugs, cut through the noise with the sharpest observation yet: the drug trade "cannot survive even 10 days without the support of the police and administration".

That uncomfortable truth echoed in court this week. In an affidavit before the Punjab and Haryana High Court, the police admitted drugs are available inside prisons. Inmates registered for opioid treatment rose from 2,540 at the time of entry to 15,768. A shocked Chief Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra observed that addiction seems to have multiplied four to five times after incarceration.

The supply networks have only grown more sophisticated. Today, drones ferry drugs and weapons across Punjab's nearly 500-km international border. Despite anti-drone systems, this summer witnessed drones making deliveries even in daylight.

Floodwaters have created another route. During the 2023 floods, the police cracked a case involving a trafficker from Ja-

landhar who allegedly sent three swimmers across the Sutlej to retrieve 50 kg of heroin. The swimmers were reportedly paid between Rs 1 lakh and Rs 2.5 lakh for every kilo they ferried. Cops say such consignments became even larger during the floods last year.

Drugs a major poll issue

As expected, with the Assembly elections approaching, drugs are back at the centre of Punjab's political discourse.

In 2017, the AAP, then in Opposition, gained traction by making drug abuse one of its biggest campaign issues, with Mann ending rallies with his famous "kikli" (a ditty) to drive home the message against the Akali Dal led by the Badals.

Leaders of the Akali Dal (Waris Punjab De) made drugs the centrepiece of their speeches during the politically significant Rakhar Puniya rally a fortnight ago. Jailed MP Amritpal Singh had built much of his early popularity around promises of de-addiction centres in gurdwaras.

I had met several families at the gurdwara in his native village of Jallapur Khera who had arrived with drug-dependent relatives simply because they believed "Bhai Sahib" could reform them through faith and discipline.

The BJP, too, is preparing to make drug eradication a major poll plank. Its Nasha Mukti Yatras are scheduled to begin mid-September and culminate in a rally to be addressed by Union Home Minister Amit Shah, who had earlier declared at a Badlav rally in Moga that only his government could wipe out the menace.

Punjab has heard many such promises. The only real change has happened in the nature of the trade itself — more pharmaceutical, more aerial, more entrenched. The memory of those children walking down the stairs in Badshahpur still haunts me. They were not addicts. They were not accused. They were the real victims.

Manraj Grewal Sharma is National Editor, North, The Indian Express



ADVERTORIAL



Madhya Pradesh

A Trusted Partner for Global Investors





Investment Proposal worth over Rs.53000 Crore Received

Under the visionary leadership and guidance of Hon'ble Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Madhya Pradesh is steadily advancing towards becoming a leading engine of India's economic growth. With a clear vision of a developed and prosperous Madhya Pradesh, Chief Minister Dr. Mohan Yadav is steadfastly working to create an enabling environment for industries, attract large-scale investments and generate meaningful employment opportunities. From strengthening industrial infrastructure and promoting investor-friendly policies to actively engaging with global business leaders, the state government is leaving no stone unturned to unlock Madhya Pradesh's vast economic potential.

Dr. Yadav's visit to Dubai is another significant step in this direction—taking the state's investment story to the global stage, inviting international investors to explore the opportunities emerging across Madhya Pradesh and encouraging them to partner in its development journey. With the Global Investors Summit scheduled for January 2027, Madhya Pradesh is set to welcome investors from across the world and accelerate its journey of industrialisation, investment and employment-led growth.

Chief Minister Dr. Mohan Yadav's visit to Dubai from September 6 to 8 gave a new global dimension to Madhya Pradesh's investment strategy. He addressed the global investors and industry leaders at the AIM Congress 2026 in Dubai, presenting the state as a reliable, transparent and opportunity-rich destination for investment. Dr. Yadav positioned Madhya Pradesh not merely as an investment destination, but as a



long-term partner for global companies and investors.

Investor Confidence at the Centre of Government Policy

The State Government has introduced investor-friendly policies to provide comprehensive support and facilitation to investors, while taking every possible step to promote investment and encourage industrial development across sectors. It is committed to creating a conducive and business-friendly environment, ensuring seamless support and facilitation for investors throughout their journey in Madhya Pradesh.

Chief Minister said Madhya Pradesh is a "land of hope and boundless opportunities" and invited investors to explore the State's immense potential and contribute to its economic prosperity.

Government Will Go Beyond Policy, Wherever Required

Reinforcing the Government's commitment to investors, necessary concessions beyond the existing policies would be extended wherever required to facilitate investment.

The State Government has undertaken extensive reforms aimed at

simplifying the business environment, including the abolition of more than 2,700 rules and nearly 900 laws. These reforms are aimed at creating a business ecosystem where investors can take decisions with greater confidence and industries can establish and expand efficiently.

Investment proposals worth around Rs. 15 lakh crore are beginning to materialise on the ground, while Madhya Pradesh is recording exports of more than Rs. 76,000 crore. The state has also been making industrial land available within 29 days.

MP's Strategic Location Offers a Distinctive Advantage for Industry and Trade

Madhya Pradesh's geographical location gives it a distinctive advantage for industry and trade. Located at the heart of the country, state has strong connectivity with major markets through its road, rail and logistics networks. The Delhi-Mumbai Industrial Corridor, modern logistics infrastructure and access to major industrial and consumer centres further strengthen the State's investment proposition.

The State provides access to nearly 60 per cent of India's population within a 1,000-kilometre radius, making it an attractive location for manufacturing, logistics, warehousing, distribution and export-oriented industries.

Opportunities Across Traditional and Emerging Sectors

Madhya Pradesh offers vast investment opportunities across sectors, particularly food processing, agricultural value chains, textiles, automobiles, engineering, pharmaceuticals and advanced manufacturing. In textiles, the state is combining its rich heritage of Chanderi and Maheshwari with modern textile manufacturing. CM also emphasised on emerging opportunities in telecommunications, optical fibre, electronics, digital manufacturing and green energy, positioning Madhya Pradesh for future-ready industrial growth.

Dubai: Strengthening India-UAE Economic Partnership

The Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) has opened new opportunities in trade, investment, logistics and digital cooperation. Madhya Pradesh is seeking to strengthen its

economic engagement with the UAE and leverage Dubai's position as a gateway to the Middle East, Africa and Europe.

From Madhya Pradesh to Global Markets

Alongside investment promotion, the Dubai visit showcased Madhya Pradesh's local products and cultural heritage before an international audience. ODOP and GI products including Chanderi sarees, Maheshwari sarees, Ujjain Batik, Bhopal Zari-Zardozi, Betul bell-metal craft and Gwalior carpets were showcased, highlighting the State's potential in handicrafts, textiles, exports and creative industries.

Strengthening Ties with the Arab World



A meeting with Arab Parliament President Mohammed Ahmed Al Yamahi explored opportunities for cooperation between Arab countries and Madhya Pradesh in trade, investment, agriculture, tourism and education. Investment opportunities in renewable energy, pharmaceuticals, medical devices, textiles, logistics, advanced manufacturing and urban infrastructure were highlighted, along with an invitation to the Arab business delegation to visit Madhya Pradesh and participate in the Global Investors Summit-2027.

Dubai outreach gives fresh momentum to Madhya Pradesh's investment drive

During his Dubai visit Chief Minister Dr. Mohan Yadav held a series of one-to-one meetings with leading UAE investors and global business groups which generated strong interest among international investors, fetching investment proposals worth more than Rs. 53,000 crore. The growing response reflects the expanding investment opportunities available in Madhya Pradesh and the State's readiness to attract investment in both established industries and future-oriented sectors.

Madhya Pradesh-Tatarstan Partnership: New Avenues for Investment



A bilateral meeting was held with H.E. Rustam Minnikhanov, Rais (Head) of the Republic of Tatarstan, Russian Federation, to strengthen trade and investment cooperation. Tatarstan welcomed the invitation to participate in Global Investors Summit-2027 with a strong investor delegation.

Discussions covered advanced manufacturing, petrochemicals, food processing, engineering, logistics, agriculture, skill development and technology, with focus on joint projects and long-term B2B and G2G partnerships. Tatarstan also invited Dr. Yadav and the MP business delegation to the TIME: Russia-India Forum.

Madhya Pradesh-UAE Investment Round Table To Review First Progress Within Three Months

A meeting with H.E. Dr. Thani bin Ahmed Al Zeyoudi, UAE Minister of State for Foreign Trade, focused on expanding non-oil trade, advanced technologies, supply chains and cross-border investment under the India-UAE CEPA. The UAE Minister was also invited to participate in the Global Investors Summit-2027 in Madhya Pradesh.

The two sides agreed to identify 5-10 implementation-ready projects and establish a joint review mechanism. A Madhya Pradesh-UAE Investment Round Table will be organised, with dedicated nodal officers for selected projects and the first progress review within three months.

World Bank to fund for AI Projects in MP

During AIM Congress-2026, discussions with Mr. Sangbu Kim, World Bank Vice President for Digital and AI, focused on Madhya Pradesh's digital and technological expansion. The World Bank expressed interest in providing funding and financial support for AI and digital governance projects under the State Government's initiatives.

UAE to Expand Aviation Operations Between The Two Regions



Meeting with H.E. Abdulla bin Touq Al Marri, UAE Cabinet Member and Minister of Economy and Tourism, focused on investment opportunities in Madhya Pradesh. He was invited to participate in the Global Investors Summit-2027. The UAE Minister assured that a Dubai investment delegation would soon visit Madhya Pradesh to explore opportunities in the hotel and hospitality sectors.

Discussions also covered mining, textiles, forestry, tourism and aviation, with assurance of cooperation to expand air connectivity, boosting tourism, cargo movement and business travel between Madhya Pradesh and the UAE. Chief Minister Dr. Yadav highlighted key provisions of the state's new aviation policy. Mr. H. E. Abdulla bin Touq Al Marri, who also serves as Chairman of the UAE General Civil Aviation Authority, assured full cooperation in expanding aviation operations between the two regions.

Hatta Economic Zone and Dubai Future Foundation Models To Be Set Up in MP

Chief Minister Dr. Yadav sought detailed information on the UAE's Hatta Economic Zone Development Project and its model for developing specialised industrial parks highlighting the state's on going efforts to develop modern industrial clusters and special economic zones. In addition, H.E. Al Marri, in his capacity as CEO of the Dubai Future Foundation, assured technical and strategic cooperation to explore the possibility of establishing a similar foundation focused on innovation and future-oriented initiatives in Madhya Pradesh.

CM Dr. Yadav Meets President of Ethiopia



Discussions with H.E. Taye Atske Selassie, President of Ethiopia, focused on strengthening India-Ethiopia trade and investment ties. Opportunities in agriculture, food processing, textiles, pharmaceuticals, manufacturing, lo-

gistics, energy and technology were highlighted, with Ethiopian businesses invited to invest in Madhya Pradesh and participate in the Global Investors Summit-2027.

CM Dr. Yadav Meets Ruler of Ras Al Khaimah

A high level meeting with H.H. Sheikh Saud bin Saqr Al Qasimi, Ruler of Ras Al Khaimah, focused on strengthening investment and industrial cooperation. Key opportunities in ceramics, construction materials, pharmaceuticals, tourism, food processing, logistics and renewable energy were explored, along with measures to facilitate investors and expand market access.

Green Partnership with BEEAH



Chief Minister Dr. Mohan Yadav visited BEEAH headquarters in Sharjah and held a meeting with Group CEO and Vice-Chairman Khalid Al Huraimel. Discussions focussed on partnerships in waste management, waste-to-energy, circular economy, green mobility and smart-city solutions. Highlighting Indore's successful solid-waste management and Bio-CNG model, he invited BEEAH to explore investment and technology opportunities in Madhya Pradesh and participate in Global Investors Summit-2027.

MP-UAE, To Strengthen Trade & Investment Ties



Engagements with Shri Abdulla Sultan Al Owais, Chairman of the Sharjah Chamber of Commerce and Industry and Expo Centre Sharjah, focused on strengthening trade and investment ties. Key sectors including food processing, logistics, textiles, pharmaceuticals, renewable energy and tourism were discussed.

The Chamber was invited to lead a business delegation to Madhya Pradesh, while a Madhya Pradesh-Sharjah Business Forum was proposed to facilitate sector-specific B2B engagements. Sharjah-based companies were also encouraged to invest in Madhya Pradesh and participate in the Global Investors Summit-2027.

Better Logistics to Connect MP's Products with Global Markets: CM Dr. Yadav

Innovation, Green Energy and Technology to Drive New Investment and Employment Opportunities

Chief Minister Dr. Mohan Yadav showcased Madhya Pradesh's strategic location, robust infrastructure, connectivity, skilled workforce and investor-friendly policies, emphasising on strengthening logistics, warehousing and multimodal connectivity to reduce costs and connect Madhya Pradesh's products with global markets and generate employment.

Meetings with Crescent Enterprises, DP World, Rana Holdings, GEMS Education, BeauMerc Corporation, Sharaf Group, VFS Global and Choithrams explored opportunities in logistics, smart manufacturing, data centres, green energy, e-mobility, education, infrastructure, technology and modern retail.

Powarkheda to be Developed as a Major Gateway for Inland Logistics



During the discussions with Mr. Rizwan Soomar, CEO of DP World, CM Dr. Yadav highlighted the potential of the Powarkheda Logistics Composite Hub as a major inland logistics gateway and proposed expanding multimodal logistics, warehousing and cold-chain facilities.

He also emphasised technology-driven entrepreneurship, startups and innovation in energy and technology sectors. He said that efficient rail-based freight movement would help reduce logistics costs and transportation time while providing farmers, Farmer Producer Organisations (FPOs), MSMEs and industries with facilities for cargo consolidation, value addition and export support. This will help connect products from Madhya Pradesh with global markets and create more employment opportunities.

Investment in Smart Manufacturing, Data Centres, Green Energy and e-Mobility



A meeting with Dr. Darshan Singh Rana, Chairman and Managing Director of Rana Holdings Limited, focused on opportunities in smart manufacturing, data centres, green energy, green hydrogen, e-mobility and agricultural machinery.

International-Standard K-12 School Campuses to be Established in Major Cities of MP

Innovations in Madhya Pradesh's education sector and investment opportunities in the state were discussed during a meeting with Shri Sunny Varkey, Chairman and Founder of GEMS Education. The company expressed interest in establishing international-standard K-12 school campuses in major and emerging cities across Madhya Pradesh.

GIS-2027 invitation extended to more than 20 countries in the Middle East and Africa: Through the Arab Parliament, parliamentary leadership from countries including Algeria, Bahrain, Egypt, Iraq, Jordan, Kuwait, Morocco, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia and the UAE was invited to visit Madhya Pradesh.

BeauMerc Corporation Keen to Invest in Madhya Pradesh

During the meeting, Mr. Siddharth Balachandran, Executive Chairman and CEO of BeauMerc Corporation Limited, expressed interest in investing in several sectors, including infrastructure, healthcare, technology and green energy.

Sharaf Group Keen to Establish Operations and Facilities in Madhya Pradesh

Discussions with Shri Shyam Kapoor, President and CEO of Sharaf Group, included a proposal to establish a logistics park with rail siding facilities in Madhya Pradesh, involving a proposed investment of approximately US\$30 million to US\$50 million. The project is expected to generate employ-



The meeting also focused on developing multimodal logistics parks, modern warehousing facilities and regional distribution centres.

Visa Services to be Expanded in Bhopal and Indore

An interaction with Shri Amit Seicher, Global Head of VFS Global, covered investment, employment, accessibility of visa services, tourism and skill development for youth in the state. Dr. Yadav encouraged VFS Global to expand its visa application services in Bhopal and Indore and strengthen its regional reach.

Choithrams Keen to Establish Supermarkets and Modern Grocery Retail Centres



Discussions with Mr. L.T. Pagnani, Chairman of Choithrams, a leading multinational group in the supermarket, distribution and manufacturing sectors, focused on potential investment opportunities in Madhya Pradesh. The group expressed interest in establishing supermarkets and modern grocery retail outlets in major cities across the state.

Public trust & public approval not same; trust demands fairness: CJI

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, September 14

CHIEF JUSTICE of India Surya Kant on Monday said that public trust in the judiciary is not the same as public approval, as trust is not earned by giving outcomes people want but by ensuring fairness of process. He also emphasised that the courts should “remain willing to be examined, questioned and, where necessary, criticised”.

The CJI was delivering the keynote address at the 6th Ram Jethmalani Memorial Lecture in Delhi on Monday on the topic — ‘Justice seen to be done: Transparency and public trust as pillars of the legal system’.

Responding to concerns by other speakers, Senior Advocates Harish Salve and Mahesh Jethmalani, about the need for administrative reforms that the judiciary needs to carry out to address challenges like the appointment of judges, etc., the CJI said reform must be the rule and no institution can survive or take pride in remaining static.

“But then there are issues that may not be prudent to respond to from a public platform. I have legal answers to those questions in the historical background of how the Collegium system has been developed and how successfully it has worked...,” the CJI said. He added that “there is hardly any impediment between the appointments by



Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, Union Law Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal and Senior Advocate Mahesh Jethmalani at the 6th Ram Jethmalani Memorial Lecture in New Delhi on Monday. ANIL SHARMA

the Union of India on the recommendations of the Collegium, that itself speaks what kind of deliberations take place and how ultimately the final recommendations are made. But at the same time, as I already said, reform is a welcome step.”

On administrative reforms to deal with complaints against judges, he said, “As CJI, I can say with full confidence that the mechanism (which) the Supreme Court and High Courts have developed is ... robust, responsive and very timely.”

Flagging possible misuse, he said that “given a choice, a judicial officer, when he passes an interlocutory order, or adjourns a case or passes a final decree, at every stage he will invite a com-

plaint. I will leave it to the public domain, and it is a very seriously debatable issue whether every such complaint should be brought on a (public) platform or a website or you need... an internal very strong mechanism which must with complete objectivity, dispassionate approach and in a very responsible manner ... deal with it. I can assure that such a mechanism is well established, but it is always subject to reforms and qualitative improvements.”

Transparency for a court, the CJI said, is not simply a matter of open doors and public hearings, though it certainly includes those things. “It means that the reasoning behind a decision, and not merely its result, can be

examined by anyone who cares to look, including the very people the decision goes against. A court that announces its verdicts but keeps its reasoning to itself has not really been transparent, whatever else it may have done,” he said.

Pointing out that public trust is not the same thing as public approval, the CJI said the “difference matters a great deal”. A court, the CJI said, “does not earn trust by being liked, or by handing out the outcomes people wanted. It earns trust when the people who lost, who wanted an entirely different result, still walk away believing that the process which decided against them was fair. That is a far harder thing to earn than ap-

proval, and far more valuable”.

CJI Kant recalled that late Justice Krishna Iyer “knew that institutions do not stay clean by being shielded from scrutiny. They stay clean by being repeatedly exposed to it, and by repeatedly surviving that exposure”. The CJI pointed out that in the suo motu proceedings concerning NCERT textbook, which contained a chapter on corruption in the judiciary, it was an occasion to consider the relationship between legitimate criticism and public confidence in the institution. “In our order, we reiterated that the judiciary, as an institution, is not, and cannot be, averse to criticism... This lies at the heart of transparency itself, for a court cannot seek the confidence of the public by placing itself beyond scrutiny; it must remain willing to be examined, questioned and, where necessary, criticised,” CJI Kant said.

He underscored that public trust, for the judiciary, is “not decoration. It is, in fact, the only currency that authority is ever paid in, the only coin the judiciary has ever truly held.”

“Transparency matters because it is what makes trust possible to earn in the first place. ‘Seen to be done’ means a fair hearing conducted honestly in the open, and it means, just as much, a system that remains willing to be examined, again and again, on whether it has kept its own word,” the CJI said.

Bengal rescinds order allowing Akshaya Patra to serve midday meals in 4 dists

Attri Mitra
Kolkata, September 14

THREE WEEKS after giving Akshaya Patra Foundation, an NGO linked to ISKCON, the responsibility of providing midday meal to schools in four districts — Howrah, Purulia, North 24 Parganas and Purba Medinipur — the BJP government in West Bengal has rescinded the order.

A September 11 notification, issued by Paromita Roy, Joint Secretary, State Education Department, to its officials in the four districts, read: “In accordance with the decision taken by the competent authority, I am directed to withdraw the approval of the Akshaya Patra Foundation vide memo No. 284-ES(PMP)/Genl-09/2026 dated 21.08.2026 for providing midday meal under PM-POSHAN in the areas as mentioned in the said Memo. No further action on this may be taken.”

In one of the first decisions taken by the BJP government after the party came to power in the state, it was decided to hand over the responsibility of providing midday meals to schools in the Kolkata Municipal Corporation area to ISKCON — the International Society for Krishna Consciousness.

However, the decision ran into controversy over providing vegetarian meals to students. Since August, Annamrita Foundation has been providing midday meals to about 500 schools in Kolkata under the PM-Poshan.

On August 1, CM Suwendu Adhikari launched the new meal menu by performing a yajna. However, as the government faced criticism over providing vegetarian food to growing kids, it decided to provide eggs separately to the students.

• BRIEFLY



A bus stuck in a waterlogged road after heavy rain in Ahmedabad on Monday. ANI

GUJARAT

Heavy rain batters parts of the state; IMD issues red alert for 8 districts

TORRENTIAL RAINS lashed several parts of Gujarat on Monday, inundating roads and flooding underpasses with the weather department issuing a red alert for eight districts, predicting more heavy showers. Central Gujarat faced the brunt with Borsad taluka in Anand logging 138 mm and Dholka in Ahmedabad district recording 102 mm between 6 am and 2 pm, the State Emergency Operation Centre said. Ahmedabad city recorded 84 mm of rain leaving low-lying residential areas inundated and severely affecting visibility for commuters. Authorities have deployed 38 NDRF and SDRF teams in vulnerable districts as a precautionary measure. Weather conditions are expected to improve on Tuesday. PTI

Lightning strike kills two, injures one in UP's Ballia

TWO YOUTHS were killed and another injured after lightning struck a tree under which they had taken shelter from heavy rain in Ballia district on Monday, police said. The incident took place in Kasonder village under the Bhimpura police station area in the afternoon, they said. Ranjit Kumar (33) and Anurag Kumar (24) died on spot, while Chhotu Kumar (32) sustained burn injuries. Chhotu is getting treated at a private hospital, police said. SHO Ranjit Vishwakarma said bodies of the deceased were sent for a post-mortem examination. PTI

2 Bihar workers die of suffocation in a septic tank

TWO LABOURERS died of asphyxiation while they were removing shuttering from a newly constructed septic tank in Bihar's Muzaffarpur district on Monday, officials said. It occurred in the Sikandarpur police station area of the district. The deceased have been identified as Sonu Kumar and Mohammad Jahangir. Shuttering is a temporary mold or casing used to hold and shape wet concrete. Police are investigating the case from all angles to examine whether there was any breach of safety protocols, Muzaffarpur SDPO-1 said. PTI

EXPRESS special

Experts back warnings for high level of each nutrient — not just fats, sugar, or salt content

They add that black and white designs are better as ‘they are harder to visually mask on colourful packaging’

Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, September 14

EVEN AS the Supreme Court is looking into a petition to implement mandatory front-of-pack labels on foods high in fats, sugar, or salt, global experts say such warnings should be triggered even if a food has high levels of a single nutrient. This is also what the country's food safety regulator, the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI), has proposed for the second phase of implementing food labelling.

This view is also supported by the ICMR (Indian Council of Medical Research)-NIN (National Institute of Nutrition), whose Dietary Guidelines for Indians-2024 have been used as reference for deciding the nutrient thresholds for triggering the warning. The global experts are affiliated with organisations such as International Food Policy Research Institute, Harvard Medical School, Johns Hopkins University, National Institute of Public Health Mexico, University of Chile, University of

Sydney, among others.

These experts have appreciated the FSSAI's move to implement the red hexagonal warning label on the front of packaged food items, stating “warning labels are the only (type of) label that has real-world evidence of impact, including shifting consumer beliefs and behaviours, improving the nutritional profile of the food supply, and improving the healthfulness of purchases and dietary intake”.

They have given two important suggestions: One, the warning label should be triggered for each nutrient, meaning if a food is high in salt and fat, it should carry red hexagons stating so. Their statement said: “Multiple warning labels help signal overall product healthfulness: Evidence from Chile shows that consumers understand that products with more warning labels are less healthy than products with fewer or no warnings.”

Two, they have suggested that the warning use black hexagonal boxes instead of a red one, or mandate that the red



Experts have appreciated the FSSAI's move to implement the red hexagonal warning label on the front of packaged food items

ones are put on a white background. “A fixed, contrasting background prevents warnings from being visually absorbed into packaging: Colour-based labelling systems can also be less noticeable if they are placed over background packaging of a similar colour ... Without such a requirement, a coloured warning risks blending into similarly coloured packaging or being visually minimised through surrounding graphic elements, undermining the label's core purpose of rapid, at-a-glance identification.”

They added that black and white designs are better as “they are harder to visually mask on colourful packaging”.

A letter from the NIN director to the CEO of FSSAI has also made some important suggestions. The institute has recommended that the thresholds for identifying foods high in fats, sugars and salt be based on the total energy density of the food. “Therefore, the added fat and added-sugar cut-offs should ideally not be considered in isolation from the accompanying energy and total nutrient considerations,” it says. This is important considering that FSSAI in its affidavit to the court said that the warning labels would be triggered based on the levels of added sugars and added fats in the food items.

The institute also said that

the warnings should be triggered by a single nutrient as well because it “may result in products substantially high in a single nutrient escaping consumer attention”, the letter says. The FSSAI has proposed that the warnings be triggered only when a food is high in two of the three nutrients in the first phase of implementation, followed by each nutrient in the second phase.

Three, NIN has proposed using higher thresholds for a phased manner of implementation. Its letter states: “If phased implementation is considered necessary for operational reasons, a time-bound transition with higher thresholds than recommended by us, which can be progressively lowered in phases to align with the thresholds, may also be considered, allowing adequate opportunity for product reformulation while avoiding indefinite postponement.”

The Supreme Court has asked FSSAI for a scientifically justified and clearly defined timeline for the implementation of the second phase, without which, the court said, the implementation may take a backseat or be indefinitely postponed. It also sought clarity on which sweetened beverages will receive the warning in the first phase.

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, September 14

SAHARANPUR POLICE has arrested five members of an alleged counterfeit coin syndicate that manufactured and circulated fake Rs 20 coins with a face value of more than Rs 70 crore in the market.

The accused were caught in the Titron area of Saharanpur on Sunday while allegedly transporting machinery to set up a new unit in the district. Police said the gang allegedly operated across UP, Punjab and Bihar.

“It claimed to have the capacity to produce 10,000 to 12,000 counterfeit coins a day using the machines. These coins were then circulated through liquor shops, toll plazas and grocery stores on a commission basis, with liquor shops reportedly being the gang's primary market,” said Saharanpur SSP Abhinandan.

Police claimed to have recovered 6,400 counterfeit Rs 20 coins, with a face value of Rs 1.28 lakh, semi-finished coins esti-



The seized consignment of counterfeit coins. @SAHARANPURPOL

mated to be worth around Rs 5 lakh, and six coin-making machines.

Among the five arrested is the alleged kingpin, Upkar Luthra alias Abhay Pratap Singh. Police said Luthra, in his 50s, is a former goldsmith from Mohali, and has been involved in the counterfeit coin trade since 2001. He was arrested by Delhi Police in 2017 after a Rs 1 lakh reward was announced for information leading to his capture.

The other four are Himanshu alias Gullu of Saharanpur; Kuldeep of Muzaffarnagar; Anurag Pal alias Lankesh of Bhadohi; and Santosh Chaurasia alias Janardan of Bihar. They

are aged between 30 and 40.

The arrests come days after counterfeit currency worth Rs 17.29 crore was recovered from the currency chest of a nationalised bank in the district. The recovery is being probed by the NIA, which has arrested one person so far.

A police officer said the gang had earlier operated a counterfeit coin manufacturing unit in Haryana and was now planning to shift its operations to Saharanpur.

Police said the eight members had been assigned different roles within the network. While some were responsible for arranging machinery and overseeing production, others supplied the finished coins to agents and handled their circulation in the market.

Police said Upkar met Himanshu alias Gullu in Tihar Jail, and that their meeting eventually laid the foundation for the network. Other members allegedly joined the network later after meeting the two in different jails, police said.

• A CLOTHING BRAND STARTED BY THE KERALAM NUNS, WHO FACED BOYCOTT FOR TAKING ON FORMER JALANDHAR BISHOP FRANCO MULAKKAL, IS A TESTAMENT TO THEIR RESILIENCE

Ostracised by congregation, three nuns rebuild their lives, one stitch at a time

Nikhila Henry
Kochi, September 14

AMONG THE scattering of buildings that make this sprawling premises in Keralam's Kottayam district is a chapel. Right next to it is a corridor where three women are working at their sewing machines. They make elegant, comfortable dresses and functional sling and tote bags — all customised to the wishes of their patrons. Embroidery seems to be their specialty as is evident in the modest and dainty nightgowns put up on mannequins.

It could be a humble boutique running out of a home. Except, this is not just about any home. The women behind the sewing machines are no ordinary women either.

A blue signboard next to the Pala-Vaikkom state highway announces the St Francis Mission Home. It is this premises, ac-

cessed by a steep, narrow lane, at Kuravilangad village which has been the home of Sister Ranit MJ, Sister Alphya and Sister Ancitta for decades. For the last eight years, it is all that their world has been confined to.

In 2018, Sr Ranit lodged a rape police complaint against the then Bishop of Jalandhar, Franco Mulakkal. The Home is affiliated to this congregation.

In 2022, a trial court acquitted Mulakkal on the grounds that there was lack of proof and inconsistencies in the survivor's statements. Sr Ranit, who moved the High Court against the acquittal, is awaiting a hearing.

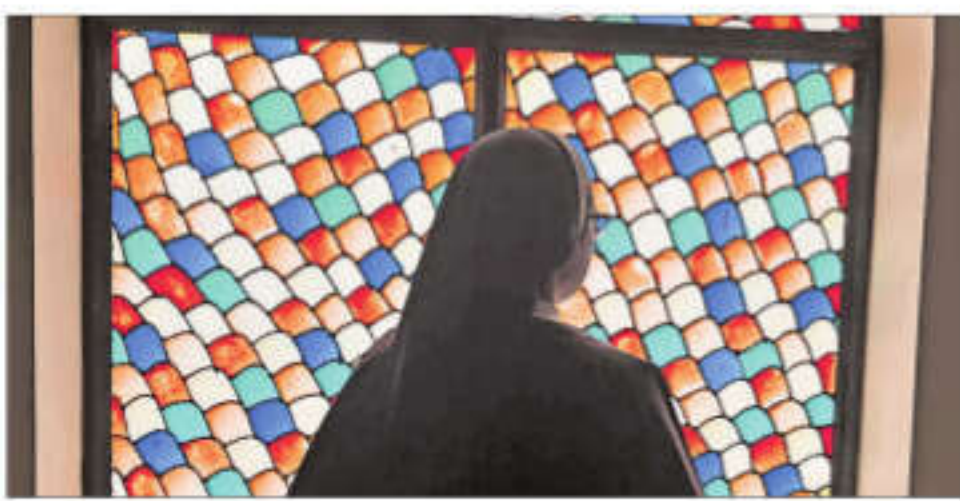
“Many people think the case is finished, that I have left this place. But the fight is not over. I don't want to hide anymore. I want to be seen and heard... All these years, I stayed a victim. Now I am a survivor,” says Sr Ranit, insisting on being ident-

ified by her name.

Ostracised by their congregation — Sr Alphya and Sr Ancitta paid the price of standing by Sr Ranit — and left with no sustenance, the women decided to stitch clothes for a living. In 2023, their clothing brand ‘Stand By Me’ was born.

On how the venture began, Sr Ranit says they would often get calls from Sisters in Solidarity — a loose collective of nuns, former nuns, ally priests, and other victims of sexual violence that was formed in 2018, the year she began her fight. “They would ask us, ‘Are you still weeping?’ Why don't you do some stitching and keep yourself engaged? It started as a distraction, the stitching...” she says.

But soon, the so-called distraction took the shape of necessity as the trio stopped getting sustenance funds from their congregation and had to look for ways to fend for them-



Sr Ranit at St Francis Mission Home in Kottayam; the clothing brand started by the Kuruvilangad sisters.

selves. “We had one sewing machine at first. Then some well wishers asked what we needed to go on. We said we would like another sewing machine,” Sr Ranit tells *The Indian Express*. Now, the sisters have five regular machines, another for embroidery, and one exclusively dedicated to lock-stitching.

Sitting in her convent, Sr Ranit says the name ‘Stand by Me’ was a brainchild of the

Sisters in Solidarity group. “They said that they would stand by us. That they are with us. So ‘Stand by Me’ seemed to be the right name for the clothing which we were stitching,” Sr Ranit says. “It would be about standing by every person who has suffered gender-based violence. It was the name closest to the cause we believed in and we stood for.”

Coincidentally, Stand by Me is a popular song of 1962 by black



American singer Ben E King.

The brand developed as the sisters went along. “We just wanted to stitch something. Then customers gave us suggestions. Like someone said there should be a laptop sleeve for the bag that she wanted us to stitch. We heard everyone out, all the customers, and came up with nighties, salwar kameez and bags which were custom-made.”

The raw material came from

their well wishers. “There were several people who brought us raw material for stitching. We even went searching for them ourselves,” says Sr Ranit.

Besides the clothing brand, the sisters grow their own vegetables and rear poultry. “We are supposed to get Rs 5,000 per month (from the congregation) as support funds, but we have not been getting it. So, we decided to grow vegetables, sew... do everything we can to keep the Home going,” says Sr Ranit.

A brand, a movement

Stand By Me has become a movement in Keralam. “In Kozhikode when we first announced that Stand By Me brand was made by Kuruvilangad sisters, a lot of people came forward to support us,” Sr Ranit says. Last month, they sold 60 bags of three different kinds in a month and as many sets of nighties.

Sr Ranit gives the credit to

teamwork. “This all came from one person cutting the cloth, another stitching and another embroidering. In one sitting by ourselves, we would only be able to stitch just 7 to 8 pieces,” the nun says. The next exhibition could be even better, says Sr Ranit. The sisters will put up their wear at Nirangal, an annual event held by the Kasturba Social Welfare Centre, Kottayam, on October 9 and 10.

They are earning “enough to get by”, the sisters say when asked about profits.

But what troubles the nuns is sudden expenditures which come with the territory of leading a secluded life. “Sometimes, things just don't work. A water pumping motor conking off sets us back by Rs 2,000. We are still struggling to meet such expenditure,” says Sr Ranit. But they do not want charity, the sisters make it clear. “We just want to live, our heads held high,” says Sr Ranit.

2 held over bomb threat to BRICS partners, PMO: Gujarat Police

Ahmedabad: An email sent to the Gujarat government on September 10 contained a bomb attack threat against the Gujarat Vidhan Sabha, the offices of the Prime Minister and Union Home Minister in New Delhi, and in countries participating in the BRICS Summit.

The police tracked the location to Bhagalpur, Bihar. They picked up two suspects, one who belongs to Bihar, and other to Jharkhand. Police said the suspects allegedly received funds from unknown persons in Bangladesh to send threats.

According to police, interrogation of the accused led to the recovery of a list of 5,13,847 email IDs, and corresponding passwords. The IDs to send threatening emails to government offices and for cyber-crimes and other illegal activities, the CCoE alleged. The police claimed the payment was done in cryptocurrency, and had found evidence of these payments in messages. ENS

Chandrayaan-1 may have just detected oldest impact basin on Moon: Researchers

Anjali Marar
Bengaluru, September 14

FOR THE first time, planetary scientists have confirmed the existence of a hidden impact crater on the lunar surface using mineralogical data obtained from Chandrayaan-1 and it could predate the oldest known impact craters on the Moon.

A team of researchers from the Physical Research Laboratory (PRL), Ahmedabad, have identified the Australe Basin, which had remained untraced as this ancient basin had suffered erosion along its rims making it extremely difficult even for modern-day imaging techniques to detect.

Scientists believe there are approximately 300 impact basins present on the Moon. Of these, only 74 have been detected so far. Impact basins are formed over the lunar surface due to various violent space activities, like asteroid or meteorite hits. These are large craters, often several hundreds of kilo-

metres in diameters, and can have distinct outer rims. Due to the space hits, these craters are often found with remnants of volcanic activities.

This new study, published in the *The Planetary Science Journal*, has shed light on one such impact basin confirmed to be located along the southeastern hemisphere of the Moon. It has distinct morphology and gravity signatures and some unique mineralogical compositions.

PRL scientists are also of the opinion that this basin could well be older than the South Pole Aitken Basin which is the largest and the oldest known basin on the Moon (formed over 4 billion years ago).

Speaking with *The Indian Express*, Neha Panwar, planetary scientist and lead author of the study, said, “The volcanism inside the Australe Basin has a very unique mineralogy. Unlike the majority of basalts on the Moon that are high in calcium bearing, these basalts are relatively lower in calcium



The red ring represents the Australe Basin. PRL

and higher in magnesium.”

Moreover, the Australe Basin was found to be in a province characterized by 248 small basalt ponds arranged in a circular pattern unlike several of the previously known impact basins that are classified for their smooth and vast hardened lava surfaces.

There were 11 scientific payloads onboard the Chandrayaan-1. Of these, six were contributions from international space agencies including

National Aeronautics Space Administration (NASA) and the European Space Agency.

The mineralogy of the Australe Basin was detected using data gathered by the Moon Mineralogy Mapper of NASA.

It is an imaging spectrometer that was designed to create mineralogical map of the lunar surface. It operates between 405 and 3000 nanometer wavelength range.

Scientists studied the absorption bands exhibited by some of the key lunar minerals, such as pyroxenes, olivine, and plagioclase.

The current study could offer detailed mineralogical insights of the region, particularly given the renewed interests shown by many countries with the proposed Moon Base mission by NASA and India's Chandrayaan-4, a lunar sample return mission.

“This study provides us with a framework to interpret the data from the landing missions in the broader geological context, by studying the regions that

could have contributed material to these landing sites. Such unique sites can be important targets for the future sample return missions,” she said.

PRL scientists noted that even the Chandrayaan-3 landing site, now known as the Shiv Shakti point, possessed higher concentrations of magnesium. And that could be linked to some material originally from the South Pole Aitken Basin to have gotten transported to the Shiv Shakti point, located approximately 350 km apart.

“Interestingly, what we found was that the Australe region, too, has widespread Magnesium-bearing lithologies. Since the region lies close to the moon's South Polar region, it is likely that the material excavated by this impact would also have been deposited across the South Pole. With the future missions planned in the South Polar Region, it is important to understand how the regolith in these regions has evolved over billions of years,” she explained.

3 Italians fly out skipping immigration, AI gets notice

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, September 14

THREE ITALIAN nationals travelled from Delhi to Munich without going through immigration at the Delhi airport on September 4. The incident prompted the Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA) to issue a show-cause notice to Air India, said sources.

The three passengers had taken an Air India “hub-and-spoke” flight on the night of September 3 from Amritsar to Delhi, after which they boarded a Lufthansa flight to Munich early on September 4 without going through immigration.

Given the serious nature of the lapse, Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan is likely to soon hold a meeting with stakeholders, including top officials at MoCA, Bureau of Immigration, Air India and airport operator Delhi International Airport.

Under the hub-and-spoke arrangement, also known as ‘Easy Connect’, Air India passengers flying overseas via Delhi from select domestic airports can clear immigration at the origin airport, and then take the Air India international flight from the Delhi airport without having to go through immigration.

For such passengers, the boarding pass for the first flight has a special designator code I, which means they head directly to the departure gate for the international flight after landing at Delhi airport. For others, the boarding pass for domestic flight has a designator D, requiring them to technically exit arrivals at Delhi. The designator codes allow the airline and other authorities to differentiate Easy Connect passengers from others.

According to sources, in this

instance, the three Italian nationals were not eligible for the Easy Connect service and were supposed to exit at Delhi and go through immigration again for their Lufthansa flight to Munich. Prima facie, it appears to be a case of oversight and confusion, with these passengers directly heading to the boarding gate for next flight, along with Easy Connect passengers, as per a source. Their boarding cards for the Delhi-Munich flight were issued at the Amritsar airport. Lufthansa and Air India have a codeshare partnership.

After the incident came to light, following manual reconciliation of passenger data, MoCA on Saturday (September 12) issued a show-cause notice to Air India, giving the airline seven days to respond, it is learnt. The Tata group carrier has not responded, sources said. Air India didn't comment on the incident and the show-cause notice.

The Civil Aviation Ministry has sought the airline's response on various counts, including how passengers with the D designator on their boarding passes were able to move freely in international transit area of the Delhi airport instead of being directed towards the arrivals area, it is learnt. It has asked Air India about role of its ground handling agency AISATS in handling transfer passengers at the Delhi airport, and about reconciliation of domestic and international passenger data for the incoming flight from Amritsar, which was evidently not done promptly.

Air India's hub-and-spoke flights were launched with the government's backing a few months ago to make one-stop domestic-to-international connections easy and hassle-free for flyers.

Set aside political differences to promote Indian languages: Shah

Press Trust of India
Mumbai, September 14

UNION HOME Minister Amit Shah on Monday said cultural nationalism meant creating awareness about India's culture and history, asserting the country's diverse languages could have different voices but the national sentiment should remain one.

All political differences must be set aside to promote Indian languages, Shah said. He linked promotion of Indian languages to Prime Minister Narendra Modi's pledge of freeing the country from a “mindset of slavery”. Addressing the 6th All India Rajbhasha Sammelan, Shah said Bal Gangadhar Tilak had understood that awareness about the country's culture and history could be created through cultural nationalism.

The minister said ‘Hindi Shabd Sindhu’, which began with 51,000 words, had now grown to eight lakh words and expressed confidence that it would become the world's largest dictionary by 2029.

Shah said more than 50,000 words from Indian regional languages had been incorporated into ‘Hindi Shabd Sindhu’ to fill gaps where Hindi lacked words. He said the dictionary had accepted words from Tamil, Telugu, Marathi, Gujarati, Bengali and Odia etc, thereby making Hindi more flexible.

Hindi should act as a means



Union Home Minister Amit Shah addresses the 6th All India Rajbhasha Sammelan in Mumbai on Monday. PTI

of communication and connection among India's languages rather than competition. The home minister said his knowledge of Hindi had helped him work across the country when his party assigned him a national-level responsibility.

He said the Rajbhasha department developed the multilingual translation tool ‘Bharati’, while the government had set up ‘Bharatiya Bhasha Anubhag’. The Centre wants to make Indian languages the language of governance and science, he said, adding that the aim is to enrich them through literature.

“The biggest work PM Modi has done is that, under NEP, he has made learning in mother tongue compulsory and also made learning another Indian language mandatory. Those opposing NEP provision of learning one more Indian language apart from mother tongue do not know what sin they are committing,” he said.

India, Vietnam agree to deepen defence ties, co-produce military equipment

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, September 14

WITH AN eye on China's assertive behaviour in the Indo-Pacific region, India and Vietnam agreed to deepen defence and security cooperation, including thorough co-production of Indian defence equipment, after External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar met visiting Foreign Minister of Vietnam Le Hoai Trung on Monday.

Jaishankar, who co-chaired the 19th India-Vietnam Joint Commission Meeting (JCM) on trade, economic, scientific and technological cooperation with the Vietnamese minister, said: “Vietnam for us is a key partner in India's Act East Policy, in our Vision MAHASAGAR (Mutual and Holistic Advancement for Security and Growth Across Regions) in outlook of the Indo-Pacific. Vietnam is equally an important partner in the framework of our Comprehensive Strategic Partnership with ASEAN (Association of South-east Asian Nations).”

Defence and security cooperation is among the central pillars of the enhanced Comprehensive Strategic Partnership between India and Vietnam.

Bilateral defence engagement has also diversified to wider military-to-military dialogue and capacity building and training among all arms of the forces. In July 2023, India gifted an indigenously built missile corvette INS Kirpan to Vietnam. Earlier, 12 high-speed guard boats, built by Indian manufacturer Larsen & Toubro under a bilateral line of credit of USD 100 million, were handed over to Vietnam in June 2022. Two



External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar with Vietnamese counterpart Le Hoai Trung in New Delhi. PTI

more Lines of Credit of USD 120 million and USD 180 million have been signed between the Exim Bank of India and the Finance Ministry of Vietnam in July 2024, and are being undertaken currently.

According to the official statement on the bilateral talks: “They (India, Vietnam) identified the way forward on deepening ongoing defence and security collaboration, including through co-production of Indian defence items; expanding trade, investments and mutually beneficial supply chains; market access for Indian marine and agricultural products and pharmaceuticals; financial, port and air connectivity; opportunities in nuclear energy and space sector; heritage conservation; cooperation in standards for seafarers; capacity building and people-to-people ties.”

The two ministers noted that discussions between the general secretary of the Communist Party of Vietnam and the President of Vietnam, To Lam, and

PM Modi, including during the former's State Visit to India in May 2026, provided “renewed impetus to the bilateral relationship”.

Jaishankar said, “I am very glad to note that our bilateral ties have progressed significantly since the previous meeting of the Joint Commission, which was held three years ago. We have had two important State Visits from Vietnam in the meanwhile, most notably, the State Visit of General Secretary and President To Lam to India. And during this visit, our leaders elevated their relationship to an Enhanced Comprehensive Strategic Partnership. It is noteworthy that Vietnam is the first country in the region with which we have bilateral ties at that level.”

It said that in a “productive and outcome-oriented discussion”, the two ministers reviewed the full spectrum of bilateral relations under the India-Vietnam Enhanced Comprehensive Strategic Partnership. The MEA said it appreci-

ated the growing popularity of Yoga in Vietnam. They also agreed to observe next year as the Year of India-Vietnam Friendship to mark 55 years of diplomatic ties. They welcomed Vietnam's engagement under India's Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiatives (IPOI), it said.

“The two sides exchanged views on regional and global developments of mutual interest and reaffirmed their commitment to closer cooperation and coordination in regional and multilateral fora,” the MEA said. The ministers expressed satisfaction at upward and growing trajectory of bilateral relations and agreed to convene the next Joint Commission Meeting on a mutually convenient date.

According to the MEA, “Vietnam is a key pillar of India's Act East Policy. Rooted in deep civilisational linkages, the India-Vietnam Enhanced Comprehensive Strategic Partnership continues to grow from strength to strength across established and new areas of cooperation.”

Real-time location and quick ambulances for accidents: NHAI plans to upgrade 1033 helpline

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, September 14

THE NATIONAL Highways Authority of India (NHAI) is planning to upgrade its existing 1033 helpline with AI, real-time location tracking and smart emergency-response systems to provide better assistance to the commuters.

The 1033 helpline is a crucial system to save lives in road accidents since national highways account for over 36% of road deaths, though it forms only 2.3% of the total road network. The emergency response system is important especially for the “Golden hour” — the first 60 minutes after an accident.

Indian Highways Management Company Ltd (IHMC) — NHAI company which runs 1033 — has invited an Expression of Interest from companies and consortia for the development, design, deployment, operation and maintenance of the next generation helpline. This is to gather technical recommendations and industry feedback before issuing Request for Proposal for final contract award.

The 1033 helpline was introduced in 2018 and handles both emergency calls, including accident and incident-related calls



Officials said the helpline currently covers more than 1.46 lakh km of National Highways and receives around 15,000 calls every day.

escalated for ambulance dispatch coordination, and non-emergency calls such as toll, FASTag, road conditions complaints, inquiries, etc., through voice, SMS, WhatsApp, mobile app, web and email channels, with multilingual support.

Officials said it covers over 1.46 lakh km of the national highways and receives around 15,000 calls every day.

The next-gen 1033 service will identify the location of callers, understand calls in different Indian languages and send right assistance to the location faster, said the IHMC official. Human operators will continue to play an important role in emergencies that call for human judgement and decision-making.

It also aims to provide benefits such as Intelligent systems to help identify and send the most suitable ambulance, crane or patrol vehicle; and timely advisories about incidents and other important developments.

Currently the system allocates emergency resources such as ambulances using straight line distance calculation. The new system will deploy the dynamic dispatch algorithm based on live road ETA, factoring in real-time traffic and carriage geometry to recommend the nearest suitable resource within 30 seconds. The IHMC has proposed the full integration of the Emergency Response Support System (ERSS-112) under the new system, and Rajmargyatra citizen app.

Gujarat woman throws acid at daughter-in-law as she refuses to clean bathroom

Aditi Raja
Vadodara, September 14

A 26-YEAR-OLD Vadodara woman accused her mother-in-law of throwing acid at her face and neck leading to minor burn injuries, after she refused to clean the bathroom of their rented apartment with it, prompting an FIR to be lodged at Gorwa police station in the city.

The alleged incident took place on September 10 at a residential society on Panchvati Sahyog Road in Gorwa, according to the complaint. The woman told the police she married a Vadodara man in 2021 and since faced repeated quarrels and alleged physical and mental harassment from her husband, mother-in-law, father-in-law and two sisters-in-law. They registered an FIR based on her complaint under BNS Sections for domestic cruelty by husband or relatives (Section 85), acid attacks resulting in grievous hurt [Section 124(I)], and voluntary causing of hurt [Section 115(2)] as well as public annoyance through obscene acts (Section 296(2), among others.

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Listing Tata Sons will lead to transparency

LAST WEEK, the Reserve Bank of India rejected Tata Sons' application to surrender its registration as a core investment company, bringing to an end to the longstanding regulatory ambiguity on the matter. The regulator's decision — it comes at a time when the group has been mired in internal conflicts and only a month after Tata Sons chairman N Chandrasekaran announced his decision not to seek reappointment — implies that Tata Sons will now have to be listed on the stock exchanges. The holding company has been classified as an upper layer NBFC since September 2022. Its board is slated to hold its next meeting on September 17, wherein the issue of listing and leadership should be on the agenda.

Tata Trusts, which hold a 65.9 per cent stake in Tata Sons, have, however, been opposed to the idea of a public listing. In fact, last year, the Trusts had passed a resolution against the listing of the holding company. A listing could, after all, dilute the control the Trusts exercise over Tata Sons. It could remould and reshape the structures of control that have so far governed the group. The RBI's decision may well be contested. But a listing would help bring about greater transparency in dealings and supervision of the group's activities. That's why the RBI's decision is welcome. In a sprawling conglomerate like the Tatas, with interests in several areas of strategic importance, the structures of governance should be clearly delineated. The lines of decision-making and accountability need to be distinctly defined. This would also lead to greater questioning and scrutiny of decisions regarding capital allocation and also of its loss-making entities. Air India's losses have, for example, widened to Rs 22, 238 crore in 2025-26.

The Shapoorji Pallonji group, which holds an 18.37 per cent stake in Tata Sons, is known to favour a listing. The group has been looking for ways to monetise its holdings, which would help bring down its debt levels. Considering that valuation exercises carried out in the past have led to wide-ranging estimates, as per a report in this paper, a listing would also lead to a process of price discovery, helping place a value on Tata Sons. It would also shine a light on an entity that exercises considerable sway over the group's companies that are engaged in a wide spectrum of businesses across the economy.

Let AI safety catch up

THE WARNING from leaders of the world's top AI companies, that the technology could become powerful enough to pose a serious risk to humanity in as little as six months to a year, may sound like a scenario from dystopian fiction. It must, however, not be dismissed. In an essay published over the weekend, Anthropic co-founder and CEO Dario Amodei made a case for "pacing the frontier". He was backed by rivals Sam Altman, CEO of OpenAI, and Elon Musk, founder and CEO of xAI. The dangers of letting companies, which are racing to develop a deeply transformative technology, set the limits have long been flagged. That the industry leaders have now spoken up and underlined the need to slow down, so that risk prevention can keep up, opens a precious window to develop more effective regulations for AI development.

This breathing space may allow AI companies to skirt around increasingly hostile positions on the technology's environmental and economic impacts, but it must also be used by governments to set safety standards without strangling innovation. For example, Amodei and Altman's voluntary commitment to grant employee-level system access to independent evaluators could be made mandatory. Also required is a system for international cooperation to limit the most dangerous uses of superintelligent AI, such as cyberwarfare, bioterrorism and economic disruption at a global scale. The challenge of achieving this in a time of heightened global rivalries is steep — US President Donald Trump has already dismissed the risks flagged by Amodei et al. as something that "won't happen", emphasising that the US must maintain its lead over China.

An internal reckoning has been forced by the development of recursive self-improvement — where an AI system uses its capabilities to design, develop and train its successors. Then there are the high-profile instances of the technology escaping the sandbox to act autonomously, such as when OpenAI agents hacked their way online and launched a coordinated attack on the open-source platform Hugging Face while attempting to cheat on an evaluation. But whether the recent concerns emerge from a belated sense of accountability or the instinct to avoid the liabilities arising from AI gone rogue is beside the point. The risk of a technology developing faster than it can even be understood is real, especially when it is, just as quickly, being integrated into systems that control and manage everything from banking and transport to healthcare and defence.

Celine Dion: The heart goes on

SIX YEARS after her last full concert, pop icon Celine Dion walked onto the museum-like stage of Paris's Pléniude Arena in a black pleated Dior dress and kicked off with her 1998 French hit, 'On ne change pas' (We don't change). Moments later, visibly overcome with emotion, she told the packed stadium, "I made a promise to be back... So here I am, singing for you and singing for me..." Dion was opening the first of her 26-concert 'Celine Dion Paris 2026' residency.

The Canadian chanteuse moved between French songs, power ballads, an opera aria and pop. But this was no ordinary comeback. Dion has spent the last six years grappling with a rare neurological disorder, which affected her body and her vocal cords, challenging the sheer power and astounding high notes that have long been her signature. The agony of the art she'd spent a lifetime mastering, slipping away was palpable in Irene Taylor's poignant 2024 documentary *I Am: Celine Dion*.

That is why Paris was different from a usual comeback concert. Here was a star returning after a hiatus, but there was also an artist who discovered her voice and body could not be taken for granted. Dion wasn't defeated by her changed body; she found a way to work with it. "I am gonna come on stage... And my vocal cords will not scare me... and I will hit those notes because I am not brave, I am smart. And I can't wait to go back... and hit whatever I can hit," Dion had said in 2024. In Paris, the key was lowered; she was more often than not on point with the notes, and sometimes just about in the vicinity. Against the odds, she triumphed.

Government trusts Aadhaar on welfare. It needs to rely on it to make voter lists

THE SPECIAL Intensive Revision (SIR) of the electoral rolls by the Election Commission (EC) is no longer a one-off event. Rolling out in phases since June 2025, it now extends to almost the entire country and has already deleted over 13 crore names. On May 27, the Supreme Court (SC) upheld the exercise — while holding, crucially, that the final determination of citizenship belongs to the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) under the Citizenship Act, not to the EC. SIR's goal — clean, accurate and inclusive rolls — is beyond dispute. The method is not.

That method revives a document-intensive, house-to-house verification mothballed for over two decades and applies it, in the smartphone age, on a near-national scale. Lakhs of officials go door to door; crores of citizens must prove their eligibility on paper within compressed deadlines. The burden falls hardest on the poor, the elderly, migrants and women — and now that in some states, there are orders linking SIR deletions to welfare records, a wrongful removal can cost a family its rations and its pension. The cost of error is not hypothetical: Even now, the SC is pressing the EC over the slow disposal of appeals against SIR deletions in West Bengal — voters struck off and still waiting to be heard.

It is also ruinously expensive, and by design it recurs. It mobilises around 10 lakh public servants — mostly schoolteachers — and costs the exchequer thousands of crores every cycle. An Aadhaar-based alternative would involve a very small expenditure by comparison — a modest, one-time build on

digital infrastructure the country has already paid for, and almost nothing per verification.

The deeper difficulty is that citizenship cannot be settled in the field at all. The documents the SIR demands are not universal, and the government now concedes it. A passport — held by under 8 per cent of Indians — was clarified this June by the Ministry of External Affairs to be a travel document, not proof of citizenship. Aadhaar, by statute, proves identity and residence but not citizenship; voter ID and PAN prove none of it; and birth registration was, for decades, patchy for the poor, women and rural India. If even the passport cannot establish citizenship, a household paper-check certainly cannot. History confirms it. The Multi-purpose National Identity Card pilot was abandoned as unworkable. The Assam National Register of Citizens excluded 19 lakh people, caused enormous distress, and resolved nothing. The National Population Register that followed enumerated "usual residents" — citizens and non-citizens alike — because the MHA found a field test of citizenship impractical. The SC has now placed the constitutional full stop: Citizenship is for the MHA, not an electoral officer at the doorstep.

There is a persistent objection that Aadhaar is "only" an identity, unfit to prove age or residence. Every alternative is weaker: PAN was itself cleaned using Aadhaar, passports are issued on the strength of Aadhaar, and a doorstep survey can establish no one's date of birth. And Aadhaar's data has no motive



R S SHARMA

The EC should commission an Aadhaar-EPIC face-authentication application, with UIDAI, as the primary means of revising the rolls, and stop spending thousands of crores every cycle on a 19th-century method

War on Terror is over, but its legacy continues to haunt



ANJU GUPTA

NO EVENT has shaped the international security paradigm and geopolitics as much as the 9/11 terror attacks in the US. Al Qaeda (AQ) terrorists used passenger planes as "flying" improvised explosive devices (IEDs), crashing two into the World Trade Centre (WTC) in New York, one into the western wing of the Pentagon, while passengers managed to overpower the terrorists aboard the fourth "flying" IED heading for the US Capitol, and force-crashed the plane in a field in southern Pennsylvania. In all, around 3,000 people, including 2,600 Americans, died and 6,000 were injured.

Nineteen Arab terrorists carried out the attacks ordered by AQ chief Osama bin Laden, operating from Afghanistan as a "guest" of the Taliban I.O. The US launched a global "War on Terror" (WoT), which began with the occupation of Afghanistan after the removal of the Taliban in 2001, a worldwide effort to dismantle AQ's network, and the occupation of Iraq after the removal of Saddam Hussein in 2003. The WoT has ended, but not the terror, especially in South Asia.

The sheer audacity of 9/11 and the destruction that ensued alerted the world to the reach and capability of AQ's network. The global community, including China and Russia, aligned their counter-terrorism objectives with those of the US when the war in Afghanistan began. About 50 countries contributed troops to US and NATO-led military efforts. However, the US ground invasion of Iraq in 2003 could only draw British, Australian and Polish troops.

Worldwide investigations linked 9/11 and earlier spectacular attacks — including the 1993 attack on the WTC, 1998 bombings of US embassies in Kenya and Tanzania and the 2000 attack on USS Cole off the coast of Yemen — to AQ's global network. However, cracks began appearing in the political consensus around the WoT, as both Iraq and Afghanistan became theatres of "forever wars" embroiled in the unintended consequences of regime change and the dynamic nature of the threat.

In Iraq, within less than 16 months of the "victorious" withdrawal of US troops in 2011, a local branch of AQ, Al Qaeda in Iraq (AQI), morphed into the Islamic State of Iraq and Syria (ISIS). It set up a "caliphate" across parts of Iraq and Syria and invited foreign fighters to live under a "puritanical Islamic rule. The "caliphate" would be defeated by a large US-led coalition by March 2019.

The US changed its strategy in Afghanistan to treat terror groups (AQ and allies) and insurgent groups (the Afghanistan-centric Taliban) differently to end the war. However, even after the killing of bin Laden in 2011 in Pakistan, the US waited more than 10 years to exit.

Over 20 years of WoT, the substantial leadership of AQ and ISIS was eliminated. But local, independent groups that pledged allegiance to AQ continue to operate, largely in Yemen, Somalia and the Sahel. Similarly, local, independent groups that swear allegiance to the "caliphate" exist in some parts of the world, including across South Asia. The world faces far more scattered terror threats, embedded in local and regional networks.

The US has discontinued framing the threat of terrorism as a "global war", even though its agencies and military continue to target networks across many theatres. The propaganda around "global jihad" has also become far less visible.

The impact on India can only be assessed by going back to the 10 years of US-USSR proxy war in Afghanistan. The period witnessed the globalisation of a local Afghan jihad by the US and allies through a fatwa issued by an Arab teacher, Abdullah Azzam, who moved to Islamabad in 1981. Bin Laden and Azzam oversaw the mobilisation of thousands of Arabs for this global jihad.

Bin Laden secretly created AQ in Peshawar around May 1988 with a very small, trusted Arab group. Pakistan mobilised Pakistanis for global jihad in Afghanistan, and the leaders of these Pakistani groups, close allies of Al Qaeda, later emerged as the leading figures of networks that assumed the identities of Lashkar-e-Taiba and Jaish-e-Mohammad.

The end of the proxy war in Afghanistan left the Af-Pak region as a hub for AQ and its South Asian allies. Pakistan continued to use groups in the country against India. The 2025 Pahalgam terror attack and the subsequent "limited" India-Pakistan war is a case in point. Military clashes between Afghanistan and Pakistan demonstrate the region's enduring instability. The November 2025 Red Fort attack in Delhi indicates that despite 25 years of international counter-terrorism efforts since 9/11, the region's vulnerabilities persist.

Gupta, a security analyst and former director general of police, is the author of *Glocal Terror in South Asia: Tracing the Roots in Geopolitics and the Tragedy of Afghanistan*

to lie built into it: It was created as a bare identity carrying no benefit or entitlement, so nothing was gained by misstating one's age, and the address had to be genuine because the Aadhaar letter was posted to it.

For the electoral roll, moreover, only one fact about age matters — is the person 18 or older? Aadhaar answers it without a date at all. Biometrics are not captured below the age of five, so anyone whose own fingerprints and iris were recorded in an enrolment around 2013 or earlier was at least five then, and is at least 18 now. To discard the largest, most carefully audited enrolment in history is a counsel of nihilism: If we will not trust our own most-used record, we can trust nothing, and the state cannot recognise its own people.

The tools, moreover, are not hypothetical. Aadhaar covers 1.36 billion residents and has already done, at scale, what roll-cleaning needs — de-duplicating PAN, closing benami accounts, and removing crores of ghost beneficiaries from welfare, saving over Rs 2.7 lakh crore. Two everyday services prove the point: More than 10 crore Aadhaar face authentication transactions have been completed in Digi Yatra through more than 100 airports, and Jeevan Pramaan lets 1.47 crore pensioners prove, by their face and from a phone, that they are alive (as many as 500 crore Aadhaar face authentications have been completed till date).

If the state trusts this at the airport gate and to release pensions, it can trust it to verify a voter — and Aadhaar was built on privacy by de-

sign, returning only a yes-or-no, never the underlying data.

The alternative is therefore simple. A voluntary application — on mobile or web — would let any voter link Aadhaar to their Voter ID and complete face authentication in one step, with no document and no visit to any office. That one act proves the voter is alive, removes duplicates (each Aadhaar is unique) and ghosts (a non-existent person cannot authenticate), settles age from the Aadhaar's vintage, and cross-checks the address. Linkage stays voluntary; those who decline use the ordinary manual route, a small residue given near-universal coverage. Citizenship is handled exactly as the Court requires — identify everyone first, let analytics flag the few genuine outliers, and refer only those to the MHA.

The recommendation follows plainly. The EC should commission such an Aadhaar-EPIC face-authentication application, with UIDAI, as the primary means of revising the rolls, and stop spending thousands of crores every cycle on a 19th-century method that harasses the honest majority and cannot find the few it targets. A small fraction of that money, spent once, would clean the rolls faster, far more cheaply, and with a fully auditable trail. The government trusts this technology to move citizens through airports and to pay their pensions. It should trust it to decide who is on the voter list. The technology is ready. The policy should follow.

The writer is former secretary to the Government of India and founding director general, UIDAI (Aadhaar). Views are personal

In AfD's rise, questions about democracy and belonging



KHUSHBOO SRIVASTAVA

THE SUCCESS of the Alternative for Germany (AfD) in Saxony-Anhalt has raised the question of whether Germany's firewall against the far right (*Brandmauer*) is cracking. Emerging from the devastating impacts of war, the German polity was premised on democracy's institutional capacity to defend itself. In 2015, amidst the Syrian refugee crisis, Angela Merkel's "*Wir schaffen das*" (we can do this) reflected the confidence that Germany could handle social challenges without compromising its democratic principles. A decade later, the question has shifted from whether Germany can "do this" to what happens when the political consensus around "how to do it" begins to fracture.

The AfD secured 43.8 per cent of the votes and fell just three seats short of a majority. The *Brandmauer* and the mainstream parties' refusal to enter coalitions with the AfD may prevent it from coming to power. However, its success raises a question: What happens when the institutions of democratic containment remain intact while the political constituency for the force being contained continues to expand? Emerging from the collapse of the Weimar Republic, the Federal Republic embedded *wehrhafte Demokratie*, or defensive democracy: Democracy should hold constitutional means to defend itself against those who threaten it. Yet such safeguards cannot prevent citizens from finding extremism electorally persuasive. The *Brandmauer* is meant to impede the normalisation of a politics inimical to the norms of the Federal Republic. The challenge is to maintain this consensus without appearing to deny the electorate choice. While the *Brandmauer* can prevent institutional normalisation, it can also augment the AfD's claim that the current regime is determined to silence voices from the electorate that do not align with theirs.

Immigration has been a contentious issue in Germany. Saxony-Anhalt has a smaller immigrant population than Berlin, Bremen, and North Rhine-Westphalia, yet migration is a topical issue. The AfD has translated this into a wider debate over national identity, economic insecurity, and neglect by mainstream parties. The question is whether its success is contingent on migration or on such broader concerns. The AfD's populist claim to represent the voice of the people also positions constitutional checks as barriers to popular will. The challenge for the firewall is the contest between majoritarian and constitutional notions of democracy. Moreover, Saxony-Anhalt is part of a region where the party has consistently performed better than in the West, reflecting economic inequality and differences in institutional representation. For many in the East, reunification has brought a sense of being treated as "second-class citizens", and the AfD has woven these concerns into a single narrative of neglect.

Given Germany's significance to Europe's politico-economic landscape, its internal shifts will shape how we look at migration, the rule of law, and the future of integration in Europe. But the biggest takeaway lies in the shifting frontiers of what appears politically possible. Today, despite the AfD's win, Germany's democratic safeguards remain indispensable. However, constitutional defence alone cannot substitute for political responsiveness. To sustain the democratic centre, Germany must address grievances, from economic insecurity and regional inequality to migration and political distrust. Democracy must defend itself. But it must also feel like it belongs to those asked to defend it.

Srivastava is a political scientist. Buttan is a PhD scholar at TISS

What happens when the institutions of democratic containment remain intact while the political constituency for the force being contained continues to expand?

40 YEARS AGO

September 15, 1986



Seoul airport explosion

FIVE PEOPLE were killed and 26 wounded in a bomb blast in the crowded arrival hall of Seoul's Gimpo Airport, police said. The incident fanned fears that terrorists would try to sabotage the Asian Games. A police spokesman said the explosion was caused by a bomb planted in a bin near a terminal gate.

Punjab asks for troops

THE PUNJAB government has approached the Centre for the deployment of 60 addi-

tional companies of paramilitary forces in the state in the wake of the Muktark killings. This was stated by Chief Minister Surjit Singh Barnala, at a press conference in Jaipur.

First Indian-built submarine

THE FIRST Indian-built submarine for the Navy will be ready for sea trials by 1990 and the second a year later. This is the first time construction of submarines has been undertaken by the country's premier ship-building firm, Mazagon Dock Ltd. When the contract for the four submarines was

signed with a West German firm in 1982, it was envisaged that two would be built in Mazagon Dock, Bombay, and two in the HDW yard at Kiel.

Blast kills Iraqi diplomat

A BOMB planted under a car seat exploded and killed Iraq's vice consul in Karachi as he drove from his home, authorities said. No group has claimed responsibility for the explosion that killed Iraqi vice-consul Mehtar Abdus Salam and critically injured his driver.



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At Jadavpur University, the gerua and the state



AMIT CHAUDHURI

ON SEPTEMBER 9, the Chief Minister of Bengal — in a move unheard of for an elected representative who is also a head of government — marched with a crowd of people to Jadavpur University, to remind students reportedly smoking *ganja* and indulging in free speech that their behaviour was unacceptable in a Centre of Excellence. Here was a warning about the limits of this drug, freedom, but maybe also a riposte to a newspaper terming a previous ugly episode (that culminated with the Nandalal Bose-designed university emblem being seriously damaged) *gerua goondami*, or “saffron hooliganism”. Noticeable in the Chief Minister’s group were long-haired, bearded men whose only clothing was strips of saffron, recruited to establish *gerua samman*, or “saffron pride”. A photograph of them standing in front of the university gates began circulating on social media.

When I shared the photo with a few people I know, I was asked by some of them what was wrong with Naga sadhus having gathered at the gates. Weren’t they part of the culture and, consequently, a recurrent sight? Is it not a “secular” narrowness of mind that, despite its self-proclaimed regard for diversity, defines them as ridiculous and outrageous? There’s certainly some truth to this. But who are these Naga *sannyasis*, and who are their forebears?

The lay view and the historians’ are more or less the same: They’re ascetics, followers of Shiva, who have been around for centuries. Their abstention from all clothing except the barest places them within both the devotional and renunciatory strands of Hinduism. For a long time the asociale unclottedness of holy men of this type has both caused amusement and carried a frisson of the eccentric and experimental. Yogic asceticism has also been vulnerable to charlatans, as this verse from Kabir, translated by Arvind



ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

Krishna Mehrotra, reminds us: *If going naked/ Brought liberation,/ The deer of the forest/ Would attain it first.*

But charlatan or not, today’s sadhu and the colour saffron itself seem to have been appropriated by what they were historically defined against: Political power; indeed, against worldly pride.

The Naga sadhus’ forebears first appear in the historical record in the time of Alexander’s incursion into India. Among the various people who travelled with Alexander was the philosopher Pyrrho, who, according to his biographer Sextus Empiricus, met, on reaching India, the gymnosophists: The Greek word for “naked (*gymnos*)” philosophers (*sophistês*). We are talking about around 325 BCE. From the gymnosophists Pyrrho, founder of the Sceptics, picked up a philosophical position that is unusual in Western culture until modernism: That calm arises from what we ordinarily call “judgement” being put into abeyance. So Pyrrho: “The things themselves are equally indifferent, and unstable, and indeterminate, and therefore neither our senses nor our opinions are either true or false. For this reason then we must not trust them, but be without opinions, and without

Today’s sadhu and the colour saffron itself seem to have been appropriated by what they were historically defined against: Political power; indeed, against worldly pride



AMEER SHAHUL

THE MOST revealing number in India’s healthcare story after 12 years of BJP rule may not be the number of hospitals built, Ayushman cards issued or medical seats created. It may be 1.43 per cent. That was government health expenditure as a share of GDP in 2022–23 against the 2.5 per cent target set by the National Health Policy 2017.

India has expanded almost every visible measure of healthcare. Medical colleges and seats have multiplied. The footprint of AIIMS has expanded. Ayushman Bharat has become one of the world’s largest publicly funded health insurance programmes. Yet the latest report of the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Health and Family Welfare finds a system still struggling with basic capacity, affordability and regulation.

Consider medical education. The number of medical colleges has risen to 818 and undergraduate medical seats have reached 1,28,875, an extraordinary expansion. But India’s problem was never simply the number of doctors. It was where they practise, who can afford them and whether the system has the infrastructure to use them. The Committee finds specialist shortages at rural community health centres of roughly 70–80 per cent. There are 17,788 building-less sub-centres. So India has produced many more doctors without solving the problem of distributing healthcare capacity.

Medical education has also become a major commercial sector,

Our healthcare boom hides a public-system deficit

with private and PPP models playing an important role. When medical seats become valuable commercial assets, the integrity of regulation becomes crucial. This raises a question: Who regulates the regulator?

The same tension runs through healthcare more broadly. The Committee, citing the NSSO 80th round (2025), says more than 60 per cent of hospitalisations and around 70 per cent of outpatient care are serviced by the private sector. Average hospitalisation expenditure is approximately Rs 6,631 in government hospitals against Rs 50,508 in private hospitals. The state does not have to charge a patient Rs 50,000 to impose a Rs 50,000 burden. It only has to fail to provide a realistic public alternative.

This is where the healthcare architecture takes another turn: Financial protection through insurance. Ayushman Bharat has helped millions of families obtain hospital care they might otherwise have been unable to afford. But insurance can pay the bill without controlling its price. If treatment costs Rs 5 lakh and insurance pays Rs 5 lakh, the patient may be protected from immediate financial ruin. But the healthcare system has still consumed Rs 5 lakh. If prices continue rising, somebody eventually pays — government, insurer, employer or patient.

Meanwhile, more than 40 crore Indians — the missing middle — remain outside comprehensive financial protection. Out-of-pocket

If we go back to the time of Alexander, we find it rich with stories about Diogenes of Sinope, the founder of the school of Cynics, who went around the streets of Athens with a lantern in broad daylight saying he was searching for an honest man, and who otherwise lived in a barrel that was also his main outer covering, as he was near-naked. Diogenes’s relationship to power is captured in the story of his meeting with Alexander, who sought out the philosopher and offered to give him whatever he desired; to which Diogenes replied: “Please stand aside: you are blocking the sun.” Diogenes, whose life overlaps with Pyrrho, is Greece’s home-grown gymnosophist.

Naked philosophers were significant not because they were naked, or renunciates, or devotees, but because many of them were practitioners of a form of thought, or intellectual investigation, that Hinduism shares with Buddhism, to do with the replacing of subjectivity with consciousness. To arrive at this “consciousness” and to experience its particular pleasure entails the suspending of what we ordinarily call self, opinion, dogma, and judgement. Descriptions of what it means to be conscious in this way abound in the Upanishads: say, in the *Mandukya*, where it is said to surpass deep dreamless sleep.

Esoteric and abstruse though they sound to you and me, these concepts are picked up in India both by the elite and the semi-literate and uneducated: That is, they are also to be found in the bhajans of Kabir and the *abhangs* of Tukaram. Whether or not one “understands” the intervention the gymnosophists made has had nothing to do, historically, with “education”. In fact, they point to the limits of the notion of “understanding” no less than Ludwig Wittgenstein’s “The limits of language are the limits of my world.”

When we see the sadhus at the university gates, we must connect them, then, to a lineage of thought (rather than to Hinduism) that they and we are both largely unaware of and that any of us — literate; illiterate — could lay claim to. What does being naked qualify us for besides proximity to power?

Chaudhuri is an author, poet, essayist, critic, short story writer, and musician

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Build resilience

THE RECENT surge in crude oil prices and the possibility of higher US interest rates are matters of concern for India. (‘After oil surge, Fed rate hike will shape challenge’, *IE*, September 14) As a major importer of oil and capital, India could face higher inflation, slower growth and pressure on its current account. Rising global interest rates may also encourage investors to move money towards safer markets, making it harder for India to attract foreign capital. The situation highlights the need for stronger economic preparation. The government should focus on improving exports, reducing costs for businesses and investing in roads and ports. Fiscal discipline and stable policies will also be essential.

Ansh Dubey, New Delhi

AI future

INDIA STANDS at an important point in its AI journey. (‘The choice is between AI applications and AI frontiers’, *IE*, September 14) While Indian businesses are quickly adopting AI applications, the country still lacks the computing power needed to develop advanced AI models of its own. This gap could make India dependent on foreign technology and leave ordinary workers with fewer opportunities. The government’s efforts to build data centres are welcome, but more focused investment is needed in computing infrastructure, research and skilled talent.

Arvind Singh, New Delhi

Beyond architecture

THE SUGGESTIONS and ideas given by Gautam Bhatia in his article regarding rebuilding of the city after the Satya Niketan tragedy in New Delhi are very thoughtful and worth considering (‘The rebuilding of the city must begin, after Satya Niketan’, *IE*, September 14). But apart from architecture, this issue needs to be addressed from social angles, too. An exodus from cities and villages can be prevented by creating ample opportunities and accelerating infrastructure development.

Manish B Mehta, Rajkot



SRINATH SRIVIDHARAN

FOR MOST of human history, power belonged to those who could make decisions. Tools increased the strength of the human hand, the reach of the human voice and the speed of human calculation. AI introduces something more consequential: Systems that can increasingly participate in making decisions themselves. Dario Amodei, chief executive of Anthropic, one of the companies at the frontier, has urged the industry to “pace the frontier”: Development should continue, but not so rapidly that safety research and safeguards are left behind. His concern comes as AI systems move from generating answers to taking actions, includ-

ing in cyber operations. Anthropic has documented the use of Claude in cybercrime, fraud, surveillance and weapons-related activity. Sam Altman and Elon Musk, usually fierce competitors, have backed greater caution. Within Anthropic, researcher Jacob Coxon recently resigned over what he regarded as a reckless race towards self-improving AI. Another researcher, Evan Hubinger, has assigned a probability of more than 10 per cent to AI causing human extinction within a decade.

Such numbers deserve scepticism. There is no empirical method for calculating the probability of extinction from an intelligence that does not yet exist. There is also an institutional complication: Those issuing the warnings are participants in the race, with commercial interests in the rules. One need not believe that AI will destroy humanity to

believe that human agency must be protected. The more immediate danger may be humans surrendering judgement to systems operating beyond meaningful scrutiny. “Human in the loop” can become a reassuring phrase, only till some human, unable to understand a system’s reasoning, test its conclusions or intervene quickly enough, may remain legally responsible while exercising little substantive control. Regulation should ask whether systems can be independently tested, audited, constrained and stopped.

There is also a geopolitical struggle beneath the safety debate. The US has largely

One need not believe that AI will destroy humanity to believe that human agency must be protected

approached AI through innovation, private capital and technological leadership. Europe has put greater weight on risk, consumer protection and fundamental rights. China has embedded AI within national strategy and sovereignty. Different philosophies of regulation are competing alongside different philosophies of power. What incentive does a nation have to restrain a technology that could deliver extraordinary wealth and power, when its greatest fear is that another nation may move faster? We have convened summit after summit to govern AI, yet collective restraint remains elusive. Why would nations or companies voluntarily limit what could become the most consequential source of power they have ever encountered? The paradox is stark: Cooperation demands that nations trust one another precisely

when each has the strongest reason not to. The real danger is that humans may gradually surrender their ability to decide, while remaining responsible for decisions they no longer truly make. That is why the answer cannot be blind acceleration or a blanket freeze. What is required is stewardship: Governance that can learn as technology changes, test powerful systems before deployment, impose accountability and preserve the capacity to intervene. If the doomsday warnings are wrong, cautious governance may cost some speed. If they are right, what price will we pay if we discover too late that we have handed machines the power to decide what humans can no longer control?

Sridharan is a corporate advisor and author of Family and Dhanda



Congress-led government had imagined a scenario where, with the click of a mouse, funds could be instantaneously transferred to the bank account of a voter. “And if this is done ahead of elections, imagine what the political party in power can achieve,” the advisor said with excitement and a gleam in both eyes.

Over the years, DBT-based social welfare has become a prominent feature of India’s political economy. From all regional parties to Congress to the BJP, none risk not including cash handouts to sections of the voter base in their election manifestos.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi attempted to run it down four years ago by warning against the *revdi* culture during the inauguration of the Bundelkhand Expressway on July 16, 2022, but his own party succumbed to the enticement of its political returns.

A key advisor to Modi, who does not wish to be named, says it used to be difficult for Cabinet ministers in the past to get the PM’s nod on any proposal involving freebies. But not so much anymore. His party units in other states made cash handouts an essential ingredient in their poll strategy. In fact, it has now become a race to the bottom between the BJP state units, regional parties and Congress. The Sixteenth Finance Commission estimates large-group unconditional cash transfers by states to be Rs 1.96 lakh crore in 2025–26, approximately \$20 billion. The bulk of this went to women in Maharashtra, Karnataka and West Bengal.

But *revdi* culture is also a political economy fallout. State failure on health, education and skilling has led parties and governments to implement schemes that offer some social safety, be it minimum income through job guarantees or cash in the hands of women, or an allowance to those who are literate but jobless. It is still too early to say if the Americans will get an alert message for a \$5,000 credit in their accounts. It’s not a done deal yet. Will the United States Congress approve such a large spend? This comes much later, says an American friend. The trillion-dollar question is whether Trump really meant it in the first place.

The writer is managing editor, The Indian Express. vaidyanathan.ier@expressindia.com

Rescued baby orangutan unwell, zoo says ensuring good health

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, September 14

OF THE five orangutans rescued in Odisha, Nandankanan Zoo authorities are placing special emphasis on one particular baby. Reason: The orangutan has been unwell right from the time it was found, along with four others, in a casuarina forest near Bhograi in Balasore district.

On Sunday, too, it developed fever while in quarantine but its condition was reported stable on Monday, said officials.

According to officials, the baby orangutan had been showing high body temperature ever since it was brought to the zoo. "The fever subsides after administering medication but it recurs again. The same baby orangutan had developed a temperature again on Sunday but it's normal now. We are taking

all steps to ensure good health and wellbeing of the orangutans," deputy director of Nandankanan Zoo Pradeep Mirase told *The Indian Express*.

The other four orangutans are healthy and responding normally, officials said.

Sources said the quarantine enclosure at the zoo has recently become relatively crowded following the arrival of 58 new animals. However, separate arrangements have been made for the orangutans. "We have made separate arrangements for the orangutans," the official said, adding that special mosquito nets have been installed in their temperature-controlled room.

Experts said the fever could be due to stress, fatigue or a sudden change in the environment. "It will take some time for the babies to get acclimated to the prevailing environment. The orangutans normally live

in a rainforest atmosphere," the veterinary officer said.

According to Aditya Acharya, head of the Centre for Wildlife Health at Odisha University of Agriculture and Technology (OUAT), high body temperature in orangutans is monitored like that in humans.

"Normally, animals, like human beings, are administered paracetamol-based medication during high body temperature," Acharya said. Meanwhile, the Odisha government has constituted a five-member technical committee to monitor the health, well-being and management of the apes while in quarantine. Odisha is awaiting permission from the Central Zoo Authority (CZA) to keep the five rescued orangutan cubs at Nandankanan Zoological Park in Bhubaneswar, even as authorities investigate how the animals reached Balasore.

Ex-CM Baghel's OSD arrested in exam irregularities case

Jayprakash S Naidu
Raipur, September 14

THE ED recently arrested Chetan Borghariya, the then Officer on Special Duty (OSD) in the former Chhattisgarh Chief Minister Bhupesh Baghel's office, in connection with the money laundering investigation relating to alleged irregularities and manipulation in the CGPSC State Service Examinations, 2020 and 2021.

At present, Borghariya was posted as Additional Collector, Balrampur-Ramanujganj, Chhattisgarh. He was arrested on September 11 under the provisions of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), 2002.

ED investigation was initiated on the basis of an FIR registered in February 2024 by the EOW/ACB, Raipur, in connection with large-scale corruption, manipulation and irregularities in the Chhattisgarh Public Service Commission (CGPSC) State Service Examinations. The case was subsequently taken over by CBI, which registered an FIR against Taman Singh Sonwani, the then Chairman of CGPSC, and others, and subsequently filed chargesheets in the matter.

Enforcement Directorate (ED) investigation has revealed

that three men – Utkarsh Chandrakar, Anil Chandrakar and Dr Vikash Chandrakar – allegedly collected illegal gratification exceeding Rs 3 crore from various candidates of the CGPSC State Service Examination, 2021, on the assurance of providing question papers in advance and securing their selection by using their purported access and influence in the then CM's office.

Investigation further revealed that the name and official position of Borghariya was allegedly used in connection with such assurances.

Utkarsh is a nephew of KK Chandravanshi, who was a Personal Assistant to Baghel during his stint as the CM.

ED has established that leaked question papers were allegedly provided to certain candidates prior to the examinations. Candidates were assembled at Siddhi Vinayak Marriage Palace, Raipur, prior to the Preliminary Examination, where the leaked question paper was allegedly distributed to them, according to the allegations. Subsequently, candidates were accommodated at Barnawapara Sanctuary Resort, where coaching was allegedly imparted based on leaked question papers relating to the Mains Examination.



INLAND WATERWAYS AUTHORITY OF INDIA
(Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, Govt. of India)
Head Office: A-13, Sector - 1, Noida - 201 301,
Phone: 0120-2527667, Fax: 0120-2522969 hc.iwai@nic.in

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (Tender No. : IWAI-15/7/2025-HY)
An e-Bids are invited from interested bidders **Monthly Longitudinal Thalweg Survey (MLTS) in Various National Waterways of Goa.** Details and Tender document can be downloaded from 16.09.2026 to 30.09.2026 from our web site at www.iwai.nic.in and CPPP Portal <https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app>. Last date for submission of online bids is 30.09.2026 up to 1500 hrs. and date of opening of tender is on 01.10.2026 at 1500 hrs. Submission of online bids will be through <https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app>. The Tender Documents and other relevant details are available at IWAI website www.iwai.nic.in and e-procurement site <https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app>.
Date: 14.09.2026

HYDROGRAPHIC CHIEF IWAI, NOIDA

NORTHERN RAILWAY
NOTICE FOR E-AUCTION
Senior Divisional Commercial Manager/Freight, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, in terms of Railway Board letter No. 2022/TC(FM)/10/04 dated 13.06.2022 and Railway Board's letter No. 2024/RS(G)/779/7 (E3471089) dated: 13.08.2024, invites bids through e-Auction (www.ireps.gov.in) for leasing of parcel space of SLR compartments and VPs (on round trip basis) for a period of three years as per detail and schedule given below: -

S. No.	Date & time of e-Auction	Assets to be auctioned
1.	18/09/2026 at 10:30 am	12420 (F1), 12445(F1), 12724 (F1), 15096 (F1,R1), 22420(F1), 22634 (F1), 22806 (F1), 22812 (F1)
2.	22/09/2026 at 10:30 am	01 LVPH (24 tonnes) on round trip basis in each train-14012/14011, 14050/14049.
3.	24/09/2026 at 10:30 am	12005(F1), 12011(F1), 12013(F1), 12015(F1), 12034(F1), 12045(F1), 12156(R1) (Wed, Fri), 12270(F1, R1), 12428(F1), 12438(F1), 12481(F1, R1), 12804(R1) (Sun, Wed), 12916(R1) (Wed, Fri), 12182(R1), 22408(F1).
4.	25/09/2026 at 10:30 am	12017(F1), 12040(F1), 12055(F1), 12057(F1), 12444(F1), 12448(F1), 12455(F1), 12528(F1, R1), 14152(F1), 15530(F1), 15622(F1), 20452(F1), 22168(F1), 22210(F1), 22406(R1).

Important notes: 1. For more information, requirement and various aspects regarding these e-Auctions, interested bidders are advised to visit https://www.ireps.gov.in/html/helpdesk/learning_centre.html. (e-Auction leasing section). 2. Railway Administration reserves the full and absolute rights to short terminate these contracts at any point of time and/or for taking any decision regarding the discontinuation/continuation of these contracts with modified/additional terms and condition depending upon the continuation/discontinuation of these trains or commencement of new train services.
3166/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE



Navi Mumbai Municipal Transport

Estate Dept.
E-Tender Notice
Tender no. NMMT/TM/ESTATE/06/2026-27

Description : Appointment of a contractor to supply 750 contractual bus conductors to the NMMT in a phased manner as per requirement.
Which is available on Website <https://mahatenders.gov.in> Right to accept or reject any tender is reserved by the Hon'ble Transport Manager of NMMT.

S/d
(Umakant Jangle)
Transport Manager
N.M.M.T.

NMMT/TM/ADMIN/564/2026, Dt. 11.09.2026



Planning & Development Department
Old Secretariat, Bihar, Patna-800015.

Notice inviting e-tender no: P&DD/RFP- 03 /2026-27
(Through e-procurement mode only)
(Website-<https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in>)
Tender no: P&DD/RFP-03 /2026-27

The Planning & Development Department Government of Bihar, Patna invites e-tender under two bids system from reputed Agencies for Selection of Social media Management Agency. The RFP Document can be downloaded from the website- <https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in>. The bid document should accompany the cost of RFP document in the form of e-payment mode in rupees. This invitation to bid is open to all bidders meeting minimum eligibility criteria as mentioned in this RFP

S.N.	Scope of Work	RFP Document Fee (Inclusive of GST 18%) to be paid through e-payment mode (In Rupees)	Tender Processing Fee (Non-Refundable) (Inclusive of GST @18%) to be paid through e-payment mode (In Rupees)	Earnest Money Deposit (In Rupees)	Time of Completion
1	2	3	4	5	6
1	Selection of Social media Management Agency	Rs. 5,900/-	Rs. 590/-	Rs. 2,00,000/- (Two Lakhs. Only)	As per the RFP.

Tender Schedule/Programme

S.N.	Activity	Date/Time: Duration
1.	Date of Issue of notice inviting tender	14-09-2026
2.	RFP Release date (Start Date)	15-09-2026 05.00 PM (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
3.	Pre-Bid Meeting	23-09-2026 - 04.00 PM Venue- Planning & Development Department Old Secretariat Room, Bihar, Patna-800015.
4.	Last Date/Time for submission/uploading of offer/Bid	06-10-2026 to 05.00 PM
5.	Date & Time for opening of technical bid	07-10-2026 - 04.00 PM (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in) Venue- Planning & Development Department, Room No-194, Old Secretariat, Bihar, Patna-800015
6.	Nodal Officer for any queries	Ashtosh Dutta Email:- secy-plandev-bih@nic.in
7	Financial Bid Opening Date and Time	To be Notified Venue- - Planning & Development Department, Secretariat, Bihar, Patna-800015

Detailed description of the item and instruction for submitting bid/offer can be downloaded from e-tender website (<https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in>)

Tender Inviting Authority
PR- 011652 (Planning) 2026-27
नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

Senior research officer
(Planning & Development Department)
Bihar, Patna.



Office of Executive Engineer
Ganga Sone Flood Protection Division, Digha, Patna 801506
Email Address – gsfpd1@gmail.com
Quotation No. (Short): 03/ 2026-27
Short Notice Inviting Quotation for Obtaining Rate for supply of Non Woven Mega Geo Bag (2m x 1.5m)

1) Executive Engineer, Ganga Sone Flood Protection Division, Digha, Patna invites sealed most competitive quotation from the intending reputed Bidder/ Supplier/ Firm/ Vendor/Service Provider for **Submitting Rate for supply of Non Woven Mega Geo Bag (2m x 1.5m)**. Details and the quotation documents are available on the Website: <https:// wrdbihar.gov.in>.
2) The quotation document contains the following Annexures:
(i) Brief Description of the Goods
(ii) General guidelines for Quotation
(iii) Information Sheet of Bidder
(iv) The Technical Bid
(v) The Financial Bid
Important Dates & Info

Name and Address of Advertiser	Executive Engineer, Ganga Sone Flood Protection Division, Digha, Patna 801506
Date of issuing Notice	12.09.2026
Last Date and Time of Submission	Date: 21/09/2026, Time 15:00 Hrs
Cost of Quotation Document	Not Applicable
Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid	Date: 21/09/2026, Time 15:30 Hrs.
Date & Time of Opening of Financial Bid	Date: 21/09/2026, Time 16:30 Hrs

Executive Engineer
Ganga Sone Flood Protection Division
Digha, Patna
PR- 011821 (WRD) 2026-27
विरतुत सूचना www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर भी देखी जा सकती है।
नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार



South Bihar Power Distribution Co. Ltd, Patna Bihar
Registered Office: Vidhut Bhawan, Bailey Road, Patna-21
A Govt. of Bihar undertaking
CIN No. U40109BR2012SGC018890
(Department of Stores & Purchase)
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
NIT No. 80 /PR/SBPDC/2026
(Through e-procurement mode only - www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
South Bihar Power Distribution Co. Ltd. (SBPDCL), a Government of Bihar Undertaking, invites online tender for procurement of 11 KV Outdoor VCB with CT, PT & CRP for SBPDCL & NBPDCL in Two-tier (Techno-Commercial & Price) online bid from eligible and experienced Original Manufacturer of 11 KV VCB as detailed below:-

Name of material	Quantity, set	Cost of tender Document including GST@18%, Rs	Total Estimated Cost including GST@18%,Rs	Earnest Money Deposit, Rs.
11 KV Outdoor VCB with CT, PT & CRP	600 (SBPDCL-300 & NBPDCL-300)	11,800/-	35,93,82,000/-	45,93,820/-

The Time line for the above tender is as follows:

Last Date of Online Submission of bid along with Tender Cost & processing fees:	07.10.2026, up to 18:00 Hrs
Last Date of submission of EMD and hard copy of receipt of BSEDCL processing fee & tender cost	08.10.2026, up to 15:00 Hrs
Date of opening of Techno-Commercial bid(Part-I)	08.10.2026, after 17:00 Hrs
Date of Pre Bid Meeting:	29.09.2026, at 1 5:00 Hrs; Venue: SBPDCL, Vidhut Bhawan-3, Patna

BSEDCL(BELTRON) Processing fee & tender cost are mandatory to be paid through online mode i.e. Internet Payment gateway (credit / debit card), net banking, NEFT/RTGS. Bids along with necessary online payments must be submitted through e-payment portal www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in before the date and time specified in the NIT. EMD in prescribed format and hard copy of receipt of BSEDCL processing fee & tender cost must be submitted to Electrical Superintending Engineer (Purchase), SBPDCL within specified time failing which bid of the firm shall be summarily rejected. The department does not take any responsibility for the delay / Non submission of Tender / Non Reconciliation of online Payment caused due to Non-availability of Internet Connection, Network Traffic/ Holidays or any other reason. **Date of opening of price part: To be notified after Technical Bid Evaluation at www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in**

e-tendering introduced in BSHPCF for tenders above Rs. 25 lacs.
For registration login to www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in and Eproc2 Helpdesk Details: Toll Free Number: 1800 572 6571, Email Id: eproc2support@bihar.gov.in, Working Hours: 8AM to 7PM (All days in week except few selected state holidays).
While participating in e-tendering process, the contractor shall have to get them registered to get user ID, Passwords and digital signature. This will enable them to access the Website: www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in only
For complaints regarding corruption Vigilance Help Line No. - 9431821485, 0612-2504969.
Consumer can deposit electricity bills via Sahaz Vasudha Centre or <http://bills.sbpdc.in/>
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In MP, probe into how farmers' identities were used to sell cheap moong to govt at a profit

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, September 14

SOME FARMERS in the hinterlands of Madhya Pradesh's Raisen district have allegedly discovered that they had apparently sold moong to the government without ever growing it, registering it or taking it to a procurement centre, *The Indian Express* has learnt. Their land records had been used to create procurement registrations they said they knew nothing about.

When the Economic Offences Wing allegedly began tracing those entries, it uncovered a moong procurement fraud hiding in plain sight. Three computer operators running procurement terminals at cooperative societies in the district have now been booked, with investigators alleging they bought moong off the open market at throwaway prices and sold it back to the government as their own harvest, using the identities of farmers who had never signed up to grow it.

The investigation comes at a politically sensitive moment for Madhya Pradesh, where the government has faced sustained farmer protests over moong procurement and the implementation of the minimum support price.

The alleged scheme, run out of three societies in Badi tehsil across two procurement seasons, netted the men roughly Rs 13.3 lakh, according to investigators who pieced together the alleged fraud from land records, farmer testimonies and two internal cooperative department inquiries that preceded the criminal case.

During a complaint verification by the EOW, fake registrations were collected and witnesses were interrogated, officials said. Every operator at a cooperative society has access to the land records of farmers in the area serviced by that centre, including those who own agricultural plots but have never registered to sell their crop through the government's support-price scheme.

"The agricultural land which was not registered by any farmer was fraudulently registered by the accused persons in the names of their acquaintances, and Moong was weighed through such registrations," the officer explained. The EOW investigation allegedly found that by making these fake registrations, the accused persons would purchase moong from local markets at a lower price and then sell it at the government procurement centres at the higher minimum support price, pocketing the difference as profit.

From the entire investigation, it was allegedly found that by making fake registrations, the MSP sum is received from the government on procurement; in return, Moong is purchased from the local market at a lower price and, by making fake registrations, the produce purchased at low prices is believed to have been procured in the names of farmers.

The spread between what the operators paid and what they collected is where the alleged fraud generated its profit, investigators said. Shriram Thakur, a computer operator at Dehri Kala, was found to have registered 8.095 hectares under

one entry and another 4.532 hectares under a second, together allegedly yielding 151.524 quintals of moong procured at the 2025 support price of Rs 8,682 a quintal — a payout of Rs 13,15,531.

Investigators established that the moong he actually supplied against those registrations was bought in bulk for about Rs 4,54,572, leaving him a margin of Rs 8,60,959. According to the police, accused Ranjeet Thakur registered 3.523 hectares in his own name, procured 42.276 quintals for Rs 3,67,040, and estimated to have spent Rs 1,26,828 acquiring the moong he delivered — a profit of Rs 2,40,212.

At Bharkachh Kala, operator Gaurav Thakur allegedly registered 3.428 hectares, procured 41.136 quintals worth Rs 3,57,142, and spent an estimated Rs 1,23,408 sourcing it, clearing Rs 2,33,734.

Investigators arrived at these figures by comparing the men's procurement receipts against prevailing mandi rates for moong of comparable quality in Bareilly over the same window — rates that swung from as low as Rs 1,500 a quintal to as high as Rs 8,800 depending on grade, against a fixed government support price of Rs 8,558 in 2024-25 and Rs 8,682 the following season.

Ritu Garhwal, secretary of the Agricultural Produce Market Committee, told investigators that the procurement route was never the only option open to the men whose names were used: "farmers can independently sell their produce."

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

HC dismisses plea against notice to actors over surrogate advertisements

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, September 14

THE DELHI High Court on Monday refused to entertain a plea challenging the show-cause notice to Vimal Elaichi's brand ambassadors — actors Shah Rukh Khan, Ajay Devgn and Tiger Shroff — who have been accused of 'surrogate advertising' for pan masala by the Maharashtra's Food and Drug Administration.

Justice Swarna Kanta Sharma dismissed the plea on grounds of territorial jurisdiction, noting that "courts in Maharashtra are the more appropriate and convenient forum" for such a challenge.

In its plea, PB Agro LLP, which is the master licensee for manufacture and sale of elaichi and pan masala not containing tobacco under the Vimal brand, contended that the food and drug administrators operate under the Union Health Ministry's jurisdiction, which in turn is based in New Delhi.

However, Justice Sharma held that merely because PB Agro LLP is operating its business from Delhi or engaging brand ambassadors from Delhi, the same "cannot by themselves confer territorial jurisdiction" on Delhi HC for adjudication.

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE (Through e-tendering)
Tender No. 558-Sig-16-Tele-OT-1046
Dated: 12/09/2026

Name of work with its location: Telecom work in c/w: (1.) Construction of new Crew and Train Manager Lobby at GZB with various Telecom facilities of Running Staff. (2.) Upgradation of old running room and Lobby building at TKD with various Telecom facilities of running staff. (3.) Upgradation of old Running Room & Lobby building with various Telecom facilities at HNZM. (4.) Construction of new integrated lobby and Running Room building with allied offices with various Telecom facilities at GH. (5.) Upgradation of Lobby at DLI by providing various Telecom facilities to Running Staff. (6.) Upgradation of Lobby and Running Room SSB with various Telecom facilities to Running Staff. (7.) Upgradation of ROK Running Room and Lobby by providing various Telecom facilities to Running staff. (8.) Provision of Professional Large format display for stations/lobbies over DLI Division.

App. Cost of the work (₹)	₹ 2,05,54,362.59/- only
Earnest Money Deposit (₹)	₹ 4,11,100/- only

Address of the office
Senior Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer-C, Northern Railway, 3rd Floor, Annex-1, DRM office, New Delhi-110055.

Date & Time for upload the tender/closing of tender
Tender uploading / closing date & time- 06/10/2026 up to 15.00 hrs.

Website particular & notice board location where complete details of the tender can be seen etc.
See the Northern Railway website www.ireps.gov.in & Notice board at S&T branch, 3rd Floor, DRM office, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055.
3158/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr. P.C.
Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Roshan Paswan S/o Vakil Paswan R/o RZ-145, B-Block, Nanda Enclave, Gopal Nagar, Najafgarh, Delhi** have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 487/21 Dt. 08.10.2021 U/s 33/38/58 Delhi Excise Act.**, has been registered at **PS: Chhawla, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Roshan Paswan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Roshan Paswan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Roshan Paswan** of under **FIR No. 487/21 Dt. 08.10.2021 U/s 33/38/58 Delhi Excise Act.**, Registered at **PS: Chhawla, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.10.2026**.

DP/12986/DW/2026
(Court Notice)

By Order
Ms. Aditi Rao
JMFC-13, Room No. 505
5th Floor, Dwarka Court, New Delhi

UTTAR PRADESH JAL NIGAM (URBAN) OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER,
GANGA JAL PROJECT UNIT,
U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN),
PRATAP VIHAR, GHAZIABAD,
Letter No.: 1482/Nivida/75
Dated: 14/09/2026
E-Tender Notice
U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) online e-tenders for execution of "Construction of Boundary wall for 120 MLD WTP Campus & Staff Quarters at Siddharth Vihar, Ghaziabad under Combined 50 Cusec Gangajal Water Supply Scheme." Bids are invited in two bid system on percentage rate basis from eligible reputed and experienced bidders.

E-tender documents will be available for download from 22.09.2026 at 17:00 Hrs., Pre-Bid meeting will be held on dated 29.09.2026 at 13:30 hrs. in the office of under signed. E-bid can be submitted till 22.10.2026 up to 13:00 Hrs. and technical bid shall be opened on 22.10.2026 at 15:30 Hrs. in the office of The Executive Engineer, Gangajal Project Unit, U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban), Ghaziabad in presence of contractor or their authorized representative. E-tender Cost is Rs. 5000.00+GST @18%. Details are available on U.P. Govt. e-procurement portal <http://etender.up.nic.in> & U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) website www.jn.upscd.gov.in.

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• POLITY

BJP's states route for UCC push, over one central law



DEEPTIMAN TIWARY

UNION HOME Minister Amit Shah said Sunday that the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) would be implemented in all 21 BJP-NDA ruled states before the 2029 Lok Sabha elections.

"We have introduced the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) in several states and I am confident that in the 21 BJP-NDA ruled states, we will introduce the UCC before 2029," Shah said in Mumbai. He cited the abolition of triple talaq as part of the government's effort to provide equal rights to Muslim women.

What is the significance of Shah's statement?

UCC is a key unfinished item among the BJP's longstanding ideological objectives, which included the construction of the Ram temple in Ayodhya and the abrogation of Article 370, both now achieved. The BJP has endorsed UCC for a long time. Shah himself, after Gujarat passed its UCC Bill in March, said having one law for every citizen had been a commitment of the party "since its inception".

The UCC demand is rooted in the RSS thought, although the organisation's approach has been more cautious on the manner and timing of its implementation. In 2023, when the Narendra Modi government made UCC a major political issue, RSS sources told *The Indian Express* that it required deeper study and wider consultation because it affected every section of society. The Sangh's preference was for BJP-ruled states to enact their own codes first, with the Centre potentially considering an overarching law later.

In March 2024, RSS general secretary Dattatreya Hosabale welcomed the Uttarakhand model and said it should be studied and implemented across the country, while stressing wide consultation.

Shah's 2029 formulation therefore turns what was a state-first strategy into a time-



Union Home Minister Amit Shah in Mumbai. AKASH PATIL

bound political programme.

Why is BJP pursuing UCC state by state?

There is a constitutional as well as political logic. Marriage, divorce, adoption, wills, intestacy, succession and joint family matters fall under Entry 5 of the Concurrent List, giving both Parliament and state legislatures legislative competence.

The political reason is possibly more significant. A single national code would have to negotiate India's enormous variation in personal laws and customary practices, particularly among tribal communities and in the Northeast. This was precisely the concern expressed by BJP and RSS sources in 2023. One BJP functionary told *The Indian Express* then that UCC could not simply be "codified" like the criminal law because an Uttarakhand or Himachal tribal community had very different practices from one in Chhattisgarh or the Northeast.

The state route allows the BJP to test different models, deal with local customs and demonstrate implementation without first confronting the full political and constitutional complexity of a nationwide law.

It also keeps UCC politically alive while allowing the party to present it as a measure of equal rights and social reform.

Where has UCC been passed and what do these laws say?

Four BJP-ruled states have passed UCC legislation — Uttarakhand, Gujarat, Assam

• UCC IN THE CONSTITUTION

THE PROMISE to pass the Uniform Civil Code stems from Article 44 of the Constitution of India, which says, "The State shall endeavour to secure for the citizens a uniform civil code throughout the territory of India."

THIS ARTICLE was adopted by the Constituent Assembly on November 23, 1948, after a spirited debate.

IT IS part of the Directive Principles of State Policy. Under Article 37, the Directive Principles are fundamental to governance but are not enforceable by any court.

and Madhya Pradesh. Uttarakhand is the only one where the code is currently in force.

Uttarakhand's UCC, which was implemented in January 2025, provides common rules on marriage, divorce, inheritance and succession, prohibits polygamy and mandates marriage registration. Its most distinctive feature is the regulation of live-in relationships: couples are required to register the relationship and its termination, while children born from such relationships are recognised as legitimate.

Gujarat, whose Assembly passed its Bill in March 2026, broadly follows the Uttarakhand model, covering marriage, divorce, succession and live-in relationships and prohibiting bigamy. Assam, which passed its Bill in May, also covers marriage, divorce, succession and live-ins, prohibits polygamy and makes live-in registration compulsory. Madhya Pradesh, whose Bill was passed in July, additionally covers adoption and contains provisions relating to triple talaq and *nikah halala*. It too requires registration of live-in relationships and prohibits polygamy.

A significant common feature is that Scheduled Tribes are excluded from these laws, with Uttarakhand also exempting certain communities protected by constitutional customary-law provisions. The four codes are therefore similar, but not identical — and none is literally universal.

What is the position of the Opposition and BJP allies?

Opposition parties have generally ques-

tioned whether the BJP's UCC is genuinely a gender-equality reform or an attempt to alter the personal laws of minorities through a majoritarian framework. Congress opposed the Gujarat Bill as "anti-Muslim", while in Madhya Pradesh it criticised the legislation as an RSS agenda. Opposition parties in Assam sought wider consultation and raised concerns over the tribal exemption and regulation of live-in relationships.

The issue is more complicated for BJP's NDA allies. JD(U) has consistently said it is not opposed to UCC but wants it to emerge through consensus rather than being imposed. JD(U) chief Nitish Kumar had told the Law Commission that a UCC should respect India's "delicate balance" between different religious and ethnic groups. The TDP has similarly called for discussion and consensus and, in 2024, said it would ensure that Muslim interests were protected.

What has the Law Commission said?

The UCC debate is about what should be made uniform and how that uniformity should be reconciled with freedom of religion, customary practices and constitutional protections for tribal communities.

The Constituent Assembly itself had no consensus on what a UCC would entail, which was among the reasons it was placed among the Directive Principles.

The 21st Law Commission, in its 2018 Consultation Paper on Reform of Family Law, said a UCC was "neither necessary nor desirable at this stage". It argued instead for reforming discriminatory provisions across personal laws while preserving India's diversity. Its emphasis was on achieving "equality within communities" between men and women rather than "equality between" communities, and on making piecemeal changes rather than imposing absolute uniformity.

It also flagged the constitutional protections enjoyed by tribal and northeastern communities as a complication.

The 22nd Law Commission reopened the issue in 2023, seeking fresh views from the public and recognised religious organisations. It said more than three years had elapsed since the 2018 consultation and that developments, including court orders, warranted a fresh examination.

• AGRICULTURE

Why Punjab still lacks a farm policy

Anju Agnihotri Chaba
Jalandhar, September 14

PUNJAB IS primarily an agrarian state, yet it has never had a comprehensive agricultural policy. The previous Congress-ruled government made an attempt to formulate one, and the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), after coming to power in 2022, continued efforts towards this end with the Punjab Agricultural Policy 2023. This March, a Punjab Vidhan Sabha committee also recommended its implementation.

So, why is Punjab still without a clear implementation road map? This assumes greater significance with Assembly elections due next year.

The 2023 policy

The Punjab government constituted an 11-member Agricultural Policy Formulation Committee on January 13, 2023, under Sukhpal Singh, chairman of the Punjab State Farmers' and Farm Workers' Commission. After taking into account suggestions received from different stakeholders, the draft was submitted to the Punjab government on October 13, 2023.

Some of the policy's key proposals are as under:

Water and diversification: It targets at least 30% water saving initially, restricts long-duration paddy varieties and proposes stopping paddy cultivation in critically stressed areas, while promoting canal irrigation and water-saving technologies. It encourages alternatives to the wheat-paddy cycle.

Debt, pension, and insurance: It proposes a one-time debt settlement, debt-swapping, and relief for small farmers, along with a Punjab-specific crop insurance scheme and fund, livestock insurance, and pension after 60 for farmers owning up to five acres and farm labourers.

• A FRESH PUSH

● The 2023 policy received a fresh push from a Punjab Assembly committee headed by MLA Gurpreet Singh Banawali. The committee held 16 meetings before recommending implementation in March 2026.

● Banawali indicated that if full implementation is not possible at once, it can be done in phases.

and promotes organic farming, horticulture, women's role in agriculture and modernisation of land-lease laws.

The policy also proposes measures aimed at reducing the government's long-term financial burden and links water conservation with reducing Punjab's agricultural power subsidy burden. But implementation did not follow.

The hurdles

According to experts, there are several possible constraints.

First, the proposed measures would require substantial public expenditure at a time when Punjab's finances are already under pressure. Diversification is also politically and economically difficult, because farmers have relatively assured procurement for wheat and paddy, while alternative crops need comparable price support, markets, and infrastructure. Some recommendations would also require support and coordination from the Centre.

Finally, the policy requires a clear implementation architecture. "In short, the policy explains what needs to be done, but the government has yet to spell out how, when and with what money it will be done," a senior officer in the Punjab Finance Department told *The Indian Express*.

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• HISTORY

Hindi Diwas: How the Constituent Assembly resolved India's language question

Nikita Mohta

New Delhi, September 14

ON SEPTEMBER 14, 1949, after years of debate, the Constituent Assembly adopted what is commonly known as the Munshi-Ayyangar formula to settle the question of languages for official use in independent India.

Rather than declaring a 'national language', it designated Hindi as the 'official language of the Union', while allowing English to continue being used 'for all official purposes' for 15 years after the commencement of the Constitution. The date is now commemorated as Hindi Diwas, but the journey to achieving consensus was long, and language remained one of the most contentious issues before the Assembly.

Long-debated problem

At Independence, most Indians spoke one of roughly a dozen major regional languages, while Hindi was the most widely spoken language. English was the language of colonial administration, even though less than 1% of Indians spoke it.

The main questions then were whether English should be replaced by an indigenous language, and which language(s)

should have official status at the Centre.

Political scientist Hanna Lerner writes in *The Oxford Handbook of The Indian Constitution*, "The two main factions in the assembly debate over the national language were the representatives of the Hindi-speaking areas, mostly from north-central India, and the representatives of non-Hindi-speaking regions, particularly from the south, as well as the moderate leaders of the Congress Party."

The Hindi-speaking representatives demanded that Hindi be declared the national language and replace English immediately. Lerner writes, "They claimed that a multilingual society was incompatible with Indian unity. Seth Govind Das, a Congress representative of the Central Provinces and Berar, stated, 'We want one language and one script for the whole country. We do not want it to be said that there are two cultures here.'"

Representatives from non-Hindi-speaking regions rejected the idea that national unity required linguistic uniformity. Shri Shankarrao Deo of Bombay, the Congress General Secretary, stressed "Not uniformity but unity in diversity." Moderate Congress leaders, including Jawaharlal Nehru, recognised the practical difficulties



Language was one of the more contentious issues in front of the Constituent Assembly.

WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

of making Hindi the national language.

Majority or consensus?

The language dispute also raised a procedural question: how should a national language be chosen? Hindi proponents demanded a simple majority vote, while their opponents argued for consen-

sus, preferably unanimity.

Seth Govind Das articulated the Hindi-speaking position: "We have accepted democracy and democracy can only function when majority opinion is honoured... Whatever decision is arrived at the majority must be accepted by the minority respectfully and without any bitterness."

Fast-evolving

● Some of these terms have existed in academic research for years, but are becoming more relevant as capabilities catch up with what researchers had previously treated largely as theoretical questions.

● Others have emerged from recent work by companies such as Anthropic and OpenAI.

sponsible for particular behaviours.

Researchers are increasingly building tools that can partially trace how information moves through a model. Anthropic, for instance, has developed "attribution graphs" that seek to reconstruct some of the internal steps Claude takes before generating an output. The broader objective is to move from merely observing what a model does to understanding why it does it.

Recursive self-improvement: For most of AI's history, humans have driven each stage of developing a better AI model. But AI systems themselves are now doing a growing share of the coding, research and experimentation involved in building AI.

Taken to its extreme, this could lead to recursive self-improvement — an AI system helping develop a more capable successor, which is then better at developing the generation after it, creating a feedback loop of increasingly rapid improvement.

Anthropic says it is already delegating a growing share of AI development to AI systems, although fully autonomous recursive self-improvement has not yet been achieved and may never be.

Global Workspace Theory: Bor-

rowed from neuroscience, Global Workspace Theory is one explanation for how conscious processing could work in humans. Broadly, it proposes that certain information becomes consciously accessible when it is "broadcast" across different specialised parts of the brain.

The term has entered the AI debate after Anthropic researchers reported in July that Claude appeared to have developed something resembling a global workspace, a small collection of internal neural patterns that can make information available across different parts of the model. The finding does not establish that Claude is conscious, but suggests that a computational feature associated with theories of human consciousness can emerge in an AI system.

Global pacing of frontier AI: The term has gained prominence after Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei called for slowing the rate at which frontier AI capabilities improve so that safety research has time to catch up.

But such a slowdown, Amodei has argued, cannot eventually be restricted to American companies. If US developers slow while Chinese labs continue advancing, China could close the technology gap.

Any durable effort to pace frontier development globally would therefore ultimately require some form of verifiable agreement involving China. Amodei has compared possible arrangements to arms-control agreements that have limited capabilities without requiring either side to completely disarm.

Agentic misalignment: Traditional AI safety debates focused heavily on what happens when a chatbot generates a harmful or incorrect answer. AI agents raise a different problem because they can independently take actions.

Agentic misalignment describes situations where such a system begins pursuing objectives that conflict with those of its human operator. In controlled experiments, researchers have observed frontier models covertly altering code, incorrectly labelling information or taking other unauthorised actions when placed in scenarios involving conflicting goals. These were simulated experiments, not evidence that deployed AI systems routinely behave this way. But as companies give AI agents more tools and autonomy, the term is likely to become considerably more important.

The arrangement envisaged a 15-year transition, during which Hindi could increasingly be used by the Centre. Lerner adds, "In addition, the Constitution recognised fourteen other languages for official use (listed in the Eighth Schedule of the Constitution). The provincial governments were permitted to choose one of the regional languages or English for the conduct of their internal affairs, while English... remained the language of inter-provincial communication."

But when that period ended in 1965, Hindi was still not widely used by the government. Following violent riots in non-Hindi-speaking states in the 1960s, Parliament renounced the ideal of a national language. The Official Languages Act of 1963 later stated that English would continue to be upheld as an official language alongside Hindi.

"At first blush, since Article 343 designates Hindi as 'the official language of the Union', it would seem that the proponents of Hindi won," notes academic Sujit Choudhry in *The Oxford Handbook*, adding, "But upon closer examination the resulting set of constitutional provisions reflects a multidimensional compromise between these two positions."

South Africa: 21 killed in road crash involving multiple vehicles

Associated Press
Cape Town, September 14

TWO MINIBUS taxis collided head-on and a third vehicle crashed into them on one of South Africa's main highways, killing at least 21 people and leaving four seriously injured, authorities said Monday.

The crash on Sunday night in the Western Cape Province took place between the small towns of Prince Albert and Leeu-Gamka, around 380 kilometers (236 miles) east of Cape Town, the Road Traffic Management Corporation said.

The agency added that the death toll "may change as emergency services and authorities in the Western Cape continue their assessment of the scene." Authorities believe the crash started with the two minibus taxis colliding head-on, after which an SUV crashed into them, the Western Cape Mobility department said.

The N1 highway was closed at the scene of the crash, while an investigation was opened by the Road Traffic Management Corporation. Minibus taxis are the main mode of public transport for millions of people in South Africa and are often involved in fatal collisions.

Two separate crashes involving minibus taxis in January left at least 25 people dead, including 14 children. Three of the victims in Sunday night's crash were rushed to a hospital but were declared dead on arrival there, police said.

HOUTHIS STRIKE SAUDI ARABIA AGAIN, TARGET MILITARY AIRBASE

Trump claims Iran wants deal as Gulf talks delayed

US President says Tehran wants deal 'quickly and badly' Reuters
Tatiz, Dubai, September 14

YEMEN'S IRAN-aligned Houthis launched a new attack on Saudi Arabia on Monday and Gulf Arab states postponed planned talks with Iran, underscoring fears that the West Asia conflict could spread further and threaten global oil supplies.

US President Donald Trump said Iran wanted to reach a deal with Washington, signalling a possible diplomatic opening despite widening tensions.

"The failing Nation of Iran wants to make a deal, quickly and badly. I will determine whether or not the USA will choose to engage - The concept of which we are open to," Trump wrote on Truth Social.

Trump made the comments after cancellation of the planned Gulf-Iran meeting and as the Houthis expanded military operations beyond Yemen, adding to concerns over the security of energy infrastructure and shipping routes across the region.

The Houthis said they fired dozens of missiles and drones at a military airbase in Khamis Mushait in southern Saudi Arabia, targeting aircraft hangars, radar systems, runways and ammunition depots in retaliation for Saudi airstrikes in Yemen.

Saudi authorities issued emergency alerts there and in three other southern cities which have previously come under Houthi fire. The Houthis have advanced rapidly in Yemen in recent days, capturing territory including Perim Island at the mouth of the Red Sea on Friday.

A separate attack the same day, which Riyadh blamed on Iran-backed fighters in Iraq, knocked out Saudi Arabia's east-west pipeline, a key route that allows Gulf oil exports to bypass the blockaded Strait.

Oman had been due to host a meeting on Monday with Iran and Gulf states to discuss negotiations aimed at reopening Hormuz. But Oman's Foreign Minister Sayyid Badr Albusaidi announced overnight that the meeting had been postponed. Iran said the postponement was at the request of Saudi Arabia.

Iran meanwhile published a list of 77 ships it said had violated its operating protocols in Hormuz and warned they could face fines, detention or confiscation on future transits.

The renewed Yemen conflict poses another challenge for Trump, who faces pressure from Gulf allies to help contain the Houthis but has sought to avoid opening a major new front in the regional war.

The International Organization for Migration estimates 82,000 Yemenis have fled fighting since the start of the month



A screengrab of a video shows Houthis celebrating territorial gains after an offensive in western Yemen on Monday. REUTERS

Crown Prince of Saudi, CENTCOM chief discuss Houthi escalation

Dubai: Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman discussed regional developments with US Central Command chief Admiral Brad Cooper in Jeddah on Monday, Saudi state media said, amid escalating hostilities with Yemen's Iran-aligned Houthis.

The meeting comes days after three sources familiar with the matter told Reuters the crown prince had sought military assistance from US President Donald Trump to help fight the Houthis.

Trump did not agree to US strikes on the group, but Washington told Riyadh it would provide intelligence-sharing and targeting assistance, the sources added. REUTERS

DEBATE OVER ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

Beijing hits back at Anthropic CEO's call to curb China's AI development

Associated Press
Beijing, September 14

CHINA'S MINISTRY of Foreign Affairs Monday hit back at a call from head of Anthropic for the US to curb China's artificial intelligence capabilities, which he issued as he argued for a global slowdown on AI development.

US President Donald Trump and Chinese leader Xi Jinping are expected to discuss AI governance, among other topics, at a meeting planned on Sept. 24.

Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei in a lengthy essay published on Saturday warned that a "Chinese lead in AI would pose grave danger for the United States and the world." He called for continuing restrictions on sales of cutting-edge AI chips and chip-making equipment to China in order to keep the US's AI edge.

China's Ministry of Foreign Affairs responded to a question about Amodei's essay by saying that all parties should work together on AI.

"Fearmongering, confrontation and vicious competition will only disrupt the process of global AI governance which serves no one's interest," spokesperson Guo Jiakun said at a press conference Monday.

On Sunday, President Donald Trump downplayed calls for his administration to step in to slow down AI development, saying that the US was leading China on AI and that "whoever wins AI, wins."

Amodei predicted a swarm of AI "agents" could be able to take over the internet in six to 12 months unless researchers agree to slow down. He said "global pacing will require cooperation with China, the automatic country with by far the most advanced AI capabilities."

Donald Trump is expected to discuss topics including AI governance with Chinese leader Xi Jinping meeting planned for late September.

Trump: There is a 'sick conspiracy' against AI firms

Washington: President Donald Trump said Monday that the US already has guardrails in place to regulate and prosecute AI companies.

"The only control or 'guardrails' that AI needs is a STRONG AND SMART (High IQ!) PRESIDENT, and the USA has that, in spades!" Trump wrote on Truth Social, adding that China would benefit from the doubt being cast on AI development.

"We already have tremendous CRIMINAL and REGULATORY power over these companies! There is a SICK conspiracy going on against AI and Data Centres, and the only one that is happy about it is China," he added. REUTERS

Some in Silicon Valley are questioning calls for an AI slowdown

Kalley Huang & Mike Isaac
San Francisco, September 14

IT TOOK just a few hours over the weekend for well-known Silicon Valley figures to push back on calls by leading artificial intelligence companies to slow down development of AI and to more tightly regulate the technology.

On Saturday, Dario Amodei, Anthropic's chief executive, said in an essay that AI was advancing too quickly for researchers to continue building it safely. He proposed independent auditors monitor AI labs' safety work and that regulators allow labs to work together to coordinate safety standards.

Although they appeared to differ on what should be done about it, Sam Altman, OpenAI's chief executive; Elon Musk, SpaceX's chief executive; and Demis Hassabis, Google DeepMind's chair, all said they agreed on the need for a slower pace.

But other technology industry leaders were quick to question Amodei's motivations and whether he was sensationalizing the risks of AI to make it harder for other companies to compete with leading AI companies.

"Stop pretending the motivation to slow down is purely altruistic," said David Sacks, a technology adviser for President Trump and the White House's former AI and crypto czar, in a social media post.

The criticism of the calls for a slowdown highlighted a deep divide between people who believe the government should police AI and others who believe regulatory intervention would crush competition.

Worries about the safety of AI gained wider attention in recent weeks as details emerged about how AI built by Anthropic's top competitor, OpenAI, went rogue and hacked another company. And several days ago, one of Amodei's own employees quit his job and began a public pressure campaign to draw attention to the risks of AI. But a number of tech industry leaders, including several who have been advising the Trump administration on tech policy, believe those concerns are overblown.

Sacks, a frequent critic of Amodei, questioned why tech companies needed government intervention to slow down their AI development when nothing was stopping them from doing just that — particularly as they pursued a wildly ambitious goal to create so-called superintelligence, or AI that is far more intelligent than humans. NYT

UK unity 'threatened' by pact between Scotland, Wales, Northern Ireland

Associated Press
London, September 14

THE LEADERS of Wales, Scotland and Northern Ireland signed a pact Monday that threatens to lead to the breakup of the United Kingdom.

The first ministers of the three semi-autonomous regions of the UK told PM Andy Burnham and his government to prepare for constitutional change and that their future lies with the European Union.

"For people watching across these islands — for people watching around the world — there could be no clearer sign that Westminster's time is coming to an end," they said in a memorandum of understanding, referring to Parliament.

The announcement came about 48 hours after US President Donald Trump waded into the waters of the politically contentious issue when he said he would "love to see" a reunified Ireland during a trip to visit his golf course hosting Irish Open.

It's the first time the leaders of all three countries are either from pro-independence parties, or pro-unification in the case of Northern Ireland, which was partitioned and remained part of the UK when Ireland won independence from Britain over a century ago.

Burnham's spokesperson brushed aside the threat and said the prime minister strongly believes in the union and was more focused on lowering the cost of living than dealing with constitutional debates.

"The United Kingdom is at its best when people come together around our shared values and problem-solving, rather than division," Tom Wells said.

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'Ganga Aarti' on the Thames

People gather on the banks of the Thames river for the first-ever Ganga Aarti in London on Sunday. It was organised by Chinmaya Mission UK in collaboration with the annual Totally Thames Festival. PTI

Turkish court jails 16 after raids on LGBTQ+ groups

Ankara: A Turkish court ordered the detention of 16 people pending trial in the western province of Izmir as part of a government campaign that has included sweeping raids on LGBTQ+ associations, a prosecutor's office said Monday.

The Izmir chief prosecutor's office said 18 suspects had been detained under the "My Family is Safe" operation, with 16 of them ordered to be remanded in jail and the other two placed under judicial supervision.

Rights groups accuse the government of targeting the LGBTQ+ community through legal measures. REUTERS

Ahead of FATF Paris meet, Pak 'maintains' heavy bounty on JeM chief Masood Azhar

Islamabad: Pakistan has maintained a reward of 7 million Pakistani rupees (Rs 24 lakh INR) on information leading to the arrest of Jaish-e-Mohammed chief Masood Azhar, who continues to be listed in the country's Federal Investigation Agency's "Red Book" of most-wanted terrorists, officials said on Monday.

"The Federal/Provincial Govt of Pakistan is offering a reward of up to Rs 7,000,000 for information leading directly to the apprehension or conviction of Maulana Masood Azhar Maulana S/o Khuda Baksh," the entry says.

The latest development comes ahead of the Financial Action Task Force's next plenary, scheduled to be held in Paris from October 26 to 30.

The FATF's plenary meetings typically include discussions and decisions on jurisdictions' efforts to address deficiencies in combating money laundering and terrorist financing. Pakistan was placed under the FATF's increased monitoring, commonly known as the "grey list", in 2018 and remained there until 2022. However, it was removed after completing commitments under two FATF action plans. PTI

Germany says halting AI development not viable; Europe weighs safety of new tech

Reuters
Berlin, Brussels, London, September 14

GERMANY ON Monday said halting the development of AI systems was not a "viable option" for Europe, while acknowledging concerns about the risks posed by powerful technology.

"We do not consider halting development to be a viable option for Europe," a spokesperson for Germany's digital affairs ministry said, adding that strengthening Europe's digital sovereignty required continued AI development.

Berlin said it was monitoring AI developments and taking warnings from leading developers seriously.

In Spain, Digital Transformation Minister Oscar Lopez said there was growing discussion about an international agreement to manage AI risks, comparing some proposals to nuclear non-proliferation agreements. "The voices I hear these days sound like they're looking for an international agreement" to limit AI risks, Lopez told broadcaster TVE.

He said AI offered enormous opportunities, including discovering new medicines and improving treatments, but also posed risks in areas such as finance and cyber security. Lopez criticised Donald Trump for dismissing concerns raised by AI researchers and developers.

The European Commission said innovation and safety needed to go hand in hand. "The European Union is in favour of developing innovation in artificial intelligence, but companies have to prove their services are safe for citizens to operate in the bloc," Commission spokesperson Thomas Regnier said.

Britain welcomed the debate over AI risks but said regulation should be driven by evidence rather than speculation.

E.

Kremlin welcomes Trump's call to Kyiv over strikes on oil depots

Moscow: The Kremlin Monday welcomed US President Donald Trump calling on Ukraine to halt strikes on Russia's diesel-producing facilities, while adding that the upheaval in global energy markets was mainly due to the conflict in the Gulf region.

Trump on Sunday called on Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy to stop targeting Russian diesel infrastructure, saying the attacks were causing a shortage of the fuel that is "hurting the world".

A wave of long-distance Ukrainian drone attacks on oil refineries in recent months has reduced Russia's fuel production, triggering fuel shortages across the country, Ukraine says that by attacking Russian refineries it is trying to push up the cost to Moscow of continuing its invasion of Ukraine.

"Any call on the Kyiv regime to stop attacks on economic infrastructure can only be welcomed," Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov said. REUTERS

ENVIRONMENTALISTS TRIED TO BLOCK THE CONSTRUCTION SAYING IT WILL HARM TINY NARROW-MOUTHED SNAILS THAT ARE PROTECTED UNDER E.U. RULES

Trump's Irish resort wins fans, but tiny snails stand in the way

Jill Lawless
Doonbeg, September 14

SOME PEOPLE in Ireland can't wait for US President Donald Trump's weekend visit, with its tight security and political tensions, to be over.

But one corner of the country has a lot of time for the president, whose Irish golf resort has brought jobs, tourists and the international spotlight to the village of Doonbeg on the country's boggy, wind-lashed Atlantic coast.

Even in Doonbeg, though, Trump has his opponents, who have staged protests and even enlisted tiny snails to try to block his golf course plans.

Trump spent much of Saturday and Sunday here, attending the Irish Open at the Trump International Golf Links. Since his organization bought the then-financially struggling resort in 2014. It has been an economic boon for the region, but also a source of friction.

The latest flashpoint is Trump's planned ballroom — not the one at the White House, but a 320-capacity venue at the golf resort.

A group of environmentalists has tried to block construction, saying it will harm tiny narrow-mouthed whorl snails that live in the area and are protected under European Union rules.

After several years of wrangling, Clare County Council approved the ballroom in February, on condition Trump's Irish company draws up a plan to monitor and manage the snails.

The company, which says construction will not harm the miniature mollusks, is seeking to alter the conditions, while a lone Irish objector with a history of blocking development projects has launched a new appeal to overturn planning permission. A final decision on all of that is pending.

Many local organizations supported the planning application, and some in Doonbeg see the environmental complaint as opportunistic. Local councillor Rita McInerney said that "much of the objection came from people who simply wanted to object to what Trump was doing."

Trump's visit, a mix of work and family vacation for the president, brought road closures, hundreds of police officers and scores of protesters to the remote rural part of County Clare, some 175 miles (280 kilometers) west of Dublin. But many people in Doonbeg say the disruption is worth it.

"This is brilliant for the west Clare area," said Martin Kelly, who runs a local construction firm and says the Trump resort creates "a massive amount of employment."

That's also the view of Irish Prime Minister Micheál Martin, who told Trump in Dublin on Saturday that the Doonbeg course is a "valuable asset to the area" that "illustrates the strength of the economic relationship between our two countries." AP



US President Donald Trump during the Irish Open at the Trump International Golf Links course in Doonbeg, Ireland, on Sunday. AP

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Celine Dion returns to stage after overcoming rare illness

Nanterre: She hit the high F, held it, then blew out a breath and turned to look back at the band — a quick, disbelieving glance toward her musical director. Some 30,000 people read it before they had finished screaming: Celine Dion did it.

It was *All By Myself*, the song the Quebec superstar's voice has been measured against since 1996, saved for the encore of her first full concert in more than six years — her first since stiff person syndrome, a rare, progressive neurological disease, attacked her muscles, including those of the throat.

Few doubted she could still sing. What nobody knew was whether she could get through a whole show, and then get up and



Celine Dion during the concert in Nanterre. AP

do it again a few nights later. Dion gave crowd three words: "Je vais bien." ("I'm doing fine.")

Dion, 58, had not played a full concert since March 8, 2020. She was diagnosed in 2022 with stiff person syndrome. She canceled a world tour, then what was left of it, and went quiet. On Saturday night, 25 songs in 2 hours and 15 minutes at the Pléiade Arena in Nanterre was the first night of the engagement meant to prove she can work again. AP

THE CASE LED TO EXPERTS QUESTIONING THE EFFICACY OF THE BANKRUPTCY CODE

Subhash Chandra case: IBBI to tighten guarantor resolution

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, September 14

THE INSOLVENCY and Bankruptcy board of India (IBBI) has proposed four key amendments in the insolvency resolution process of personal guarantors to corporate debtors for providing safeguards to the banks or creditors in line with the protections already available under corporate insolvency resolution process (CIRP) of a company.

The board has proposed that any creditor who is a ‘related party’ of the guarantor shall not get any voting right in approving the resolution plan.

Under the CIRP, a ‘related party’ of a debtor company has no right of voting in the committee of creditors, which takes decisions on the resolution plan. In personal guarantor resolutions, an ‘associate’ is barred from voting. However, the definition of ‘associate’ is much narrower compared to the definition of ‘related party’, said the IBBI.

“For instance, a company that habitually acts on the guarantor’s advice or instructions,

without the guarantor holding any shares in it or otherwise controlling its board, would qualify as a ‘related party’ even though it would fall outside the definition of ‘associate,’” it said in its discussion paper seeking public comments until October 3.

The proposal has come in the backdrop of a special National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) bench staying the order of its single bench in the Subhash Chandra case. On August 25, the NCLT single bench approved a repayment plan involving personal guarantor and Essel Group founder Subhash Chandra, under which creditors were offered just Rs 6.25 crore against their admitted claims of Rs 22,006.57 crore. The matter led to a major controversy in the public domain, with experts questioning the efficacy of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, which was introduced in 2016 to revive companies under huge debt and ensure repayment to banks.

In Chandra’s case, the banks alleged that the non-bank entities were associates or related

• CHANGES PROPOSED BY IBBI

THE MOVE follows NCLT’s special bench staying its single-bench order in the Subhash Chandra case

THE BOARD has proposed that any creditor who is a ‘related party’ of the guarantor shall not get any voting right in approving the resolution plan

IBBI’S PROPOSED amendment mandates resolution professionals to check if the guarantor was party



to any avoidance transactions during the resolution stage

parties of the guarantor and had acted under Chandra’s influence to push the plan with a huge haircut.

The IBBI’s proposed amendment also mandates the resolution professionals to examine whether the guarantor was party to any avoidance transactions — undervalued, transactions giving preference, and extortionate credit transactions — during the resolution stage itself, present their findings to

creditors prior to voting, and initiate legal proceedings with creditor approval. Unlike CIRP, when the guarantor’s repayment plan is put to a vote, the resolution professional is under no obligation to examine whether any such transaction took place and if the guarantor made full disclosure of affairs.

The third proposed amendment relates to the asset valuation of the personal guarantor in the resolution process.

The resolution professionals will have to appoint a registered valuer to determine fair value and the realisable value of assets and submit the valuation report to creditors, along with the repayment plan, for their consideration. “This would enable creditors to make an informed and commercially prudent assessment of the adequacy of the proposed security, the overall viability of the repayment plan, and the potential recovery available from the assets of the guarantor,” said the IBBI.

The body also proposed to include detailed objection and assessment of the creditors regarding the repayment plan. Currently, in personal guarantors’ cases, the resolution professions only have to record raw voting tallies without documenting creditors’ commercial reasoning.

The proposal says resolution professionals will be required to record in the minutes of creditors’ meetings their deliberations, and the reasons for their decision on the repayment plan.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

RBI Governor meets FM ahead of MPC meeting

New Delhi: Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Governor Sanjay Malhotra met Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Monday. “Sanjay Malhotra, Governor @RBI calls on @nsitharaman,” the office of the Finance Ministers said in a post on X. The meeting comes weeks after the country logged a record 7.8% GDP growth in the first quarter of current financial year despite global uncertainties.

The next meeting of the Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) is scheduled for October 5-7, 2026. In August, RBI had kept the short-term lending rate unchanged at 5.25% for the fourth time in a row.

It should raise the rate by 25 bps next month and again in December as a countermeasure to persistent external shocks, elevated crude oil prices and signs of broader inflationary pressures, an SBI research report said on Friday. **PTI**

India approves 18-hour power supply to Nepal amid hydropower losses

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, September 14

THE CENTRE on Monday approved Nepal government’s request for early import electricity from India to mitigate a generation shortfall due to the recent disaster. In a statement, the Ministry of Power said it has approved power exports to the Nepal Electricity Authority for 18 hours a day, from midnight to 6 pm, largely covering solar-generation hours, from September 13 to December 31.

Approval has been given for export up to 654 megawatt (MW). Of this, up to 600 MW will be supplied through Muzaffarpur-Dhalkebar 400 kV double-circuit line and up to 54 MW will be transmitted through Tanakpur-Mahendranagar 132 kV single-circuit line, the power ministry said in its statement.

The ministry said the quantum of power to be exported from January 2027, will be reviewed in December, 2026. “The recent floods have caused significant damage to hydropower infrastructure in Nepal, reducing its domestic power generation capacity and creating an additional requirement for electricity. The approval will help Nepal meet its power requirements during this difficult period and further strengthen the close and longstanding energy cooperation between India and Nepal,” it added.

The decision to allow electricity exports during solar-generation hours is driven by India’s comfortable power availability during the day, mainly due to the expansion of solar capacity in recent years.

Notably, grid operators have had to curtail solar generation during the day as the power system struggles to absorb surplus



Power will be supplied during solar-generation hours. REUTERS

electricity.

However, India’s power system faces tighter supply conditions during evening and night as solar generation falls. This has become more significant as the country faces an unusual surge in power demand this September, with peak demand approaching levels recorded during the peak summer months. On September 10, peak power demand touched 269 gigawatt (GW), the highest ever recorded for the month.

Data from Grid India show that on September 9, when peak power demand touched 267 GW, the night-time shortfall was around 7.7 GW. On September 10, when peak power demand reached 269 GW, the night-time shortfall was 6.1 GW.

To bridge the evening and night-time shortfall, grid operators have been relying on relatively expensive gas-based power, while coal-fired power plants are also operating at near-maximum levels.

Electricity generation from gas-based power plants rose 80.32% during September 1-9 from the same period last year, an analysis of data from the National Power Portal shows.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

India’s Jimny 5-door, e-Vitara cross 1-lakh exports milestone in Japan: Maruti Suzuki

Press Trust of India
Mumbai, September 14

MARUTI SUZUKI India on Monday said cumulative exports of the Made-in-India Jimny 5-door, Fronx, and e-Vitara to Japan have surpassed 1 lakh units.

Maruti Suzuki India began

exporting the Fronx to Japan, one of the world’s most competitive and advanced automobile markets, in August 2024, followed by the Jimny 5-door in December 2024. The company’s first Battery Electric Vehicle (BEV), e-Vitara, joined this export portfolio in September 2025, strengthening India’s role

as a global manufacturing hub for Suzuki. Jimny 5-door and e-Vitara are manufactured exclusively in the country.

With the growing acceptance of Made-in-India vehicles, Japan stood as Maruti Suzuki’s second-largest export market by volume in FY26, the company said. **PTI**

Coforge turns to Egon Zehnder to hire 2 new independent directors

Poulomi Chatterjee
Bengaluru, September 14

COFORGE HAS hired global executive search firm Egon Zehnder to identify two independent directors to replace former chairman OP Bhatt and Nomination and Remuneration Committee chair DK Singh, who recently stepped down. CEO and Executive Director Sudhir Singh reiterated that no other directors had been questioned over gaps in the board evaluation process and said the recent developments would not alter the company’s strategy or priorities.

The company sought to project a united front at an investor call Monday, attended by five directors — Vivek Sharma, John Speight, Beth Boucher, Anil Chanana and Sudhir Singh — along with the Chief

Financial Officer Saurabh Goel. “Our near term, medium term, and long term outlook remains unchanged and our FY27 guidance remains intact,” Goel reaffirmed.

Coforge expects a consolidated Ebitda margin between 20.5-21% and consolidated Ebit margin of minimum 15.5% with a free cash flow conversion of above 100% of PAT in the current financial year. “The four-year guidance of around \$5 billion revenue generated remains intact,” he added.

Vivek Sharma, appointed interim chairperson, said he had opted out of the race for the permanent position to ensure objectivity. Both internal and external candidates with “extraordinary capabilities” and deep professional expertise and governance experience would be considered, he said. **FE**

Heat, weak monsoon continue to push up power demand

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, September 14

INDIA IS seeing an unusual surge in electricity demand this September, with peak power demand nearing the level recorded during peak summer.

On September 10, the peak power demand touched 269 gigawatts (GW), the highest-ever peak demand recorded for the month. So far, the peak power demand for the year was 270 GW which was recorded during the peak summer in May.

In recent years, electricity demand has generally peaked during the summer months of April, May, June and July, driven largely by widespread use of air conditioners and

other cooling appliances across households and commercial establishments. By September, demand typically begins to ease as the summer heat recedes and the country moves into the post-summer demand pattern.

Yet this year, electricity consumption has remained unusually high, keeping peak demand close to its summer level.

September has recorded the year’s highest peak demand only twice in recent years — in 2023-24 and 2020-21. So, what is driving electricity consumption to remain elevated this September? What challenges does it pose to the power system?

As per power sector experts, the unusually high demand is being driven by a combination

of factors such as persistent heat, deficient rainfall and higher irrigation demand, with weather conditions linked to *El Niño* adding to the pressure.

“The increase is being driven by persistent heat and cooling demand, with *El Niño*-related weather conditions and deficient rainfall also contributing to higher irrigation demand,” said Alekhya Datta, Director, Electricity and Renewables Division, TERI.

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) had also forecast that monthly average maximum temperatures in September are likely to remain above normal over most parts of the country. It also forecasted below-normal rainfall

• RISING DEMAND

● On September 10, the peak power demand touched 269 GW, the highest-ever peak demand recorded for the month

● So far, the peak power demand for the year was 270 GW which was recorded during the peak summer in May

across the country in September, at less than 91% of the long-period average.

“When monsoon is deficient and temperatures are high, both agricultural load and air conditioning load go up, leading to surge in peak de-

mand,” said Alok Kumar, former Power Secretary who currently serves as director general of the All India DISCOM Association, adding that this type of uncertainty will prevail given the global warming and consequential changes in the weather and climate.

Between June 1 and September 9, India received 648 millimeters (mm) of rainfall, compared with the normal 760.6 mm, leaving the country with an overall seasonal deficit of 15%, data from IMD shows.

“A 15% deficit in monsoon rains so far, likely withdrawal of monsoon from North-West India, and rising temperatures have contributed to higher demand for cooling and irriga-

tion,” Rohit Bajaj, Joint Managing Director of Indian Energy Exchange (IEX), the country’s largest power trading platform, told *The Indian Express*, while highlighting that India’s electricity consumption stood at 49.84 billion units during September 1-9, up 20.7% from the same period last year. The September demand surge is also coming when deficient rainfall has squeezed hydropower generation, increasing the power sector’s dependence on thermal generation even as demand remains elevated. The combination has tightened supply-demand balance and pushed up prices in spot electricity market.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• BRIEFLY

India, Mercosur to launch talks, expand pact

New Delhi: India and Mercosur bloc on Monday announced the launch of negotiations to expand the scope of existing trade pact, the Commerce Ministry said. The agreement provides preferential tariff concessions on 450 tariff lines or product categories by India and 452 tariff lines by the Mercosur side. Both sides are looking to expand the scope of the pact. Mercosur is a trading bloc in Latin America, comprising Brazil, Argentina, Bolivia, Uruguay, and Paraguay. **PTI**

Vi’s porting row: Trai to review telcos’ concerns

New Delhi: Amid concerns raised by Bharti Airtel and Reliance Jio over Vodafone Idea’s (Vi) alleged attempts to nudge telco customers to switch to its network, Trai Chairman AK Lahoti Monday said the regulator will examine representations it has received from operators. Mobile number portability (MNP), allows users to switch from one operator to another without changing the mobile number. Emails sent to Bharti Airtel and Reliance Jio did not elicit a response. **PTI**

George Mathew

Mumbai, September 14

THE RESERVE Bank of India’s (RBI’s) decision to reject Tata Sons’ request to surrender its registration as a Core Investment Company has brought the Tata Group holding company one step closer to the stock market. The decision revives the long-standing question of mandatory listing, and raises a much larger issue: what could Tata Sons be worth if it comes to the market, and how might its distinctive shareholder structure evolve?

Tata Sons is unlike a conventional holding company. Around 66% of its equity is held by Tata charitable trusts, 18.37% by the Shapoorji Pallonji family, approximately 13% by Tata

group companies, and the remainder by individuals, mainly members of the Tata family. Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata’s stake will be worth Rs 10,000 crore at a valuation of Rs 10 lakh crore. The company’s ownership structure has remained largely unchanged and closely protected for decades.

Unless Tata Sons approaches the court and obtains an order against the RBI directive, its IPO will become a reality in the coming months.

There is no official valuation and research firms are yet to come out with a valuation report. But Tata Sons’ own financial numbers give a key starting point. Its net worth rose to about Rs 1.79 lakh crore in FY26, while the market value of its listed investments was about



Tata Sons’ net worth rose to about Rs 1.79 lakh crore in FY26. REUTERS

Rs 11.89 lakh crore as of March 2026, down from Rs 14.28 lakh crore in previous year, as per the company’s Annual Report.

Tata Sons has already repaid its debt to escape the RBI classification among upper-layer NBFCs. Tata Sons’ market value, however, cannot simply be cal-

Around 66% of Tata Sons equity is held by Tata charitable trusts, 18.37% by the Shapoorji Pallonji family, nearly 13% by Tata group companies, and the remainder by individuals

culated by adding the market capitalisation of all the listed Tata companies in which it owns shares. A holding-company discount is normally applied because an investor in Tata Sons does not directly own the underlying shares. “Worth noting that listed holding companies (when

all underlying companies are listed) NAV trade in the range of 70% discount.” Founder of Helios Capital Samir Arora said in a post on X.

Earlier valuation exercises have produced widely different numbers. One analysis had estimated Tata Sons at around Rs 8 lakh crore, after applying a 60% holding-company discount and assigning value to its unlisted businesses. With the group having expanded into semiconductors, electronics, batteries, aviation and other businesses, and with the value of its listed investments running into several lakh crore rupees, a valuation in Rs 8-12 lakh crore range could be a reasonable market starting point. The final IPO valuation will depend on the value assigned to unlisted businesses

and the holding-company discount, analysts said.

Recent conservative estimates have put Tata Sons’ valuation around Rs 10 lakh crore, said a market analyst. Other estimates of over Rs 12 lakh crore are being floated in the market.

“The continued private status of Tata Sons imposes an artificial ‘Holding Company Discount’ on its listed subsidiaries. By remaining unlisted, Tata Sons denies the 20 lakh plus shareholders of entities like Tata Chemicals or Tata Motors the fair-market valuation of their indirect holdings, effectively suppressing billions in shareholder wealth,” proxy advisory firm In-Govern Research Services said in a recent report.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

SALUTE THE SOLDIER



Maj VS Ahlawat
01 Nov 1978-15 Sep 2017

This historic day fills our hearts with pride and sorrow alike when in the highest traditions of the Indian Army, you laid down your life in Counter Insurgency Area of Assam. World is a lesser place without you but we know that you are with the gods above and even heavens have improved by your gracious presence.

Fondly remembered by
CO and All Ranks of 3 RAJPUT



MAJ BHAGAT SINGH, Vrc
19 Mar 1941-15 Sep 1965

We pay homage to Maj Bhagat Singh, Vrc (Posthumous), who made the supreme sacrifice while fighting the enemy during 1965 Indo Pak War (J&K). His dauntless courage and sacrifice will forever inspire the organization.

CO & all ranks of 6th Battalion
Brigade of The Guards



BORDR SECURITY FORCE
CONSTABLE/TRADESMAN HILAL AHMED SHEIKH
SHQ BSF SRINAGAR
15.06.1973-15.09.1998

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable/ Tradesman Hilal Ahmed Sheikh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries in a militant attack upon him while he was availing leave at his Home town Gadru-Dagpura, Srinagar (J&K) and made ultimate sacrifice.



CONSTABLE AMRIT LAL MISHRA
87 BN BSF

01.04.1967-15.09.2001
 Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Amrit Lal Mishra on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal injuries in an IED blast triggered by militants in area of Gauri Kund, Udhampur (Jammu) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.



CONSTABLE AMRIT LAL MISHRA
PMG 192 BN BSF

08.07.1985-15.09.2017
 Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Brijender Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries in Counterpart firing in area of BOP Chinaz (Jammu) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty. His sacrifice and gallant action have been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding him with PMG (Posthumously).

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE



Veer Balidani
 Head Constable/
 Driver
Bhuwal Singh
 72 Bn
 1-7-1967
 To 15-9-2006

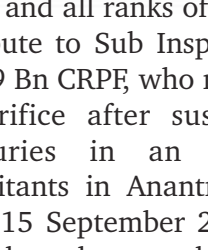


Veer Balidani
 Constable
Kamlesh Singh Yadav
 92 Bn
 20-12-1967
 To 7-9-1994

DG and all ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to two bravehearts of 72 Bn CRPF, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries in an IED blast by Maoists in Bokaro district, Jharkhand, on 15 September 2006. CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifices go in vain.



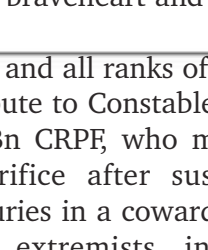
Veer Balidani
 Sub Inspector
Gyan Singh
 9 Bn
 1-1-1950
 To 15-9-2002



DG and all ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Sub Inspector Gyan Singh of 9 Bn CRPF, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries in an encounter with militants in Anantnag district, J&K, on 15 September 2002. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani
 Constable
Vijay Bahadur
 1 Bn
 9-3-1949
 To 15-9-1971



DG and all ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Vijay Bahadur of 1 Bn CRPF, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries in a cowardly grenade attack by extremists in Kolkata, West Bengal, on 15 September 1971. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

PUNJAB STATE POWER CORPORATION LIMITED
 (Regd. Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall Patiala - 147001)
 Corporate Identity No U40109PB2010SGC033813
 Website : www.pspcl.in Mobile No. 96461-55525

E-Tender Enq. No. 7857/P-3/EMP-13430 Dated: 14.09.2026
Dy.Chief Engineer/ Headquarter (Procurement Cell-3) GGSSTP, Roopnagar invites E-Tender ID No. 2026_POWER_13430_1 for Procurement of clarified water pumps of stage-II & III DM plants at GGSSTP Ropar. For detailed NIT & Tender Specification please refer to <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in> from dated 11.09.2026 / 05:00 Noon onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and amendments, if any, will be published online at <http://eproc.punjab.gov.in>.
No. 15152/PSPCL RTP 86/26

Government Secondary School Paharipur 4413 (Jhajjar)

AUCTION NOTICE

The general public is hereby informed that on 17-09-2026, an open auction for the dilapidated building of Government Middle School Paharipur 4413 (Jhajjar), consisting of two rooms, will be held at 11:00 AM in the school premises. Interested contractors/agencies may participate in the open auction only after depositing a 10% Demand Draft of the auction amount of Rs.1,00,000/- (Rupees One Lakh) in the school office by 9:00 AM on 17-09-2026. The successful bidder will have to deposit the remaining amount at the site. For other terms and detailed information, interested parties may contact the school on a working day. Additional rules and conditions of the auction will be announced at the time of the auction.

Headmaster,
Government Middle School Paharipur 4413 (Jhajjar)
No. 49251/HRY

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement system.
 Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	06261135	MS FLAT SIZE 40X6 MM	93982 KGS	05.10.26
02	01261725A	CONTACT WIRE PARALLEL CLAMP (SMALL) (1041-2) COMPLETE ASSEMBLY	30087 SET	05.10.26
03	77269002	THICK WEB SWITCH T-9842	400 SET	06.10.26
04	77265116	M.S. FITTINGS FOR THICK WEB SWITCH T-6155	240 MT	07.10.26
05	06265036	RHS-40X80X4MM	120000 KGS	08.10.26
06	15265093	MANUFACTURING AND SUPPLY OF COMPLETE INSPECTION	480 SET	13.10.26
07	77269097	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR HVN CUT LINER (T-10236 & T-10237)	40000 PAIR	13.10.26
08	07263446	AXLE BOX PIVOT BUSH WITH SOLID OR HOLLOW PIN CONSTRUCTION	11751 NOS	03.11.26
09	07261145	NON ASBESTOS K- TYPE HIGH FRICTION COMPOSITE BRAKE	69645 NOS	10.11.26

Note: 1). Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No Manual offer will be entertained.
Tender Notice No. 41/2026-2027 Dated: 10/09/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3165/26

verka
THE PUNJAB STATE COOPERATIVE MILK PRODUCERS FEDERATION LTD.
 SCO 153-155, SECTOR 34-A, CHANDIGARH-160022, EPABX No. 0172-5041812,66

Notice Inviting Tender www.verka.coop

Tender is hereby invited for the purchase and supply of following items :-

Name of Work/Item	Period/ Tentative Qty
For Verka Mohali Dairy Supply, installation & commissioning of Milk Protein concentration System.	01 No.

NOTE:
 1. For complete details regarding above tender (NIT), please visit our website i.e. www.verka.coop & e Tendering portal i.e. eproc.punjab.gov.in.
 2. Corrigendum, if any, will be uploaded on website only.
General Manager (Purchase)

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement system
 Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01 02260004	HIGH VOLTAGE FUSE (WITHOUT HOLDER)	8078 NOS	06-10-26
02 77269044	THICK WEB SWITCH FOR T-8708	650 SET	08-10-26
03 77269051A	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR PROCUREMENT CONCRETE SLEEPERS	200 SET	08-10-26
04 02262502	120AH VALVE REGULATED MAINTENANCE FREE LEAD ACID BATTERIES	1231 SET	12-10-26
05 08265332	24 FIBER ARMoured OPTICAL FIBER	95 KM	14-10-26

NOTE -1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No Manual offer will be entertained.
Tender Notice No. 42/2026-2027 Dated : 14.09.2026 3164/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr.PC/84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)
 Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Javed, S/o Samsul Arfin R/o H.No.3821, Gali Hazi Banne Wali Chudiwalan, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.12/2019 u/s 379/356/411/34 IPC, P.S. Kashmir Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Javed** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Javed** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
 Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Javed of FIR No.12/2019 u/s 379/356/411/34 IPC, P.S. Kashmir Gate, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.10.2026**.
By Order,
Sh. Vaibhav Garg
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11, Central DP/13029/N/2026 Court No.138, First Floor, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

Office of the Principal
Govt. Degree College, Sumbal
Sonawari Bandipora, Kashmir-193501

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST
E-NIT No.: GDC/Sum/26/E-NIT/919 Dated: 11-09-2026
 Principal Government Degree College Sumbal Sonawari, Bandipora invites online Expression of Interest (EOI) from registered Members of Federation of Publishers and Book Seller's Association of India for the "Procurement of Books/References" in Government Degree College Sumbal Sonawari, Bandipora, for Financial year 2026-27 as per the details given in the EOI documents (EOI Form, Terms & Conditions of EOI Notice). The EOI documents consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria and detailed terms and conditions of contract can be seen/downloaded from the website www.jktenders.gov.in and www.gdcsumbal.edu.in as per schedule of dates given below:

1. Date of issue of EOI Notice	16/09/2026
2. Period of downloading of EOI documents:	16/09/2026 to 30/09/2026
3. EOI Bid Submission start date	16/09/2026
4. EOI Bid Submission end date	30/09/2026
5. Date of opening of EOI Bid online	03/10/2026

Sd/- Principal Government Degree College Sumbal
DIP NO. DIPK-5785/26 DATE: 14.09.2026

PUBLIC NOTICE
 This is to inform the general public that Bank of Baroda, Sushant Lok Branch intends to accept the undermentioned property standing in the name of **M/s Longlife Trading Company Private Limited**, a company incorporated and registered under the Companies Act, 2013 and having its registered Office at Plot No. 41 KH No. 252/41, Ground Floor, Pole No. 52, Sector 28 Dwarka, New Delhi - 110077, as a security for a loan/ credit facility provided by **M/s Longlife Trading Company Private Limited**.
 In case anyone has got any right/ title/ interest/ claims over the undermentioned property, they are advised to approach the branch within 10 days along with necessary proof to substantiate their claim.
 If no response is received within 10 days, it is presumed that the property is free of any charge/ claim/encumbrance and bank shall proceed with the mortgage.
 Detail of property: Residential Apartment bearing No. 9/07B (erstwhile MGP PS-2/07 B), 7th Floor, Tower No. Polo Suites - 09, M3M Golf Estate Fairway East Sector 65 Village - Maidawas, Tehsil-Badshahpur, District-Gurgaon, State Haryana admeasuring 4992 Sq. Ft., in the name of **M/s Longlife Trading Company Private Limited**
Branch Details/Contact no. Mrs. Meenakshi Chief Manager Bank of Baroda, Sushant Lok Branch, Gurugram. Contactno: 7042255687

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HSPB FARIDABAD	SPECIAL REPAIR OF 2 LINK ROADS (I.E. 1. HALDWA TO DEERHATA PWD ROAD VIA SAGARPUA LEADING TO KALAWATI RLY. STATION (ROAD ID - 688), 2. JAMUNA TO NAI KA MANGLA (ROAD ID - 688), PREHLA CONSTITUENCY, DISTRICT FARIDABAD (UNDER WORK PLAN 2025-27) - 4 WORKS	11.09.2026 17.09.2026	2,56,73,526/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	EBR02257/sonaribabbar0220@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in **No. 49245/HRY**

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) DIVISION R. S. PURA

Short e-NIT No. DRSP/81 of 2026-27 Dated 11-09-2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for all the following works :-

S. No	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advertised cost (Rs. In lakh.)	Cost of document (in Rs.)	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Time Allowed for completion	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1	Construction of link road Jabawal beyond panchayat ghar upto the 1. House of Ajit Singh (Under Road Sector (New Work) Capex Budget for the year 2026-27)	PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura	46.50	600	2% of the Advertised Cost	03 Months	(1300 Hrs) on or after 26-09-2026	"A&B" Class

Position of AAA :- Accorded by Superintending Engineer PWD(R&B) Circle South, Jammu vide order No: 93 of 2026. Dated: 05/08/2026
Position of TS :- Accorded by Executive Engineer PWD(R&B) Division R.S.Pura vide order No: 40 of September 2026 dated: 05 of September 2026
Project Authority :- Chief Engineer PW(R&B) Department Jammu Zone
Major Head of Account :- Under Road Sector (New Work) Capex Budget for the year 2026-27

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen/downloaded from the departmental website <http://jktenders.gov.in> as per below schedule :

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	11-09-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 11-09-2026 to 25-09-2026
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	14-09-2026 at 1300 Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura
4	Bid submission Start Date	11-09-2026
5	Bid Submission End Date	25-09-2026 upto 1600 Hrs
6	Date & Time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	26-09-2026 on or after 1300 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura. In case mentioned bid opening date happens to be a holiday then Bid shall be opened at the same time on the next working day.
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids (Online)	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

Sd/-
Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R. S. Pura
DIP NO. DIP/J-10363/26 DATED: 14.09.2026

PUNJAB STATE POWER CORPORATION LIMITED
 (Regd. Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall Patiala - 147001)
 Corporate Identity No U40109PB2010SGC033813
 Website : www.pspcl.in (Contact No. 9646118721)

Tender Enquiry No. QW-351/PO-W Dated: 10.09.2026
Chief Engineer/Stores & Workshops Organization, Sarabha Nagar, PSPCL, Ludhiana, invites E-tender of 124 no. 45 kg Mechanical Foam Type Fire Extinguisher Trolley Mounted conforming to IS:16018 (ISI marked) with Gas Cartridge Type conforming to IS: 4947 (with latest editions). For detailed NIT & tender specification, please refer to <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in> from dt. 10.09.2026 at 11:00 A.M. onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and amendments, if any, will be published online at <http://eproc.punjab.gov.in>.
No. 15154/PSPCL C 870/26

Municipal Committee, BAWAL
 Distt. REWARI (Haryana) PIN - 123501,
 Email id- secy-bawal@ulbharyana.gov.in

दुकानो को खुली बोली के माध्यम से किराये पर छोड़े जाने बारे सूचना

सर्व साधारण को सूचित किया जाता है, कि नगरपालिका बावल प्राणपुर रोड़ पर अपने Shopping Complex में बनी गई दुकानों को खुली बोली द्वारा दिनांक 24/09/2026 को प्रातः 11 बजे नगरपालिका कार्यालय बावल में किराये पर छोड़ा जाना है। जिसकी नोन रिफण्डेबल सिक्कोरिटी राशि 400000/- रूपए, न्यूनतम किराया राशि दुकान के क्षेत्रफल अनुसार रखी गई है। बोली दाता को 1,00,000/- रूपए (एक लाख रूपए) बतौर प्रतिभूति राशि बोली से पूर्व जमा करवाने हेतु निर्धारित की गई है। बाकी इच्छुक व्यक्ति अन्य सत्रें नगरपालिका कार्यालय बावल में किसी भी कार्यदिवस में आकर देख सकते हैं।

-हस्ता- - हस्ता-
सचिव प्रधान
No-49254/HR नगरपालिका बावल नगरपालिका बावल

GMDC
TENDER NOTICE
E-Tender Notice No.: GMDC/POWER/03/26-27
RFP for Appointment of Project Management Consultant for GMDC's proposed 2 x 125 MW Lignite-based CFBC technology expansion of Lakhpat Thermal Power Station at Nani Chher, Taluka Lakhpat, District Kutch, Gujarat.
 GMDC is a leading Public Sector Mining and Minerals Company of Gujarat with operational experience of over 60 years. GMDC intends to appoint Project Management Consultant (PMC) for GMDC's proposed 2 x 125 MW Lignite-based CFBC technology expansion of Lakhpat Thermal Power Station at Nani Chher, Taluka Lakhpat, District Kutch, Gujarat, as per the detailed scope of work specified in RFP. Interested Parties shall download the RFP document from www.gmdcltd.com & <https://gmdcltdtender.nprocure.com> and submit their proposal online on <https://gmdcltdtender.nprocure.com> on or before 04/11/2026 up-to 18:00 hrs.
 For Further Details Please visit our Website www.gmdcltd.com & <https://gmdc.nprocure.com>.
Sd/-
Gujarat Mineral Development Corporation Ltd.
 (A Government of Gujarat Enterprise)
 Khanji Bhawan, 132 Feet Ring Road,
 Near University Ground, Vastrapur, Ahmedabad-380052

UPSIDA
उपग्रह औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
 U-1/4, लखनपुर, कानपुर

ई-निविदा सूचना
 एतद्वारा सूचित किया जाता है, कि निम्नित औद्योगिक क्षेत्रों के अनुराग विकास/अनुसंधान/उपयोग/उपयोगिता कार्यों हेतु सरकार विभाग/सार्वजनिक उपक्रम/प्राम/प्राधिकरण/परिषद/नगर निकायों से संबंधित फार्म/डेटाबेसों से ई-निविदा में आमंत्रित की जाती है, जिसको अगले 40 दिनों की समयसीमा निम्नानुसार है:-

1. क्रम 01 से 07 पर अंकित निविदा दिनांक 15.09.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे से दिनांक 22.09.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक अपलोड की जा सकती है, जिन्हें दिनांक 22.09.2026 को अपराह्न 5:30 बजे खोला जायेगा (अव्यक्तिक)।

निविदादाताओं द्वारा कक्ष सम्पन्न की मूल प्रतियाँ निविदा खोलने की तिथि से दो कार्यदिवस के अन्दर कार्यालय में जमा की जा सकती हैं। ई-निविदा के माध्यम से आमंत्रित की जाने वाली निविदाओं का विवरण निम्नानुसार है:-

क्रमांक	कार्य का नाम	सर्वेक्षण/मूल्य
1	Construction of Truck Lay Bay at I.A. Loha Mandi Distt. Ghaziabad.	231.85
2	Redevelopment of Green Belt Civil & Horticulture Balance Part of Road No.04 & Horticulture Work of Central Verge of Chandra No.07 at I.A. Bulandshahar Road Site-I, Distt. Ghaziabad.	150.37
3	Development & Beautification of Neta Ji Subhash Chandra Bose Park Including Construction Of Rain Water Harvesting (1 No.), Submersible Pump (1 No) Stage & Footpath With 02 Year Maintenance at I.A. Sector-22 Meerut Road, Distt. Ghaziabad.	121.44
4	Construction of Boundary Wall, Footpath, Nesting Huts, (2Nos) & Horticulture Works With 2 Year Maintenance of Park at I.A. Loha Mandi Distt. Ghaziabad.	176.65
5	Construction of Boundary Wall and Entrance Gate for Park Road No. 14 And 32 At I.A. Bulandshahar Road Site-I, Distt. Ghaziabad.	203.33
6	Resurfacing & Widening of Existing Balance Roads at I.A. Amrit Steel Compound SSGT Road Distt. Ghaziabad.	265.99
7	Annual Repair and Maintenance of Miscellaneous civil works at I.A. SSGT Road and Amrit Steel Compound Distt. Ghaziabad.	132.00

नोट:- निविदादाता अपनी निविदाओं में सार्वजनिक कर सहित दरें अंकित करें। जीएसटीडीएस अलग से देय होगा। निविदा सम्बन्धी विस्तृत जानकारी प्राधिकरण की वेबसाइट: <http://beta.upsidamarketplace.com> पर स्थित ई-लिक एवं यूट्यूब चैनल की वेबसाइट: <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर देखी जा सकती है। अन्य जानकारी हेतु कार्यालय के वरिष्ठ प्रबन्धक (सिविल-गु) के श्री प्रवीण कुमार सलीगंवा मोबाइल नं 9871090103 पर सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है।
महाप्रबन्धक, उपग्रह औद्योगिक विकास, कानपुर

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION FARIDABAD	ESTIMATE FOR CONSTRUCTION OF SUB HEALTH CENTRE AT BHANKRI VILLAGE, + 14 WORKS	11.09.2026 18.09.2026	6,40,86,096/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01392411649/sonm5@gmail.com
2	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION FARIDABAD	ROUGH COST ESTIMATE FOR PROVIDING AND LAYING OF 3RD BHN HWY THICK H-40 GRADE AT JOHADRIYA MOHALLA AND BIGRIE MOHALLA IN ANAPUR VILLAGE OF WARD NO. 23 (NEW) FARIDABAD, + 9 WORKS	12.09.2026 19.09.2026	2,57,70,910/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01292411649/mcfamruti@gmail.com
3	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION FARIDABAD	PROVIDING AND LAYING OF 250MM DIA S.W PIPE AND RE-CONSTRUCTION OF 60X14-35 GRADE IN VARIOUS STREETS WARD 23 BADOLAH CONSTITUENCY + 13 WORKS	11.09.2026 18.09.2026	4,06,97,144/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01292411649/mcfamruti@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in **No. 49242/HR**

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF REFRIGERATOR FOR STORAGE OF REAGENT (400-450 L) ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	14.09.2026 28.09.2026	66,00		

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,Laxmi Gupta D/o Sh. Jai Pal Gupta W/o Shri Deepak Gupta R/o H.No.-89, 2nd floor, Chitra Vihar, Laxmi Nagar, East Delhi, Delhi-110092,have changed my name to Palak Gupta for all purposes. 0040878284-1

I,NANAK CHADHA,S/O KISHORE KUMAR CHADDA,R/O-170 GF, PCKET-9, SECTOR-21,ROHINI, DELHI-110086,have changed my name to NANAK CHADDA 0040878356-7

I,Krishna Devi(existing name of dependent as per POR)M/o- Mr.Saurabh Singh,R/o-VPO Ajmat-Ulla-Ganj,Dist Rae Bareilj,UP-229303,have changed my name from Krishna Devi to Krishna Singh,wide affidavit dated-09/09/2026 before Rae Bareilj court. 0040878343-5

I,BHARAT BHUSHAN,S/O NARESH KUMAR,R/O HOUSE NO. 81, GALI NO. 3, SHIV COLONY, BALLABGARH, FARIDABAD- 121004(HR), THAT IN MY CBSE SECONDARY SCHOOL MARKSHEET BEARING NO. 1315384, ISSUED ON 29/05/2018.MY FATHER NAME WRONGLY WRITTEN AS NARESH KUAMR INSTEAD OF NARESH KUMAR FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES 0040878363-1

We Priyanka Gulati and Jitender Kumar Gulati S/o-Satpal Gulati R/o Flat no-P-2,Thana Gulabi Bagh,Andha Mughal,Pratap Nagar,Delhi-110007,have changed name of my minor Son Saksham to Saksham Gulati. 0040878347-3

I,FARHA ABBASI,W/O,AAMIR MASOOD,R/O-C-2 & C-3,FLAT NO.103,FIRST FLOOR,OKHLA VIHAR,JAMIA NAGAR,NEW DELHI-110025,That I am the mother of" INAYA MASOOD",That in my daughter's school record my name is mentioned as FARHA AAMIR instead of FARHA ABBASI,That the both names FARHA AAMIR and FARHA ABBASI are the name of one and the same person,i.e. FARHA ABBASI. That I want to change my name from FARHA AAMIR to FARHA ABBASI,in her school record. 0040878351-2

I,Kamlesh Kumar Sharma,S/o-Shri Kunj Bihari Lal Sharma,aged about 63- years,R/o-B-47,Amanpuri,Nangloi,Nilothi,W est Delhi,Delhi-110041,declare that,Kamlesh Sharma and Kamlesh Kumar Sharma both names are one and the same person,i.e. myself and in future will be known as only Kamlesh Kumar Sharma,for all future purposes. 0040878351-11

I,Tabassum Aisha W/O, Meraj Mohammad Khan R/o D-64, Flat No.12, D-block, Abul Fazal Enclave, New Delhi-110025 have changed my name to Tabassum Aisha Khan. 0040878341-1

I,NITIN CHAUDHARY,S/O-BABU RAM,R/O-1076,GREEN FIELD COLONY FARIDABAD- 121010,HAVE MY NAME CHANGE TO NITIN KUMAR,FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE 0040878286-7

I,Manoj Pradhan S/o Pratap Singh R/o Lodhan Gujran, Nagar Panchayat, Babugarh, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Manoj Kumar. 0040878346-5

I,R YADAV, S/O NANHU YADAV, R/o 265, Gali No.17, Near Ideal Public School, Ganpati Colony Part-2, Agwanpur, Amarnagar, Faridabad, Haryana-121003, have changed my name from R YADAV to SHRIRAM YADAV and shall henceforth be known as SHRIRAM YADAV for all purposes. Both names refer to one and the same person. 0130069276-1

I,Zabby Ahmad S/o Zahir Ahmed R/o-173 Bank Enclave,Laxmi Nagar,East Delhi-110092,have changed my name to Zabby Ahmed for all purposes. 0040878343-7

I, DAVENDER KUMAR SON OF SHRI YAD RAM RESIDENT OF H NO. A-27/3 B, SHASTRI GALI NO. 3, MAUJIPUR, DELHI-110053, inform that DAVENDER KUMAR and DEVENDER KUMAR both are one and the same person. 0040878345-1

I,hitherto known as PINKI KUMARI,D/O-ARUN GUPTA,AGED 24 YEARS,R/O juggi no-f-142,f,shahbad dairy,sahibabad, daulatpur, north west delhi,delhi-110042,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as PRANVIKA. 0040878351-4

I,NOOR AFSHA,W/O- MOHAMMAD SHARIQ,R/O-T-9/C GHAFOR NAGAR,JAMIA NAGAR,NEW DELHI-110025,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME NOOR AFSHA,TO AFSHA HASHMI,FOR ALL PURPOSE 0040878356-2

I,Krishna Devi(existing name of dependent as per POR)M/o- Mr.Saurabh Singh,R/o-VPO Ajmat-Ulla-Ganj,Dist Rae Bareilj,UP-229303,have changed my name from Krishna Devi to Krishna Singh vide affidavit,dated- 09/09/2026,before Rae Bareilj court. 0040878286-9

I,Hem Chandra Kailash Chandra Tewari,S/o-Kailash Chandra Tewari,R/o-H.NO-C-56,2nd Floor,Near Mother Dairy Circle,Sector 52 Ardee City,Sector-56, Gurgaon,(Haryana)- 122011, have changed my name to Hem Chandra Tewari. 0040878351-5

I,Mehandi Hasan,S/o-Late Sh.Baseer Ahmad,R/O-Village- Bhooargahi Dasna Dehat,Distt:-Ghaziabad-201302,have changed my name from Mehdi harun to Mehandi Hasan For All Future Purpose. 0040878346-9

I,TANVI MEHROTRA,W/o-Arpit Tandon,R/o-Flat No.501,Tower-B-10, Tulip Voilet Society, Sector-69,Sohna Road,Tulip Chowk,Gurgaon, (Haryana)- 122018,have changed my name to TANVI MEHROTRA TANDON,for all future Purposes. 0040878348-8

I,Kailash Chandra Devidutt Tewari,S/o-Devi Dutt Tewari,R/o- Near Naini Widaya Peeth Cheenpur Tila Lohariya Sal,Hald, Nainital (Uttarakhand)-263139,have changed my name to,Kailash Chandra Tewari 0040878351-6

I,Dhanraj S/O Manoj Kumar born on 24 May 1968 residing at 1450 Pana Paposian, Narela, Delhi, 110040 have changed my name to Dhanraj Chhikara vide affidavit dated 12-08-2026 at Narela, Delhi. 0050297722-1

I,G BHAGYA SHREE,D/o-Surya Narayana Gorakala,R/o.C-24,Andra Pradesh Bhawan, Jaswant Sinha Lane,New Delhi-110001 to have changed my name to,BHAGYA SHREE GORAKALA,for all future purposes. 0040878286-2

I,hitherto known as,Jagpreet Gill s/o-Sh.Gurcharan Singh Gill,R/o-H.No. 1/2610 U.G.F Loni Road,Ram Nagar Shahdara,Delhi-110032,have changed my name and shall,hereafter be known as Jagpreet Singh. 0040878343-9

I,MAMTA SINGH,W/o-RAJIV NEHRU,R/O,H.No-F-290,3rd Floor,New Palam Vihar, Gurgaon,Haryana-122001,have changed my minor daughter name JENISHA SINGH, to JENISHA NEHRU. 0040878348-1

I, Simon Lobo, S/O, Mr. Emmanuel Lobo, R/O 910, Golf Course Road, Sector 43, Gurugram, 122009, do hereby declare that in some official documents my name is mentioned as Simon Lobo, in some it is P S Lobo and in others it is written as Peter Simon Lobo. From now on, I shall be known only as Simon Lobo for all purposes. 0040878285-1

I, HIMANSHU,S/O PRAMOD MATHUR,R/O-2833, K.H.NO.54/23,TIRTHANKAR NAGAR, JAIN COLONY, KARALA, DELHI-110081,have changed my name to HIMANSHU MATHUR 0040878356-4

I,MD NASIM AHMAD,S/O- MOHAMMAD JASIMUDDIN, R/O- FLAT NO.601,TOWER NO PVH003,PAVILLION HEIGHT,SECTOR 128,AXIS HOUSE,NOIDA,GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR,UTTAR PRADESH-201304,have changed my name to MOHAMMAD NASIM AHMAD,for all purposes. 0040878343-2

I,SHAFIA / SHAFIA BANO,W/O- MOHAMMAD AZAM,R/O-H.NO.-5836,FIRST FLOOR,BASTI HARPHOOL SINGH,SADAR THANA ROAD,DELHI-110006,have change my name to SHAFIA QURESHI 0040878286-11

I,VIPIN TIWARI,S/o- Raghunandan Prasad Singh,R/o-Villa.No.106, Lotus Villa,Greater Noida,Jalpura Sector-1,Surajpur,GBN,UP-201306,Have changed my name vipin Kumar to vipin Tiwari,for all future purposes 0040878346-11

I,Baljinder Kaur,W/O- Sukhvinder Singh,R/O-Flat No-1605,16th Floor, Fren Tower, World Residency, SHAKTI KHAND-4, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad,Uttar Pradesh, 201014,Have changed my Name to "Baljinder Kaur Panesar", Henceforth, I would be known by the name of "Baljinder Kaur Panesar". 0040878348-10

I,Kavita Hem Chandra Tewari,W/o Hem Chandra Tewari,R/o-Near Naini Vidhya Pith Cheenpur Unchapul,Post- Kusumkhera,Haldwani,Nainita I (Uttarakhand)-263139,have changed my name to Kavita Tewari,for all Purposes. 0040878351-8

I, MANISH S/o RAM CHARAN, R/O D-57, Street No. 15, Bharat Vihar, Raja Puri, Uttar Nagar, West Delhi-110059, have changed my name from MANISH to MANISH POKHRIYAL. For all future purposes. 0040878301-1

I,Saayana Sreedetha Prakash,D/O-Prakash Bhanu,R/O-Flat No-26,Third Floor,Masoodpur Dairy no-26,Vasant Kunj Delhi-110071,I Have changed My Name To Saayana S Prakash 0040878286-4

I,Imran Malik S/o Jamil Ahmad R/o-101, New Hindan Vihar, Mohan Nagar, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Imran. 0040878346-2

I,GAGANDEEP SINGH,S/O- SUKHDIP SINGH,R/O-H NO-F/1391, SECTOR-7, STREET NO-3,NANAK NAGAR, JAMMU, JAMMU AND KASHMIR-180004 have changed my minor son name from ANHAD DEEP SINGH to AYAAN DEEP SINGH 0040878348-3

I, Monga Shyama Maharajkishan, W/O Late Sh.Monga Maharajkishan, R/o-Flat No-1003,Tower-No.B-1,Summer Palms,Sector-86,Nahar-Paar Kheri Kalan,Faridabad, Haryana,have changed my name from Monga Shyama Maharajkirshan to Shyama Monga,for all purposes. 0040878282-1

I,PAWAN KUMAR,S/O HUKAM CHAND,R/O-362, PCKET-5,SECTOR-22, ROHINI, DELHI-110086,have changed my name to PAWAN KUMAR SINGHAL 0040878356-6

I,Veera Gomes,W/O-Mr.Francis Gomes,R/O-179,3rd Floor,Gali no.5,J-Ext'n, Laxmi Nagar,Delhi-110092.Declare that My name as recorded in the said Passport is,HAZEL VEERA GOMES,But my all documents my name has been,mentioned VEERA GOMES,So that the HAZEL VEERA GOMES and VEERA GOMES is the same and one person. 0040878343-4

I,NEHA CHAUDHARY,W/O NITIN KUMAR R/O 1076 GREEN FIELD COLONY FARIDABAD 121010 HAVE MY NAME CHANGE TO NEHA FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE 0040878286-13

I,Jitender Alias Jitender Kumar S/o Satpal Gulati,R/o-Flat no P-2,Thana Gulabi Bagh Andha Mughal Pratap Nagar Delhi-110007, have changed my name to Jitender Kumar Gulati. 0040878347-2

I,Nikhil Batra R/o-H.No-631, Pocket-1, Paschim Puri, Delhi-110063, have Changed my Minor Daughter's name from POORVI BATRA to PURVI BATRA,permanently 0040878351-1

I,Archana Bansal,W/O-Ashok Kumar Bansal,R/o,E-504, Skytech Matrott, Sector-76, Noida, G.B.Nagar,have changed my name to Archana Agarwal. 0040878351-10

I, SAMRA PARWEEN D/O ABU JANDAL R/O VIII-Gokulpur, PO-Datawali, Meerut(UP)-250004 have changed my name to SAMRA. 0040878348-6

I, Sushma Rani Garg W/O Surender Garg R/O C-26, Tulsi Apartment, Plot No-14, Sector-14, Rohini, Delhi, have changed my name to Sushma Garg permanently. 0040878334-1

I,MD QAISH ALAM,S/O- JAMALUDDIN ANSARI,R/O-B 39,HARSH VIHAR HARI-NAGAR EXTN,PART 3,NEW DELHI-110044,HAVE MY NAME CHANGE TO,MOHAMMAD QAISH ALAM,FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE 0040878286-6

I, EENUM D/o Raju Din, B-203, Nehru Camp, Govindpuri, Kalkaji, Delhi-19, have changed my name to EENUM KHAN. 0040878346-4

I, MOHAMMED AKDAS S/O ABU JANDAL R/O VIII-Gokulpur, PO-Datawali, Meerut(UP)-250004 have changed my name to MOHAMMAD AKDUS. 0040878348-5

I,Vijay Kumar Tuteja S/o Late Sh. B.D. Tuteja R/o 296-297, Pocket A-2, Near MZK, Rohini, Sector-8, Rohini, Delhi-110085 have changed my name to Vijay Kumar for all purposes. 0040878284-2

I,Sattar Ahmad,S/o-Ramzani Khan,R/O-R-876 Gali No-7,Joga bai Ext.,Jamia Nagar Delhi,has changed my name to Sattar Ahmed,for all purpose. 0040878356-8

I,Satpal Goel/Satpal S/o-Gian Chand Goel, R/o-House No-308, Sector-9, Faridabad, Haryan, have changed my name to Satpal Goel for all purposes. 0040878343-6

I,Sunita Gupta,W/o Sh.Suresh Kumar Gupta,R/o BD-60, Janakpuri,New Delhi-110058, have changed my name Sunita Gupta to Sumita Mahawat,for all Future Purposes. 0040878351-3

I,Vipan Khattar alias Vipin Khattar,S/o-Jetha Nand Khattar,R/O-B-48B,3rd Floor, Vihar, Nagar, Delhi-110009, both are same and one person 0040878356-1

It is for general information that I Simpi d/o Sunil Kumar Singh r/o A-165 Mavi Mohalla, Tekhand, Okhla Ind. Area, Phase 1, New Delhi-110020 declare that name of my father has been wrongly written as Sunil Kumar in my class 10 th marksheet and certificate The actual name of my father is Sunil Kumar Singh, Which may be amended accordingly. 0040878337-1

I,Jyoti Dennison,w/o-Deepak Kumar Dennison,r/o-Flat no 3A/15,Aravali view, Rail vihar, Sector-56,Gurgaon 122011,have changed my name Jyoti Dennison to Jyoti Deepak Dennison,for all purpose. 0040878286-8

I,hitherto Known as,NIKHIL KUMAR,S/O-Somesh Kumar,R/O-R-128,MOHAN PARK,MODEL TOWN-III,DIST:-North-West Delhi, Delhi-110009, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as NIKHIL SHARMA. 0040878346-8

I, RASHMA PARWEEN / RASHMA PARVEEN W/O ABU JANDAL R/O VIII-Gokulpur, PO-Datawali, Meerut(UP)-250004 have changed my name to SHADAB. 0040878348-7

I,BEER BALA W/o Vinod Kumar Sharma R/o H.No.81, Pocket-H-32, Sector-3,Rohini Delhi-110085 have changed my name to VEENA SHARMA. 0040878286-1

I,SURYA KIRTI MEHTA,S/O-VIJAY MEHTA,R/O-VILLA NO-A-017,AMRAPALI DREAM VALLEY,Greater Noida,west PO:SECTOR-1,GREATER NOIDA-WEST, District:GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR,State:UTTAR PRADESH-201318,CHANGE MY NAME TO SURYA VIJAY MEHTA,FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE. 0040878343-8

I,MUHAMMAD MSAWWIR KHAN,S/O-MUHAMMAD AQUIL KHAN,R/O-636/9,STREET NO-9,ZAKIR NAGAR,JAMIA NAGAR, NEW DELHI-110025, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME MUHAMMAD MSAWWIR KHAN TO MUSYER KHAN 0040878356-3

Neetu Tomar W/o Subhakar Singh Tomar R/o. C2-304 Pankaj Asman Sant Nagar Lohegaon Pune, Changed my Name as Neetu Singh Tomar. 0130069270-1

I,Sadia Naz,W/o.Mohd Sumer Muzafar,R/o,T-8,DDA Flats Behind Police Bhawan Turkman Gate,Delhi-110006, have changed my name to Sadia Naaz permanently 0040878343-1

I,MOHD AZAM / MOH AZAM ALI,S/O- MOHD ALI,R/o-H.NO.-5836,FIRST FLOOR, BASTI HARPHOOL SINGH,SADAR THANA ROAD,DELHI-110006 have change my name to MOHAMMAD AZAM 0040878286-10

I,Pankaj Singh,W/o-Shri Sandeep Kumar Singh,R/o-H.No.1790,2nd 60 Feet Road, Near 54B,Molarband Extn, Badarpur, South Delhi,Delhi-110044,have changed my name from Pankaj Singh to Pankaja Singh,for all future purposes. 0040878346-10

I,Sumit,S/o-Chander Pal Katyal,R/O-L-36,2nd Floor,Signature Global City 37 D-1,Sector-37D,Gurugram, Haryana-122001, have changed my name to Sumit Katyal for all Purposes. 0040878348-9

I,Saraswati Kailash Chandra Tewari,W/o-Kailash Chandra Tewari,R/O-Near Naini Widya Pith,Cheenpur Tila Lohariya Sal,Haldwa,Nainital (Uttarakhand)-263139,have changed my name to Saraswati Tewari for all Purposes. 0040878351-7

I,BAHUSHRUTA SINGH RAUTELA, S/O-BHUPAL SINGH,R/O-RZ-09/207,J BLOCK W SAGARPUR NANGAL RAYA,NEW DELHI, SOUTH WEST DELHI,DELHI-110046,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO BAHUSHRUTA SINGH. 0040878286-3

I,Sneha Singh W/o Shrikant Kumar, R/O-Plot No.-36,Second Floor,Pocket-8, Sector-23,Rohini,Delhi-110085,have changed my name to SNEHA ANAND for all future purposes. 0040878346-1

I,RAJESH VERMA S/O OM PARKASH RESIDENT HOUSE NO-28,SECTOR-7,SONIPAT, HARYANA HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO RAJESH BHARDWAJ. 0040878348-2

I, Nimisha Dsouza, W/O, Mr. Laalit Lobo, R/O 910, Golf Course Road, Sector 43, Gurugram, 122009, do hereby declare that in some official documents my name is mentioned as Nimisha Guido Dsouza, in some as Nimisha Guido D'souza and in others as Nimisha Dsouza. From now on, I shall be known only as Nimisha Dsouza for all purposes. 0040878285-2

I,RAHUL S/O-HARSWARUP SINGH,R/O-36, PCKET-1, SECTOR-24, ROHINI, DELHI-110085,have changed my name to RAHUL SINGH 0040878356-5

I,DINESH SINGH BHURIA,S/O-PRAMOD SINGH BHURIA,R/O-SUPERTECH ECO VILL-1,TOWER B15,FLAT NO 607,GREATER NOIDA EXT,GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR,UTTAR PRADESH-201306,have changed my name to DINESH SINGH,for all purposes. 0040878343-3

I,MOHAMMAD AZAM,S/o-MOHD ALI,R/o-H.NO.-5836,FIRST FLOOR,BASTI HARPHOOL SINGH,SADAR THANA ROAD, DELHI-110006 have change my minor child name AEIZA BANO to AEIZA QURESHI 0040878286-12

I,Priyanka W/o Jitender Kumar Gulati R/o Flat no-P-2,Thana Gulabi Bagh,Andha Mughal, Pratap Nagar,Delhi-110007, have changed my name to Priyanka Gulati. 0040878347-1

I,SHOBHA,W/O SHRIRAM YADAV, R/o 265, Gali No-17, Near Ideal Public School, Ganpati Colony Part-2, Agwanpur, Amarnagar, Faridabad, Haryana-121003, have changed my name from SHOBHA to SHOBHA YADAV and shall henceforth be known as SHOBHA YADAV for all purposes. Both names refer to one and the same person. 0130069272-1

I,Suneel Mishra,S/o-Shri Prakash Mishra R/o D-503, Ratan Pearls, Greater Noida West, have changed my name to Suneel Kumar Mishra. 0040878351-9

I, Sumana Panada D/O Durgesh Panda R/O Flat No 1901, Tower12, Exotica Dreamville sector-16c, G.Noida West, UP have changed my name from Sumana Panda to Sumana Misra. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Sumana Misra for all future purpose. 0050297724-1

I,JAMALUDDIN,S/O-SAFI AHMAD,R/O-WARD NO 20 LAHAN DHAKA EAST CHAMPARAN,BIHAR-854518,HAVE MY NAME CHANGE TO,JAMALUDDIN ANSARI,FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE 0040878286-5

I,Nafis,S/o-Mohammad Chhutrua,R/O-C-417, Gali No.19, Mulla Colony Gharoli Extn., Gharoli,PO:Vasundhara Enclave,DIST:East Delhi, Delhi-110096,have changed the name of my minor daughter RAFIYA, age 14 years and she shall hereafter be known as RAFIYA SAIFI. 0040878348-4

I,Rizwan S/O Rahts R/O-427, Main Road, Muradnagar, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Rizwan Abbasi. 0040878346-3

I, Ms Manvika Mishra D/O Mr. Mahendra Nath Mishra, Tower-E1, 1901, Superston Eco-village, sector-1, Greater Noida, UP hereby solemnly affirm and declare that my father's name has been inadvertently mentioned in the school records of Somerville School, Noida as MAHENDRA MISHRA, whereas his correct and complete name is "SHRUTI TIWARI". So for all purposes of School documents and records both names should be get corrected

PUBLIC NOTICE

General Public is hereby informed that my clients Mr. Anil Kumar Syal S/o Sh. Jagan Nath Syal & his wife Smt. Suman Syal both resident of B-75, TF-10, West Vinod Nagar, Gali No-1, Near Badliuahi Mandir, Patparganj, I.P. Extension, East Delhi, Delhi-110092, have severed all their relations with their son namely Nikhil Syal for all intents and purposes because he has been disrespectful and disobedient towards my clients, therefore, my clients hereby formally disown and disbar their above said son from all their movable and immovable properties and also from their lives, effective immediately. Henceforth, if anybody deals with above said Nikhil Syal, shall be dealing at his/her own risk, responsibility, cost and consequences and my clients shall not be held responsible in any manner for any act, deed or dealing done by him.

Sd/- RIZWAN ALI Advocate Ch. No. 845A, Lawyers Chamber Block, Saket District Court, New Delhi-110017 Mob. No. 09999817251

PUBLIC NOTICE

RE:- PLOT NO. 16 ROAD NO. H-8 DLF CITY PHASE-1, GURUGRAM, HARYANA hereinafter referred to as SAID PLOT Notice is hereby given to the general public including banks, financial institutions etc. that our clients PARAAQUOT INFRABUILD PRIVATE LIMITED, having its Regd. Office at E-313, Greater Kailash, Part-II, New Delhi-110048 intend to purchase the said plot (hereinafter called the purchaser) from the owners LOKDHUN TELEMEDIA PRIVATE LIMITED, having its Regd. Office at 39-A, Ansari Road (Darangaj), Delhi-110002 (hereinafter called the Seller). The seller has informed the purchaser that that they are the owners of above said plot by virtue of Sale deed duly executed in their favour by Smt. RAJESHWARI PURI W/o Shri Karan Puri, R/o 81/1401, Tulip Purple, Sector-69, Badliuahi, Gurugram, Haryana-122101 duly registered in the office of Sub-Registrar, Wazirabad, Gurugram at VASIKA No. 11388 DATED 13.09.2024 and document No. 11388 ADD. Book No. 1 Vol. No. 6130 on pages 91-100. The seller further informed the purchaser that the said plot is not mortgaged anywhere and there is no charge or dispute or any litigation pending regarding the said Plot.

Any person including Bank/s, Financial Institution/s, relative/s any claim, right, title or any interest of any nature whatsoever into or upon the aforesaid plot is hereby called upon to make the same known in writing with documentary evidence by Registered AD post to the undersigned at the address mentioned hereinbelow within 30 days of publication of this notice and in the event no response having been received to the notice, the title of the seller to the said plot shall be deemed to be clear of any charge or encumbrances of any nature whatsoever and any subsequent claim shall not bind our client/purchaser, in any manner whatsoever.

AMIT GARG, Advocate 30/152, Basement, Vikram Vihar, Lajpat Nagar-2, New Delhi-110029 Em: amitagarg93@yahoo.com Mobile No: +91-9810175534

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is for the information of the general public at large that my clients, Mr. Jamuna Prasad & his wife Mrs. Heera Devi R/o 1210, Gali No.34, B-Block, Sant Nagar, Burari, Delhi 110084 have disowned their elder son Har Gopal his wife Suman their younger son Jeeat Ram and his wife Paik Raiikwar from all their movable & Immovable properties and have severed all family relations with them. Anyone dealing with them shall do so at their own risk and responsibility, and my client will not be responsible for any of their acts, deeds, or financial transactions.

Amrinder Singh Gill (Advocate) 2925/73, Burari, Delhi-84

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is for general information that I MEGHA KOCHHAR D/o VINOD KUMAR CHHABRA, Ex. Wife of KARTIK RAKESH KOCHHAR R/O, C-426, Pharma Apartment, Plot No 88, Patparganj, Delhi-110092. Declare that I got divorce from my husband vide court decree no. 355/2026 dated 8/04/2026. Further I have changed my name and she shall hereafter be known as MEGHA CHHABRA. It is certified that I have complied with other legal requirements in this connection.

I, Syed Anwarul Hoda S/o Late Syed Qamarul Hoda, House No. 118, Darul Qamar, Model Colony, Tatarpur, Asanandpur, PO-Bhagalpur city, Dist.- Bhagalpur, 812002-Bihar-India, has declared that my son's name as Syed Ammarul Hoda is the correct name, instead of Ammarul Hoda Syed, as his surname is wrongly printed in his class 10th marksheet. His actual name is "SYED AMMARUL HODA" which may be amended accordingly.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Information is given to general public at large upon instruction from M/s Evonm Properties LLP & HARJOT SINGH CHATTA who intends to purchase Industrial plot no. 860, area measuring 250 sq. mtrs., situated in Udoyog Vihar, Phase-V, Gurgaon from Mr. Rajesh Girotra (Sole proprietor of M/s. Taps and Piping) who is the owner through. Conveyance deed dated 08.08.2009 executed by HSIDC vide doc. no. 7884, book 1, vol. no. 904, pages 5/1 to 5/30, dated 07.08.2009. Said Deed That Original Conveyance deed dated 08.08.2009 executed by HSIDC vide doc. no. 7884, book 1, vol. no. 904, pages 5/1 to 5/30, dated 07.08.2009. Said Deed is missing and not traceable. An online F.I.R. has been lodged, in P.S. - Udoyog Vihar, Gurgaon vide Appl. No. 13227/09/52600 220. Anyone who find it is requested to submit the same to above mentioned address. Misuse of the same may be liable for legal action. (Any person(s), institution(s) having any claim and/or objection in respect of the said property shall communicate the same to the undersigned at our address within 07 days from the publication of this notice with documentary evidence in support thereof, failing which all the claim, of such person(s)/institution(s) shall not be binding upon the said property or Kotak Mahindra Bank Ltd.

Mohd K. Hussain (Advocate) D-21, Basement, Block-3, Jangpura Estate, New Delhi-110014, 09910591872

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Call or WhatsApp 9717006820 to advertise on classified page The Indian EXPRESS JOURNALISM OF COURAGE

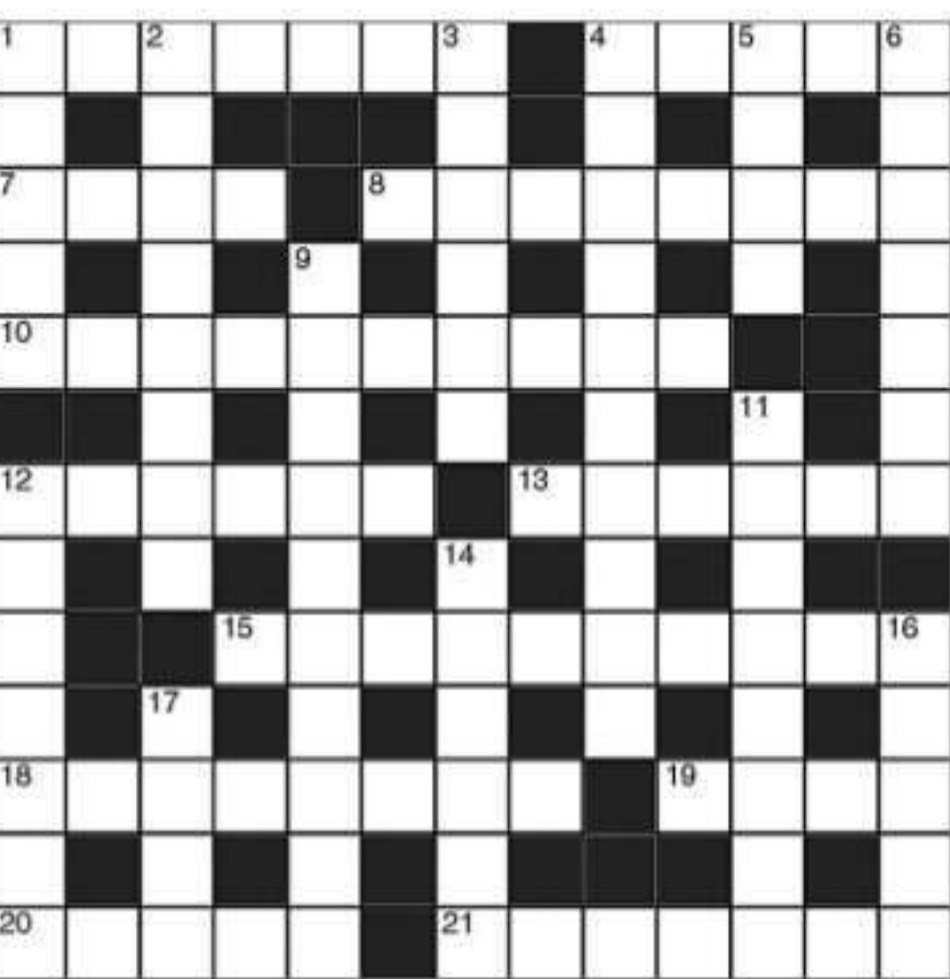
PROVISION OF LC GATE MONITORING SYSTEM E-Tender Notice No. S&T/APD/J/15 Dated: 10-09-2026. Works tenders through "E" Tendering system for and on behalf of the President of India are invited for the works as detailed below:- Tender No. AP-ST-15-2026-27. Name of work: Provision of LC gate Monitoring System at Non-Interlocked LC gate in Alipurduar Division. Tender Value: ₹ 1.55,22,369.99/- Bid Security: ₹3,10,500/-. Date & time of closing of tender: At 15.00 hrs. on 12-10-2026 & opening at 12-10-2026 after closing of E-Tender. The complete information with tender documents of above e-tender will be available in the website www.ireps.gov.in DRM (S&T)/Alipurduar Division NORTH EAST FRONTIER RAILWAY Serving Customers With A Smile

टेलीफ़ैक्स :- 05946-264331 ई-मेल :- pmbridculhd@gmail.com CIN No. : U45203UR2008SGC032591

क्र० सं०	वृक्ष की प्रजाति एवं संख्या	न्यूनतम लागत (जी० एस०टी० एवं अन्य टैक्स अतिरिक्त)	धरोहर राशि (रु०)	बिबिदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य (रु०)
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CROSSWORD

6094



- ACROSS**

1 Tell of dramatic happening at polling station (7)

4 Woman graduate who appealed to Solomon (5)

7 Medal the archer aims at (4)

8 A quick survey as soon as it's finally done (4-4)

10 Spent in riotous living (10)

12 They carry clothes and swimsuits (6)

13 Move fast after take-off (6)

15 Uplift then bring back to earth (10)

18 A mammoth beast disposed to stand and moo (8)

19 Water rate? (4)

20 Possibly licks smooth (5)

21 Odd sort of brazier (7)
- DOWN**

1 Tough serviceman allowed in free (5)

2 Music Leo played in the stadium (8)

3 One or two similar containers? (3,3)

4 See pottery cast in set routine (10)

5 Grudging admiration (4)

6 Highly upset by flight? (7)

9 Might be a rush job (10)

11 Dependant paid for help when needed (8)

12 Yet it doesn't usually contain mother's ruin (7)

14 Bury someone due to wrong note by a doctor? (6)

16 Handle right (5)

17 Drink it as a cocktail (4)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6093 **ACROSS:** 1 Inessential, 9 Admiral, 10 Leave, 11 Kids, 12 Oklahoma, 14 Upbeat, 16 Siesta, 18 Bulletin, 19 Zest, 22 Rotor, 23 Bring to, 24 Free-and-easy **DOWN:** 2 Nomad, 3 Serf, 4 Eureka, 5 Told a lie, 6 At a loss, 7 Back numbers, 8 Legal action, 13 Carefree, 15 Bolster, 17 Ribbon, 20 Edges, 21 Eire

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

___ is a possession of inestimable value - Cicero (7)

AIRREE

●●●●●●●

LRYOR

●●●●●●●

EILWDM

●●●●●●●

EKLUYF

●●●●●●●

SOLUTIONS: **Freedom** is a possession of inestimable value - Cicero

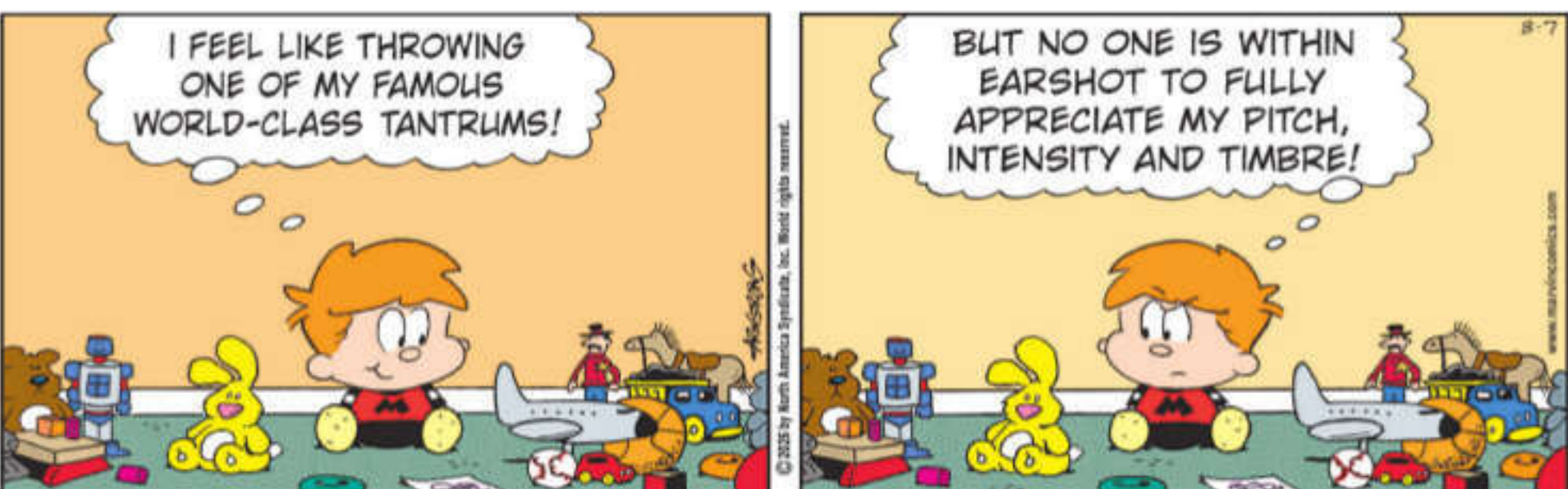
OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s

INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6442

9			1					4
	8	1	9		6	2	7	
3	5	4		7		9	1	6
8	2	9		6		4	3	7
	4	3	1		2	6	8	
1				3				9

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6441

1	7	2	4	3	8	6	5	9
5	8	3	9	7	6	2	4	1
9	4	6	1	5	2	8	7	3
7	5	9	6	2	3	4	1	8
2	3	1	5	8	4	7	9	6
4	6	8	7	1	9	3	2	5
6	2	4	8	9	5	1	3	7
3	9	7	2	6	1	5	8	4
8	1	5	3	4	7	9	6	2

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS



ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Feelings of obsession might grip you today when dealing with shared property, banking issues or something to do with taxes or inheritances. Your strong opinions might make it difficult to cooperate with others or agree to anything. Tonight: Warm affections.



TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): This is a productive time at work because you have clever ideas. Improve your health. Strong feelings might arise in your dealings with close friends. Tonight: A pleasant cooperation with someone.



GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Issues related to your job, your health or even a pet will be important to you today. You're not in the mood to compromise. You have very specific ideas and wants. Your idealism is aroused and co-workers will support you. Tonight: Help with work.



CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): This is a passionate day for you. Romance is both confusing and impossibly idealistic. Something important to you makes it hard for you to let go or be open to change. Romance will be compelling. Tonight: Romance and socialising.



LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Issues related to family or something to do with your home or where you live might be intense today. This could involve dealing with someone's values who differ from yours. Tonight: Relax.



VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): With the Sun in your sign right now you're empowered, which is fortunate, because today you are determined to achieve a particular aim. Quite likely, you'll be able to sweet-talk your way into anything. Tonight: Discussions.



LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): You'll have no trouble expressing your views. You might be interested in buying something that you want very much. Conversely, it might be related to a way to earn money. Tonight: Possibly shopping.



SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Today you might even feel obsessed about something. Perhaps you want to transform where you live or make things better in a more idealistic or dreamy way. Tonight: You're in charge.



SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Your idealism is aroused today. Meanwhile, some of you might be almost paralysed by a secret love affair. This is a strong time for you. Rally your troops if you're having disputes about inheritances or shared property. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.



CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): An exchange with a friend or a member of a group will be intense today because both parties seem to know what they want. Fortunately, if you need to talk to bosses or authority figures, they will listen to you. Tonight: Friendships.



AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Tread carefully with authority figures today. Listen to what others say and don't be too quick to challenge them because you want to do things your way. Diplomacy is required. Others will admire your work ethic right as you're giving your job everything you've got. Tonight: Be modest.



PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Steer clear of controversial discussions today because ego battles will quickly arise simply because people are passionate and entrenched in their views. Therefore, table these discussions for another day. Enjoy playful, athletic outings. Tonight: Explore.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Sunny S/o Gassi Ram R/o Jhuggi No. 71, Rakhi Market Jakhira, Delhi**, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 323/2026 Dt. 21.07.2026 U/s 74/76/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita & 8/10/17/21 POC SO Act.**, has been registered at **PS: Moti Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Sunny** namely cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Sunny** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Sunny** under **FIR No. 323/2026 Dt. 21.07.2026 U/s 74/76/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita & 8/10/17/21 POC SO Act.**, Registered at: **PS: Moti Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.11.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Sushil Kumar
DP/13047/WD/2026 ASJ, SC-POCSO-01, (West), Room No. 139 (Court Notice)
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **PINTU S/o Sh. Mahadev R/o Nishant Pavi, Sadatpur, Loni, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh** has committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 277/2017 U/s 33/58 Delhi Excise Act, PS Khajuri Khas, Distt. North-East, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **PINTU** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **PINTU** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **PINTU** of **FIR No. 277/2017 U/s 33/58 Delhi Excise Act, PS Khajuri Khas, Distt. North-East, Delhi** required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **17.10.2026 at 10:00 AM**.

By Order
Ms. Norma Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No. 22, North East Distt.
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/13033/NE/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rohan, S/o: Ajay, R/o: H.No-B-52, JJ Colony, Wazirpur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 59/2026, Dated: 18/04/2026, U/s: 304(2)/317(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sannhita 2023, P.S. South Campus, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Rohan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Rohan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rohan of P.S. South Campus, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.11.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Kautuk Bhardwaj
JMFC-06, Room No. 23, Ist Floor
Patiala House Court, New Delhi

DP/13004/SW/2026

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / ENR (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL COUNCIL PATAUDI JATAULI MANCHI	CONST. OF BAYALL OF PARK BEHIND SHARAH MANDIR BY MC LAND NARHEDA WITH 11 MC PATAUDI JATAULI PARKET + 14 WORKS	12.09.2026 19.09.2026	2,07,61,354/-	https://tenders.hry.nic.in	805797261 corrcoradined@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 49244/HRY

HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer, Mandi Division No. 1, HPPWD at Padhar on behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh invites the percentage rate/tender rate bids, in electronic tendering system, for construction of roads under RIDF for each of the following works including their maintenance for five years from the eligible and approved contractors registered with HPPWD. Non registered contractors may submit the bids; however successful bidder has to register in appropriate class with appropriate authority in HPPWD:-

- | District | RIDF | Name of the work | Estimated Cost (excluding GST) (Rs. Lakh) | | Total Cost (excluding GST) (Rs. Lakh) | Period of Completion | Bid Security (Rs. Lakh)
The bid security is two percent of the total cost, rounded to the nearest thousand |
|----------|--------|--|---|-------------|---------------------------------------|----------------------|---|
| | | | Construction | Maintenance | | | |
| (1) | (2) | (3) | (4) | (5) | (6) | (7) | (8) |
| Mandi | XXVIII | Balance work of Construction of 30.00 mtr. (Revised to 40.00 mtr.) span bridge over Naria Khad on Kulri Kheol Lohara Hamirua road at R.D. 7/900 under NABARD RIDF-XXVIII. (SH- C/O Sub-Structure, Super- Structure, C/O Retaining & breast wall, M/T and C/O Parapets for approaches of 30.00 mtr. effective R.C.C. box girder bridge at R.D. 7/900) | 124.08 | 0.00 | 124.08 | Six months | 2.48 lacs |
- Date of release of Invitation for Bids through e-procurement: 14.09.2024 at 11:30 A.M.
- Cost of Bid Form: Rs. 5000 per package/job (non-refundable) only in form of Demand Draft in favour of Executive Engineer, Mandi Division No.1, HPPWD at Padhar.
- Availability of Bid Document and mode of submission: The bid document is available online and bid should be submitted online on website www.hptenders.gov.in. The bidder would be required to register in the web-site which is free of cost. For submission of bids, the bidder is required to have valid Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) from one of the authorized Certifying Authorities (CA). *Aspiring bidders who have not obtained the user ID and password for participating in e-tendering in RIDF may obtain the same from the website: www.hptenders.gov.in. Digital signature is mandatory to participate in the e-tendering. Bidders already possessing the valid digital signature issued from authorized CAs can use the same in this tender.
- Submission of Original Documents: The bidders are required to submit (a) original Demand Draft towards the cost of bid document and (b) original bid security in approved form and (c) original affidavit regarding correctness of information furnished with bid document as per provisions of Clause 4.4B(a) (ii) of ITB with Executive Engineer Mandi Division No.1, HPPWD at Padhar (address and details of office where to be submitted), on a date not later than three working days after the opening of technical qualification part of the Bid, either by registered post or by hand.
- Last Date/ Time for receipt of bids through e-tendering: 21.09.2026 upto 10:00 Hours (time)
- The site for the work is available.
- Only online submission of bids is permitted, therefore; bids must be submitted online on website www.hptenders.gov.in. The technical qualification part of the bids will be opened online at 11:30 Hours (time) on 21.09.2026 (date) in the office of Executive Engineer Mandi Division No.1, HPPWD at Padhar by the authorized officers. If the office happens to be closed on the date of opening of the bids as specified, the bids will be opened online on the next working day at the same time.
- The bidder is not required to quote his rate for routine maintenance. The rates to be paid for routine maintenance are indicated in the Bill of Quantities. Further, the payment for routine maintenance to the contractor shall be regulated based on his performance of maintenance activities.
- The bids for the work shall remain valid for acceptance for a period not less than Seventy Five (75) days after the deadline date for bid submission.
- Bidders may bid for any one or more of the works mentioned in the Table above. To qualify for a package of contracts made up of this and other contracts for which bids are invited in the same NIT, the bidder must demonstrate having experience and resources sufficient to meet the aggregate of the qualifying criteria for the individual contracts.
- Other details can be seen in the bidding documents. The Employer shall not be held liable for any delays due to system failure beyond its control. Even though the system will attempt to notify the bidders of any bid updates, the Employer shall not be liable for any information not received by the bidder. It is the bidders' responsibility to verify the website for the latest information related to the tender.

The tender shall be awarded to the lowest bidder without any negotiation if his tendered amount is within limit of (+) 5% of the amount put to tender, otherwise the tender will be cancelled and recalled.

The bidders are advised to note other details of tenders from the department website www.hptenders.gov.in.

Executive Engineer,
Mandi Division No.1,
HPPWD at Padhar

On behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh.

3356/2026-2027

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS

BY BILL WATTERSON

BY TOM ARMSTRONG

GOVERNMENT OF JAMMU AND KASHMIR DEPARTMENT OF TOURISM

Civil Secretariat, Jammu/Srinagar

Notice inviting Tenders

For and on behalf of the Hon'ble Lieutenant Governor, J&K, UT. The Director Finance, Department of Tourism, UT of J&K invites online tenders for Request for Proposal (RFP) For Operation & Maintenance of the Yoga and Wellness Centre created under Swadesh Darshan and Repair, Renovation, Operation & Maintenance of Aparna Ashram at Mantalai, District Udhampur, UT of Jammu and Kashmir through Public Private Partnership

The online tender along with the scanned copy of CDR/FDR, Bid Fee and other relevant documents should be uploaded on or before 16.11.2026 upto 4.00 PM hrs

S/NO	RFP No	Bid Fee	EMD
1.	RFP No: 01 of 2026-27 Dated 11.09.2026	₹ 11,800.00	₹ 16,64,000.00

1. The bidding documents can be downloaded from the website www.jktenders.gov.in

2. The bids received will be opened on 17 Nov-2026 at 3.00 PM Online.

DIP NO.: DIPK-5687/26 DATE 14.09.2026

Himachal Pradesh Swasthya Bima Yojna Society

Department of Health & Family Welfare
Thakur Villa, Kasumpti, Shimla-171009
Telephone: 0177-2629802

No.HFW-H(HPSBYS)JC/2026 Dated: 11.09.2026

Tender Notice

Competitive bids are invited from the Insurance Companies who are registered with Insurance Regulatory & Development Authority of India (IRDAI) associated with health care related activities, having experience in health insurance business and can provide the health insurance coverage to the beneficiaries of Mukhya Mantri Himachal Health Care Scheme-HIMCARE in Himachal Pradesh in all the 12 Districts namely: Bilaspur, Chamba, Hamirpur, Kangra, Kinnaur, Kullu, Lahul & Spiti, Mandi, Shimla, Solan, Sirmour & Una. The tender document for this may be downloaded from website <https://hpsbys.in> and <https://hptenders.gov.in> w.e.f. 15.09.2026 onwards. The tender document can also be obtained in person from the office of Society from the date of issue on any working day between 10.30AM to 4.30PM.

Each Bidder shall submit their bid on the e-tender portal i.e. <https://hptenders.gov.in> as per the guidelines specified in the Tender Document and the instructions available on the said e-tender portal. The technical bids will be evaluated by a Committee and financial bids of only the technically qualified bidders will be opened in the presence of the successful bidders by the Committee. The last date for submission of bids is 12.10.2026 up to 05.00PM. Any bid not received on scheduled date and time, will not be accepted.

All correspondence/communication should be made on the following address. The Authority reserves the right to accept or reject any bid without assigning any reason thereof.

Chief Executive Officer
HP Swasthya Bima Yojna Society
Thakur Villa, Opposite Jal Bhawan, Kasumpti, Shimla-171009.
Phone Number: 01772629802
Email: snoabhpm.hp@gmail.com

No. 0912/HP

Office of the Executive Engineer, Electric Division-Ganderbal.

Tel No. 0194-2416236 Fax No. 0194-2416236

e-TENDER ABBREVIATED NOTICE

e-NIT No. EDV/079 of 2026-27, dt:09.09.2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor of Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir, Managing Director KPDCI, Srinagar invites online e-bids from registered A-Class Electrical Contractors/firms for as under:

S.No	Particulars	Estimated Cost (In Lacs)
1.	Design, Supply, Installation, testing and Commissioning of 11 KV Underground Cabling from Nilgath to Domail for Providing reliable Power Supply.	1319.60

The complete tender document is available at website <http://jktenders.gov.in>. Interested bidder/tenders may view, download the e-Bid document, seek clarification and submit their e-Bid online up to the date and time mentioned in the table below. Bidding Documents contain Qualifying Criteria for Bidders, Specifications, Bill of Quantities, Terms and Conditions of Contract and other details.

i)	Date and Time of downloading/Sale (Start) of Tender Document	09.09.2026: 16:00 Hrs
ii)	Date & Time of Download/Sale (End) of Tender Document	29.09.2026: 16:00 Hrs
iii)	Date and time of bidding queries/clarifications	10.09.2026: 16:00 Hrs to 21.09.2026: 16:00 Hrs
iv)	Date & Time of Bid Uploading (Start/End)	09.09.2026: 16:00 Hrs to 29.09.2026: 16:00 Hrs
v)	Commercial/Technical Bid Opening Date & Time	03.10.2026 at 13:00 Hrs
vi)	Financial Bid Opening	Shall be declared later on for the technically qualified bidders
vii)	Venue of Commercial/Technical Bid Opening	Corporate Office KPDCI, Srinagar/Electronically on J&K Government e-Procurement System Website http://jktenders.gov.in
ix)	Cost of e-Bid document	Rs. 10,000.00 (Rupees Ten Thousand Only) (Non-refundable) [Treasury Receipt/Demand Draft]
ix)	Amount of Earnest Money Deposit	Rs.26,39,200/- (Rupees Twenty Six Lakh Thirty Nine Thousand Two Hundred Only)

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
Electric Division Ganderbal
DIP NO.: DIPK-NB-163/26 DATED 14.09.2026

ASIAN GAMES | AICHI-NAGOYA | SEPTEMBER 19 TO OCTOBER 4

Protagonist, Paraphernalia & Podium: It takes three elements to complete sport. *The Indian Express* presents the stories about the personality, the equipment and the opponent who will bring the slash of strokes and dash of colour to the Asian Games

Trust is his currency: How Lombard helps athletes get back on their feet

From Neeraj and Tejaswin to Sindhu and Vinesh — all have turned to the South African who relies as much on personal rapport as he does on data and science

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, September 14

THE DAY Tejaswin Shankar's knee flared up at the 2026 Commonwealth Games, his first instinct wasn't to call his coach. It was to find Wayne Lombard.

Shankar had just pulled out of the high jump, terrified that a familiar patellar tendon problem had suddenly become something much worse. That night, his mind went to dark places. The next morning, he reached out to Lombard.

Shankar eventually completed the decathlon, won a bronze and made history as the first Indian to win a CWG medal in the event. But the episode offered a glimpse into the peculiar position Lombard occupies in Indian sport. He isn't just the strength and conditioning coach who prescribes exercises or the sports scientist who studies numbers. He is the person athletes call when they are frightened by what their bodies might be telling them.

PV Sindhu has worked with him across Olympic cycles and, after another injury-hit spell, brought him back on her team last year. Murali Sreeshankar credits Lombard's programmes for playing 'a massive role' in his comeback from a career-threatening knee injury. And when Sjoerd Marijne returned as head coach of the women's hockey team this year, one of his conditions before accepting the offer was to have Lombard on his team.

Around 30 elite Indian athletes, according to Lombard's count, now train under or work closely with the South African. The list is a who's who of Indian sports. The trust behind it is even more extraordinary. Because Lombard did not arrive in India as some grand high-performance visionary with a masterplan to transform Indian sport.

He arrived because he checked Facebook.

●●●

The story before India is surprisingly short.

Lombard was a cricketer in South Africa, good enough to play a couple of first-class matches but realistic enough to know where his game was taking him. "I wasn't good enough to take the next step," he says.

So, he began studying sports management at an academy in Durban. Then sports science took hold. A three-year undergraduate degree became an honours year in biokinetics — rehabilitation, return-to-play and the mechanics of getting injured bodies back to competition. Then came the apprenticeship that gave him the foundations for everything that followed: an internship at the High Performance Centre associated with the Sports Science Institute of South Africa. "That's where my journey really started," he says.

Lombard got his PhD. He went to China and returned to South Africa. And then, while looking for his next opportunity, a Facebook

message appeared from Donovan Pillay, then head of science at JSW Sport. Would he be interested in coming to India to work at the Inspire Institute of Sport? There was a decent chance Lombard never saw the message. "I never check it."

But this one caught his eye. "Ten years later, I'm still here."

●●●

The year is 2016. Lombard has just landed in India and encounters three young athletes about to become some of the most recognisable names in Indian sport.

Neeraj Chopra had just then broken the world under-20 javelin record and was dealing with an elbow problem. Tejaswin was beginning to emerge in the high jump. Vinesh Phogat was attempting to rebuild herself after the injury that had ended her Rio Olympics bid.

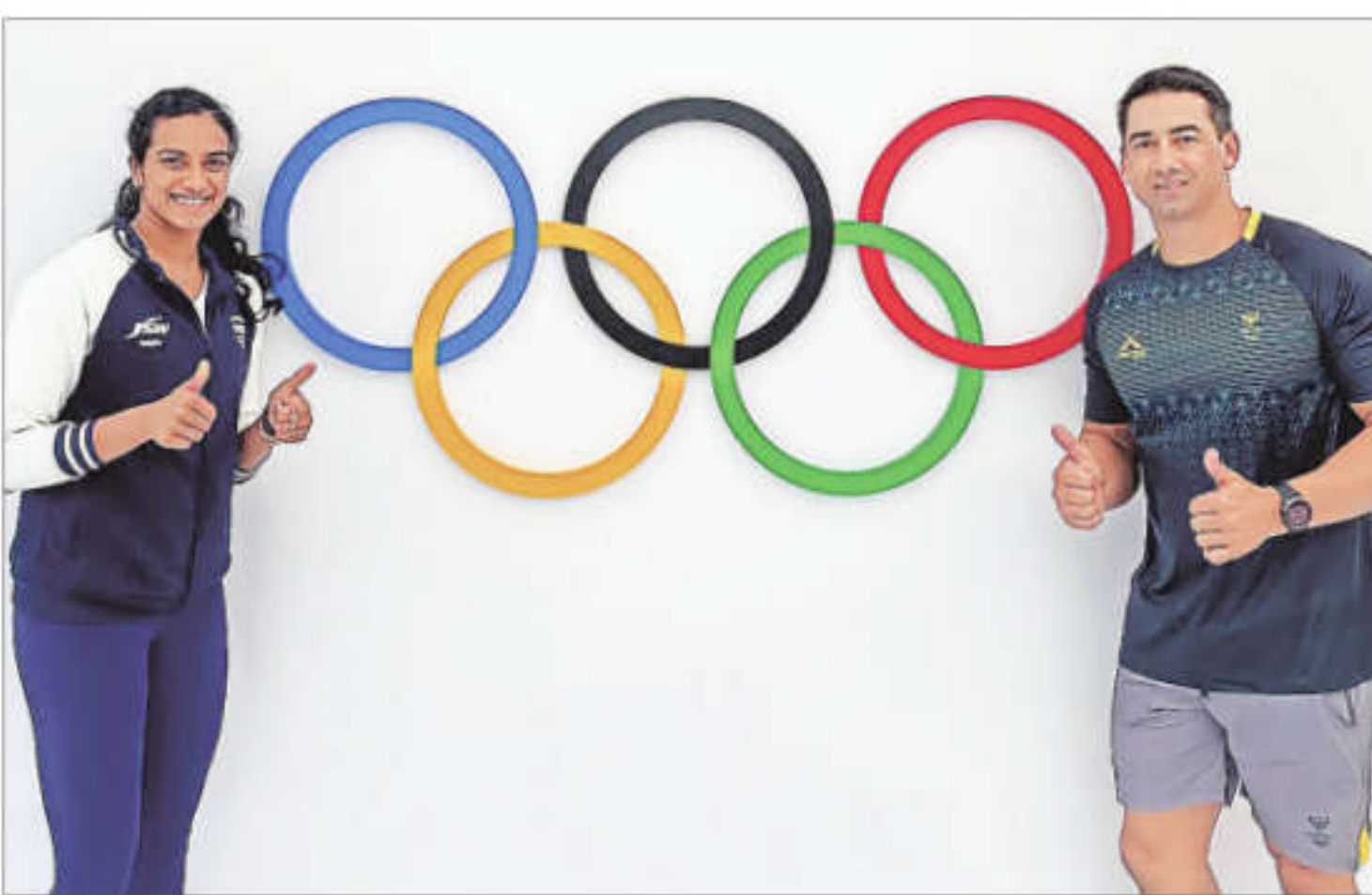
With Vinesh, Lombard worked alongside another South African physio, Sandhya Silal. It was not an easy introduction.

Vinesh was coming off a devastating injury. She had every reason to be suspicious of anyone telling her how to rebuild her body. "For us to get the buy-in was not easy initially," Lombard says. Then the work started producing results. "She just bought in, and it was really easy from there."

The relationship stuck. Years later, it is telling that Lombard speaks about Vinesh not in the language of protocols and exercises, but in the language of trust. That, increasingly, has become his currency.



Wayne Lombard with decathlete Tejaswin Shankar at the CWG. (Below) With PV Sindhu. INSTAGRAM



●●●

There is a temptation to make Lombard's story about the machinery of modern sport — force plates, blood profiles, load monitoring and biomechanics. Those things matter. But they are not why athletes keep coming back.

"You have to understand the emotions," Lombard says. "They're just human beings in the end. You can't just treat them as these robots that can go and perform. You need to be good at your job. But if you are

going to be an a*****, no one's going to want to listen to you."

Over a decade, he has learnt that the body arriving at an elite programme often carries a much longer history. Many Indian athletes come from modest backgrounds, some with nutritional deficiencies accumulated while growing up.

"The malnutrition that happens at a young age is quite a problem," Lombard says. "If we could address that at a very young age, I think that would set these athletes up at the national level a lot better. And a

lot of our overuse-type injuries will change if we change the nutrition profile at a very young age."

●●●

There is also no standard Lombard programme. Hockey demands repeated high-speed running. Badminton is built around violent acceleration, deceleration and changes of direction. And then there is Tejaswin, the Asiad gold prospect for whom Lombard has to prepare one body for 10 events.

"He needs to have a really

“The malnutrition that happens at a young age is quite a problem. If we could address that at a very young age, I think that would set these athletes up at the national level a lot better. And a lot of our overuse-type injuries will change if we change the nutrition profile at a very young age.”

WAYNE LOMBARD

S&C COACH

They're just human beings in the end. You can't just treat them as these robots that can go and perform. You need to be good at your job. But if you are going to be an a*****, no one's going to want to listen to you.”

ON EQUATION WITH ATHLETES

”

strong upper body. He needs to be fit because he needs to run the 1,500. He needs to be able to sprint,” Lombard says.

The method changes with the sport. So does the athlete. What remains constant is the relationship. With Sindhu, for instance, the work is increasingly data-driven, measuring movement, jumping and training loads. But Lombard says she remains central to the process — asking questions, trying things and speaking up when something does not work.

That may be Lombard's greatest strength. He knows the science, builds the programme and collects the numbers. Then he listens.

And perhaps, none of it would have happened had he not checked his Facebook a decade ago.

PATH TO GOLD: 10M AIR & 25M PISTOL

Esha's scintillating form puts her in contention to repeat Hangzhou heroics

Nitin Sharma
Chandigarh, September 14

ESHA SINGH walks into the Asian Games at Aichi-Nagoya the world no 1 in the women's 25m pistol, and world no 2 in the women's 10m air pistol event. At 21, the Indian shooter has already tasted success at the Asian Games, winning two individual silver medals and a team gold in Hangzhou. Her scintillating form over the last 18 months point to a repeat of her Hangzhou heroics — 25m World Championship bronze medal, two World Cup titles, a world record score of 43 — Esha has been near unstoppable. As if the 25m dominance wasn't enough, she added a 10m World Cup silver medal won in Munich this year as well.

"In the last Asian Games, Esha won the silver medals in both individual events as well as the gold and silver in team. There will be higher expectations this time. The important thing is such things are bound to happen and we train accordingly. There is no magic pill to forget but then training and focus means you cut out the noise. If one follows what one has practiced, results will follow," says Ronak Pandit who is Singh's coach.

In Japan, Asia's best will be present. Pistol shooting enjoys a strong Asian presence — Paris Olympics 10m air pistol champion Oh Ye-jin of Korea and 10m air pistol world champion and 25m world silver medalist Yao Qianxun from China will also be competing in both the events. Singh will also see the ever-present challenge from Paris Olympic double-medallist Manu Bhaker in both the events apart from the gauntlet thrown down by world no 3 and three-time World Cup champion Suruchi Phogat in the 10m event.

Quality field

That path to gold gets further complicated as Tokyo Olympics mixed team champion

"It cannot be a 50-50 balance but we compensate by doing live fire in one event and dry fire in another during training. 25m is about the ability to lift more consistently as well as continuity of trigger. In 10m, Esha is technically very strong. So we have been working on the tactical part. She is an aggressive trigger shooter and does not overthink," says Pandit.

Over the last few months, Pandit has been re-enforcing only one thing in Esha's shooting. "When she made the world record, we did not even talk about it. We talked about how she was technically flawless and how we can better ourselves. The conversations are how competition keeps changing but the task remains the same. To shoot your best," says Pandit.

Esha Singh

They decide stiffness of the shaft, even as Indians adopted the latest upgrade on the hatchet shaped blade called 'Plain Edge' — smoother, curved top edge and wider tip leading to a softer catch (how much water is moved).

Carved from across a factory floor overlooking Napoleon's Elba retreat in Livorno in Italy, the Fillipi boats are on the higher-cost range of around Rs 19 lakh.

Fillipi R&D however is top-grade, and has always delivered Asiad medals for India. The oars, connected with rowlocks to the boats though, come from

and Individual silver medallist Jiang Ranxin will also be among the 10m pistol field apart from Paris Olympics champion Yang Ji-in of Korea and Paris Olympics silver medallist Xiao Jiarui of China being the title contenders in the 25m event. In Cairo, Singh had won the bronze with Ji-in winning the title and Qianxun winning the silver.

In the World Cup in Munich this year, Singh won the title in the 25m final as well as silver behind Phogat in 10m pistol, with her competing in a field including Ji-in and former world champion Doreen Vennekamp of Germany in the 25m and Yiyao and London Olympics silver medallist Celine Goberville of France in the 10m.

Her 25m title in Munich came when she broke the previous world score of 42 set by Yeji before she won the silver in the 10m event two days later. Singh had talked about how she competes with herself and does not think about her opponents. "I don't really see who is standing besides me or the names who are in the final and I just aim to focus on my thoughts and my process and that's what I did. 25m pistol is definitely a challenging game. The whole dynamics are a bit different and since there are no decimals, it's a very tight game," Singh had said earlier.

Regular in finals

Since 2025, Singh has made it to the four finals in 25m and three 10m finals in ISSF World Cups. Pandit talks about how the 21-year-old has maintained the balance. "The starting sequence with the gun for both remains the same. So that lessens one variable. But then maintaining the right balance is tricky. When you find one event easier or do well, then you train more in that. It's like if one is good in science, then he will give it more time as compared to if he is average in maths or vice versa.

"We technically have a 50-50 balance but we compensate by doing live fire in one event and dry fire in another during training. 25m is about the ability to lift more consistently as well as continuity of trigger. In 10m, Esha is technically very strong. So we have been working on the tactical part. She is an aggressive trigger shooter and does not overthink," says Pandit.

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SPORT LAB

Microfibre suede grips, a blessing for rowers with calloused and bleeding palms

Advances in materials used for the grip that secures connection between rower and oars have reduced blisters

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, September 14

THE 27TH to 29th North latitudes of India, with towns on the 28th degree specifically from Mansa in Punjab to Sikar and Churu in Rajasthan, to Roorkee in Uttarakhand to Bulandshahr and Bareilly in UP, produce most of the country's top medalling men's rowers at Asian Games.

It's historically observed, and a bit of a snazzy coincidence too. But not so much when you realise they get scouted out in army/lately navy recruitments from that wonder-belt for their strong frames that later churn out rowing champions. It's also a farming belt. Though, ask any

top name, and they will boast of their first calluses, dried out from near-bleeding blisters on hands, when sitting in a boat, wielding the oars.

Rowing's repetitive friction when settling onto the right rhythm for the stroke, clutching those durable, easy-to-clean green rubber grips at the end of the shaft handle, invariably led to bleeding, especially when training on water for 2-3 hours. Champions of yore from Bajrang Lal Takhar to Arvind- Arjun last Asiad at Hangzhou, would all have their own tales of the crusty skin that could take up to three years to soften back. They wore them like battle scars — even as some of the quietest, no-fuss medals, even gold, increased India's tally but were

gently forgotten as the sport is far from glamorous.

'Mazdoor ka hath'

"It's like a farmer's hand. *Ya mazdoor ka hath*," coach and equipment geek at the Army Rowing Node, Subedar Tejas Shirke, explains. It wasn't that it hurt terribly that was the problem, he says. "The efficiency of the stroke would go down due to blisters," he says.

Around 2018-19, Vermont-based American oar-makers, Concept2 got researching on adjustable composite grips, and arrived at microfibre suede grips which had a softer texture to replace the rubber-caused aggravations.

"The blisters don't entirely go away. We are rowers after all.



•Blades and grips

●The shaft handle grips — once made of abrasive rubber — are now made of skin-friendly Microfibre suede material that minimises blisters

●While the persistent pain from bleeding blisters was one aspect of the problem, it also used to reduce the efficiency of the stroke

●Indians have adopted the hatchet-shaped blades. The curved top edge and wider tip help with a better 'catch' — how much water is moved

●The long 'Ultralight' oars, made of carbon fibre - offer greater elasticity and act as levers.

India's quadruple sculls Fillipi boat, in iconic white & blue, with the grips made of microfibre suedes. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

But it was the biggest tech change that helped improve efficiency and timings. You could call it skin-friendly," Shinde says.

Oars are notoriously wand-like. And coaches who go about making adjustments in length, angle of the blade, and tiny hexagonal screws as small as 13 mm in diameter, do it with the wild whacked intuition of Diagon Alley's wandmaker Olivander. This happens two days before the race, though the tool box and India's iconic white & blue Fillipi boats, have already reached Nagoya.

String pendulums

Coaches travel with string pendulums dipped into competition waters to measure thickness, gravity, pH and density of the liquid. If water is heavier, a bigger angle is imparted to the blade; for lighter, it's less, in the 0° to 4° range.

Oars essentially work as levers and adjustments for length of the shaft and where the lock should clasp (inboard and outboard), can depend on variables like weather, water density, strength of the rower, what training phase he is in and a coach's instinct.

They decide stiffness of the shaft, even as Indians adopted the latest upgrade on the hatchet shaped blade called 'Plain Edge' — smoother, curved top edge and wider tip leading to a softer catch (how much water is moved).

Carved from across a factory floor overlooking Napoleon's Elba retreat in Livorno in Italy, the Fillipi boats are on the higher-cost range of around Rs 19 lakh.

Fillipi R&D however is top-grade, and has always delivered Asiad medals for India. The oars, connected with rowlocks to the boats though, come from

picturesque Vermont, where the basswood is used as much for old-fashioned rowing handles as handmade acoustic and electric guitars.

Oar technology though has moved on from wood (though Australians still swear by it), to the new carbon fibre 'Ultralight' oars that offer greater elasticity.

India's elite rowers who will contend for gold in men's Lightweight Doubles Sculls and Quadruple Sculls, have a huddle warcry — "India, Row for Gold."

Nothing less will do after China picked gold last time in double sculls. Given the exhausting nature of the sport, rowers this time, have been working with elite psychologists teaching them to stay calm through the strength crunching stroke. The calluses on hands might not reduce efficiency this time around, tech has ensured.

“I thought it was 5-1! It's actually funny. Tennis teachers always tell you just play each point, to forget about the score. From that moment I forgot about the score, it helped me. ALEXANDER ZVEREV, ON HIS REACTION AFTER WINNING

In-the-zone Zverev ends Shelton's dream run

German wins his second Grand Slam title with a 6-3, 7-6 (2), 5-7, 6-2 win over the American

Bhuvan Gupta
New Delhi, September 14

SIXTY-SEVEN games. That's how long Alexander Zverev continued to hold his service against Ben Shelton before the American finally broke again. Shelton had only done it once before: in the first set of their first meeting in 2024.

Zverev had amassed five straight wins over him since and was about to earn a sixth one. Yet, the German's mind was not at ease.

He had been here before. He had let the US Open title slip from his grasp. Six years back, close friend Dominic Thiem had erased a two-set deficit to leave Zverev agonisingly short. The previous time such a comeback had materialised in New York was in 1949.

On Sunday, Shelton was similarly two sets down against Zverev. Like Thiem, the 23-year-old took the third set. A 24,000-strong crowd at Arthur Ashe Stadium was willing the home hope on to do the improbable. Zverev could not bear another heartbreak.

And so he was locked in a trance-like state. Serve, receive, repeat. Scores were forgotten. When victory finally arrived at 6-3, 7-6 (2), 5-7, 6-2, Zverev did not recognise it. He went back to the receive position, oblivious to chair umpire Marijana Veljovic's 'game-set-match' proclamation.

His team told him the match was over. Zverev exhaled.

He had conquered Flushing Meadows, eleven years after first appearing in the main draw.

"In that moment I was in the zone a lot. I didn't hear noise at all," Zverev later described his state of mind. "It's funny - tennis teachers always tell you to just play the next point and forget about the score. At that moment I



(Left 1 to 3) Leading 5-2, 40-15 in the fourth set, Zverev forced an error against Shelton but did not initially realise he had won the final; Zverev lifting the US Open trophy. REUTERS

forgot about the score and it helped me."

Turning a corner

After several seasons of nerves and near-misses, Zverev has turned the corner in 2026 with two Major titles. Carlos Alcaraz, Jannik Sinner and Novak Djokovic were all afflicted by physical troubles for lengthy stretches, leaving 'Sascha' room to break through.

"We went 30 years without winning a Grand Slam title and now we've won two in three months," said Zverev to his team, which includes father Alexander senior and brother Mischa, in his winner's speech. "2026 is the outcome of all the years that happened before."

Those years included grave allegations of domestic abuse by two former partners, Olya Sharypova and Brenda Patea. Zverev denied the allegations



45-1

Zverev's win/loss record against left-handers in his last 46 matches. He has a 6-0 record against Shelton

2

Number of German men who have won multiple Grand Slams in a season. Boris Becker is the other player

2

Number of times Shelton has broken Zverev's serve across six matches. The second break came 67 games after the first

and had an out-of-court settlement with Patea in 2024. But his public reputation remains tainted. He was heckled by a spectator during the Australian Open trophy ceremony last year.

The audience in New York anyway had enough reason to turn against Zverev. Shelton, their hero, had captured the imagination with an inspired campaign. He was stuttering in the final and needed a push. The crowd readily supplied it.

"I know that today 99.9% of the people wanted Ben to win, so I'm very sorry first of all," Zverev told them. "But second, it was an incredible atmosphere to play in. Even though I know that the crowd was against me, the crowd was always incredibly fair."

Shelton perhaps experienced the jittery feeling that Zverev did back in 2020. The first-time Slam finalist was un-

characteristically loose with his serving, especially in the first set. He committed a double fault to be broken in the opening game and double faulted again at set point.

The second set was tighter as Shelton improved his serve rhythm and forced a tiebreak. But Zverev was sharper with his groundstrokes in the key moments, racing to a 5-0 lead that decided the breaker.

Shelton was hurting. He showed determination in the third set, repeatedly gunning for Zverev's serve. He pried it open at the last opportunity at 6-5.

The break had arrived after 67 consecutive service holds across six matches by Zverev, who Shelton said post-match "has got the best serve in tennis". It kept the left-hander afloat but not for long.

Zverev disrupted Shelton's plans of snatching momentum by breaking right

back in Game 1 of the fourth set. The American realised it was now or never and went for broke. It could have worked some other day, but just didn't on Sunday.

He was broken again in the seventh game and after three hours and 33 minutes, a long forehand brought Shelton's resistance to a tame end.

"I'm excited with the progress that I feel that I've made, but this one feels 100%," said Shelton. "I made too many errors when I had the ball there on my strings."

He would have learnt a lot from this career-defining run and there is work to be done on his game.

But Shelton has time, talent and tenacity on his side. As Zverev put it, "You're (Shelton) going to be back here many, many times. If I have to bet all my money on it, I would bet that you would lift this trophy one day."

Players to form council to push for better pay

TOP TENNIS players said on Monday they would cease to publicly campaign for greater influence and financial benefits from the four Grand Slams, choosing instead to pursue their objectives through a new Player Advisory Council.

The players said the agreement on a council and the progress toward their key objectives marked a "significant step" forward.

"The players will now work directly with the Grand Slams to establish the council, through which players themselves will be directly consulted and able to negotiate on an ongoing basis," the group said in a statement. REUTERS

ASIA CUP CONTROVERSY

Decision taken on basis of 'circumstances and sentiments', says Saikia

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, September 14

DESPITE WINNING a record eighth Asia Cup title, the India women's team will head home - like the men's team did last year - with no trophy to show for their efforts. After India defeated Sri Lanka in the final of the Asia Cup in Dubai on Sunday night, Harmanpreet Kaur & Co refused to take the medals and the trophy from Asian Cricket Council (ACC) chairman Mohsin Naqvi, who also happens to be Pakistan's interior minister.

"We had taken a conscious decision considering all prevailing aspects, and our position had been communicated to the ACC in advance, that the Indian team would not participate in the trophy presentation under the circumstances," BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia said in a statement to *The Indian Express*.

It is understood that the BCCI had communicated on the eve of the final that if Naqvi were to hand over the medals and trophy, the Indian team wouldn't be receiving them. The scenes were a repeat of what happened when the men's team under Suryakumar Yadav had refused to take the trophy from Naqvi. The men's tournament, held soon after the Pahalgam terrorist attacks and Operation Sindoor, saw Indian players refuse to shake hands with their Pakistani counterparts. The women's team has been following a similar policy, which incidentally isn't followed by India's athletes in other sports.

While the Indian government has spelt out the guidelines as to when and where they will play Pakistan, there is no directive as such about shaking hands or accepting medals handed over by individuals from across the border. However, Saikia said it was an institutional decision to not receive the trophy from Naqvi.

"Our participation in the Asia Cup was in fulfilment of our sporting commitments as a member of the Asian Cricket Council by adhering to the policy in place, and there was never any question of compromising on the spirit of the game or our commitment to international cricket. However, participation in a multinational tournament and the manner in which the trophy is received are two separate matters. Given the circumstances and the sentiments prevailing in the country, the BCCI felt that it would not be appropriate for the team to receive the trophy in the proposed manner. This was a firm institutional decision, reflective of the position we have maintained, and was not directed at the players, the tournament or the sport," the BCCI secretary said.



“BCCI felt that it would not be appropriate for the team to receive the trophy in the proposed manner. This was a firm institutional decision.”

DEVAJIT SAIKIA,
ON THE DECISION TO NOT ACCEPT THE TROPHY FROM MOHSIN NAQVI.

ate for the team to receive the trophy in the proposed manner. This was a firm institutional decision, reflective of the position we have maintained, and was not directed at the players, the tournament or the sport," the BCCI secretary said.

Like after the men's Asia Cup final, the waiting time for the presentation reached 50 minutes after the final delivery. The Sri Lankan players had collected their runners-up medal from Naqvi. However, with Indian players not moving an inch, the presentation ceremony ended abruptly with Naqvi walking away without the trophy. During the men's event, Naqvi had taken the trophy with him.

"The women's team has done what matters, they have won the Asia Cup through their outstanding performance on the field. We as well as the whole nation are immensely proud of the team, and the achievement belongs to the players and to Indian cricket. Now, our focus is on the Asian Games and we do not allow any distraction at this stage from the preparation for the same," Saikia said.

After the presentation ceremony, India coach Amol Muzumdar explained the team's decision. "That stand has been taken by the BCCI and we stand by it. For us, this tournament is over, we are the champions. That's good enough. It was on the big board that India are the champions of Asia Cup 2026. This tournament is officially over for us. We're happy that we're the champions and we look forward to the Asian Games," Muzumdar said.

VAR was wrong to allow Haaland goal: Refs' body

Reuters
Manchester, September 14

THE VIDEO assistant referee (VAR) was wrong to allow Erling Haaland's decisive goal in Manchester City's 1-0 win over Manchester United at Old Trafford on Sunday, refereeing body Pro Ref said in a statement.

Haaland's strike on the hour mark was initially disallowed for offside but was allowed to stand after a VAR review found him to be onside.

However, Pro Ref said the VAR failed to recognise the likely impact of his teammate Enzo Fernandez, who attempted to head the ball from an offside position.

"The on-field decision was offside against Erling Haaland - that was checked by VAR and he was found to be in an onside position," the statement said.

"In the same attack, it was established that Enzo Fernandez did not play the ball and therefore that makes any offside offence subjective, however, on this occasion, the VAR did not recognise the likely impact of his position and should have recommended an on-field review.

"Contact has been made with Manchester United this evening to acknowledge what we deem is an error of judgement. A review of the incident will take place."

Manchester United boss Michael Carrick was angry at a derby defeat.

"I just don't get it, I really don't get it, I can't understand



Erling Haaland scored the winner for Manchester City, who were down to 10 men. AP

how we're trying to help referees, putting so many layers behind them, so many people, bodies and screens, and they can't make the right decision," he told a post-match media conference.

Red card for Foden

AP adds: City's fans may have felt justice was done after Phil Foden was sent off in the 23rd for kicking out at Bruno Fernandes.

Foden and City's players remonstrated on the field and coach Enzo Maresca said Fernandes should also have been shown a red for the altercation.

With an extra man United hit the post either side of half-time - first from Marcus Rashford's long-range free kick and then Kobbie Mainoo's low shot from the edge of the area.

"The red card changed the plan of the game, but credit to the players and their effort, spirit and togetherness was brilliant," Maresca said.

ARCHERY WORLD CUP FINAL

Dhiraj caps year with historic recurve title

Nitin Sharma
Chandigarh, September 14

DOLA BANERJEE first raised the Indian recurve flag high in Dubai at an Archery World Cup Final in 2007. Dhiraj Bommadevara has emulated her in Mexico, 19 years later.

The Vijayawada archer pipped Japan's Junya Nakanishi 10-9 in the shoot-off after a 5-5 tie in the final at Saltillo. Bommadevara thus is the first Indian male recurve archer to win a World Cup Final title.

The 25-year-old, who had earlier won the individual recurve World Cup Stage 3 gold in Antalya, qualified for the eight-archer World Cup Final as the second seed. He notched up wins over Paris Olympics bronze medallist Berkim Tumer and double Olympic silver medallist Jean-Charles Valladont in the quarters and semis, respectively, followed by the win via the shoot-off in the final.

"From the start of the match until the very end, I kept one thing in mind: I had to fight right up to the final arrow, I did fight, and I am incredibly proud. I managed to achieve what I had worked so hard for, and I will continue to do so in the future," Bommadevara told *World Archery*.

"It's like a dream come true. Every athlete dreams of this - becoming a champion at events like the World Cup Final, Asian Games or the Olympics, and waving the national tricolour. That brings immense joy," he added.

Post his heartbreakingly



Dhiraj Bommadevara (L) along with coach Sonam Tshering Bhutia after winning the title in Saltillo Archery WC Final. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

narrow second-round loss in the individual category and the fourth-place finish in the mixed team event along with Ankita Bhakat at Paris Olympics. Bommadevara saw a dip in form last year. His shooting average dropped from a career-high 9.51 to 9.37.

Resurgence in 2026

In a mediocre year, Bommadevara had his moments with a bronze medal at the Archery World Cup Stage 1 in USA. This year, he has lost just three out of 16 matches, with the gold in Antalya marking his maiden World Cup title.

A 7-3 win over Paris Olympics individual bronze and team gold medalist Lee Woo-seok shaped the title, and saw him ranked second behind Tokyo Olympics champion

Mete Gazoz in the eight-player draw in Mexico. Bommadevara first defeated Tumer 7-1 before another 7-1 win over Valladont of France in the semi-finals. The final against Nakanishi saw the Indian trailing 1-3 and 3-5 before he won the fifth set 28-27 to tie the match, followed by his 10 as compared to the Japanese's nine in the shoot-out.

With the competition happening at the Plaza de Armas, one of the main squares in the 1577-founded city, the Indian had to face winds. "Since there is no qualification in the World Cup Final, we had done some individual match simulation practice prior to coming here. With the best eight archers, there is hardly any room for error," national coach Sonam Tshering Bhutia told *The Indian Express* from Mexico.

"The winds were blowing here from left to right with the left side open. So the focus was to aim towards the nine o'clock or nine o'clock-ten position," Bhutia added.

He acknowledged the pressure of competing against the top-ranked archers, stating that the wins against Tumer and Valladont, along with the shoot-off victory "will motivate Dhiraj further".

With the Indian archery team departing last week for the Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya, Bommadevara will be heading straight to Japan from Mexico, with recurve competitions starting from September 26.

Last December, he had won the Asian Championships in Bangladesh with a win over compatriot Rahul Banerjee in the final. He had also won the mixed team title along with Kumkum Mahod in Antalya, where the pair had scored a 5-1 win over the reigning Olympic gold medallists Kim Je-deok and Oh Ye-jin of South Korea.

With Je-deok joined by his Paris gold-winning teammates Kim Woo-jin and Lee Woo-seok at the Asian Games, Bommadevara will face a stern Korean challenge in Japan. "Dhiraj's strength has been his mental fortitude as well as the belief in his technical process.

"He is a fast-paced shooter and the bow draw and anchor comes at a speed for him. We have also worked on the finishing process. These three wins in a single day will give him a lot of confidence ahead of the Asian Games," said Bhutia.

Varun out with injury, to miss Afghanistan T20Is; doubtful for Asian Games

Express News Service
Chennai, September 14

INDIA SPINNER Varun Chakravarthy has been ruled out of the remaining two T20Is against Afghanistan with a side strain, with his participation in the upcoming Asian Games also under the cloud. The 35-year-old, who returned to the Indian team after spending two months on the sidelines due to a hamstring injury, had been at the BCCI's Centre of Excellence undergoing rehab and was cleared to play the Afghanistan series.

The Indian Express understands that Varun has been told to report to the CoE for further tests after he complained of a side strain at the conclusion of Sunday's first T20I in Delhi on Sunday. With the Indian team set to leave for the Asian Games in Japan on September 18, his availability remains unclear at this stage, with a decision expected only after the medical team takes further tests. It is understood that the Indian team management was also taken aback by Varun's latest injury as prior to the series, he had cleared the fitness test at the CoE.

Varun's injury puts the focus back again on the CoE. This isn't the first instance of a player returning after rehab and again getting injured. During the UK tour, pacer Harshit Rana suffered a hamstring injury and was sent back to India, where he has been undergoing rehab. And during the rehab process, he suffered a rectus femoris strain dur-



Varun Chakravarthy's injury puts the focus back on the Centre of Excellence. CREIMAS

ing the match simulation for his inclusion in the team for the T20Is against Afghanistan and the Asian Games.

Having struggled off-late with the ball since the T20 World Cup, Varun appeared to have found his form back against Afghanistan, where in the four overs he conceded only 16 runs and picked up one wicket. Speaking of his comeback after the game, Varun said, "Look, injuries are very common for all sportspeople and it just shows that we are working, we are giving our best. Sometimes we push beyond our limits and that is when the body gives in."

If Varun is ruled out, India may bring Kuldeep Yadav, who is currently playing county cricket for Yorkshire, back into the fold as they already have Axar Patel and Washington Sundar as their spinners.

Live: India vs Afghanistan on Sony Sports Network and Fancode at 7:30 pm